



Antmicro

Topwrap

2026-10-09

DOCUMENTATION

1	Introduction to Topwrap	1
2	Installing Topwrap	2
2.1	1. Install required system packages	2
2.2	2. Install the Topwrap user package	2
2.3	3. Verify the installation	3
3	Getting started	4
3.1	Design overview	4
3.2	Packaging Verilog sources	5
3.3	Building designs with Topwrap	5
3.4	Command-line flow	7
3.5	Using libraries	10
4	Advanced options	11
4.1	Creating block designs in the GUI	11
5	Sample projects	15
5.1	Embedded GUI	15
5.2	Constant	15
5.3	Inout	16
5.4	Hierarchy	19
5.5	PWM	20
5.6	HDMI	21
5.7	SoC	22
5.8	Memory Map	24
5.9	AXI interconnect	25
6	Creating a design	27
6.1	Design description	27
6.2	IP description files	31
6.3	Interface definition files	40
6.4	Resource path syntax	42
6.5	Positions YAML	44
7	Interface inference	46
8	Configuration	48
8.1	Configuration file location	48
8.2	Configuration precedence	48

8.3	Available config options	49
9	Libraries	51
9.1	Registering a library	51
9.2	Inspecting libraries	51
9.3	Describing library contents	52
9.4	Referencing a library module	52
9.5	Declaring libraries in a design	53
9.6	Creating a library core	53
10	Constructing, configuring and loading repositories	55
10.1	Supported resource types	55
10.2	CLI	56
10.3	Using the open source IP cores library with Topwrap	57
11	Interconnect generation	58
11.1	Format	59
11.2	Supported interconnect types	60
12	Using FuseSoC for automation	62
12.1	Default tool for synthesis, bitstream generation and programming the FPGA . . .	62
12.2	Additional build options	62
12.3	Synthesis	63
13	Plugin Support	64
13.1	Ways to get plugins	64
13.2	Plugin configurations	64
14	Setup	65
15	Code style	66
15.1	Lint with pre-commit	66
15.2	Tools	66
16	Tests	67
16.1	Test execution	67
16.2	Test coverage	68
16.3	Updating kpm test data	68
17	Internal Representation	69
17.1	Class diagram	69
17.2	Frontend & Backend	69
17.3	Module	72
17.4	Design	73
17.5	Interface	75
17.6	Interface inference	78
17.7	Connections	80
17.8	HDL Types	82
17.9	Interconnects	84
17.10	Miscellaneous	86
17.11	A note on “sliced” vs. “independent” signals	88
18	Frontend	91

18.1	SystemVerilogFrontend	91
18.2	KpmFrontend	91
18.3	YamlFrontend	91
18.4	IpXactFrontend	92
19	Backend	93
19.1	SystemVerilogBackend	93
19.2	KpmBackend	93
19.3	YAML backends	93
19.4	IPXACTBackend	93
20	FuseSocBuilder	95
20.1	Customizations	96
21	Interface Definition	99
22	Config	100
23	Validation of design	101
23.1	Tests for validation checks	103
24	Future planned enhancements in Topwrap	111
24.1	Library of open-source cores	111
24.2	Support for hierarchical block designs in Topwrap's GUI	111
24.3	Support for parsing SystemVerilog sources	111
25	Other possible improvements	112
25.1	Ability to produce top-level wrappers in VHDL	112
25.2	Bus management	112
25.3	Improve the process of recreating a design from a YAML file	112
25.4	Deeper integration with other tools	113
25.5	Provide a way to parse HDL sources from the GUI level	113
26	Using KPM iframes inside docs	114
26.1	Usage	114
26.2	Tests	115
27	Examples for Internal Representation	117
27.1	Simple	117
27.2	Interface	118
27.3	Hierarchical	118
27.4	Interconnect	119
27.5	Advanced	120
27.6	SoC	121
27.7	SoC_AXI	121
27.8	Inverted	122
27.9	Clocks	123
27.10	Complex hierarchy parsing	123
27.11	Other	124
28	IP-XACT format	125
28.1	General observations	125
28.2	Simple example	129

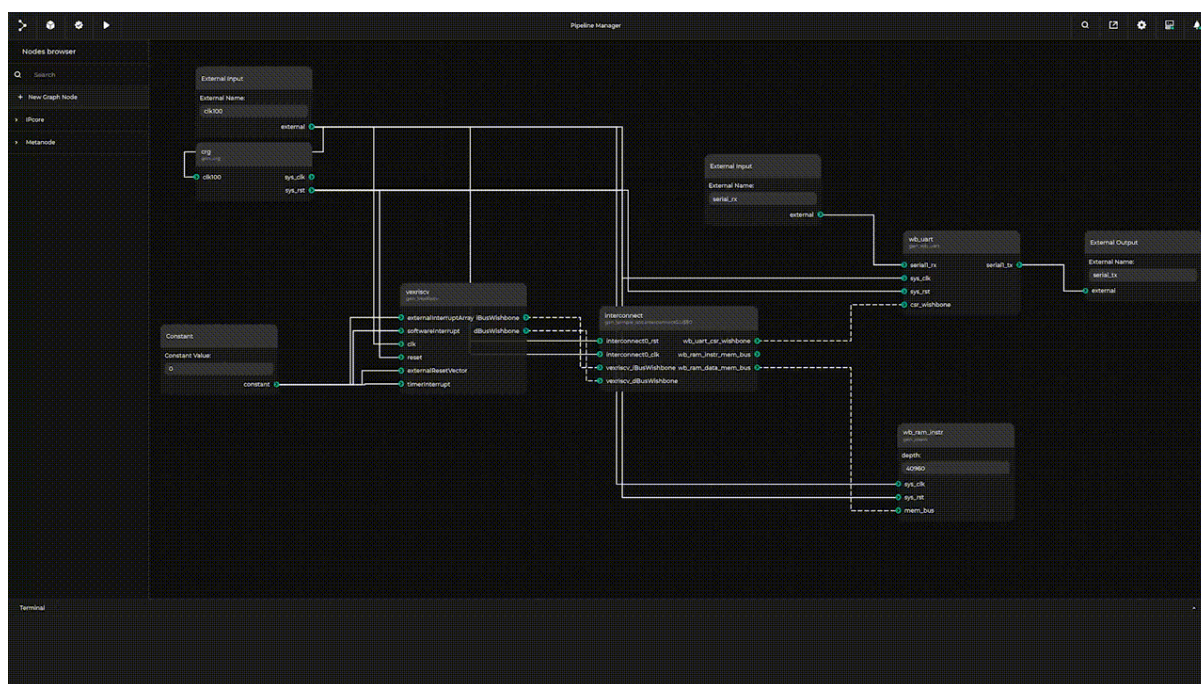
28.3	Interface example	131
28.4	Hierarchical example	135
28.5	Interconnect example	135
28.6	Other features	137
28.7	Conclusion	137
29	Generator	138
29.1	How to implement a Generator	139
29.2	Lookup maps	139
29.3	API Reference	139
30	Interconnect	142
31	Repository	143
31.1	API reference	143
32	Logging	146
32.1	Using a Custom Logging Configuration	146
32.2	Creating a New Logger	147
33	Plugins	149
33.1	Examples	149
33.2	Plugin Base	149
33.3	Build Context	150
34	Caliptra UART	152
35	VeeR EL2	153
36	HMAC	154
37	SHA256	155
38	SHA512	156
39	SHA3	157
	Python Module Index	158
	Index	159

INTRODUCTION TO TOPWRAP



Topwrap leverages modularity to enable the reuse of design blocks across different projects, facilitating the transition to automated logic design. It provides a standardized approach for organizing blocks into various configurations, making top-level designs easier to parse and process automatically.

As a tool, Topwrap makes it *straightforward to build* complex and *synthesizable designs* by generating a design file in formats such as SystemVerilog or *IP-XACT 2022*. The combination of *GUI and CLI-based* configuration options provides for fine-tuning possibilities. Packaging multiple files is accomplished by including them in a *custom user repository*, and an internal API enables repository creation using Python.



INSTALLING TOPWRAP

2.1 1. Install required system packages

Caution: Topwrap has been tested on Debian Bullseye and Bookworm. While other distributions may also be compatible, Bullseye and Bookworm reflect environments where functionality has been verified.

On Debian and Debian-based distributions, follow these steps to install the required dependencies:

Install required dependencies

```
apt install -y python3 python3-pip yosys npm
```

And uv if you want to use it to install Topwrap:

```
curl -LsSf https://astral.sh/uv/install.sh | sh
```

For more details see [uv installation page](#)

2.2 2. Install the Topwrap user package

Recommended: Use [uv](#) to directly install Topwrap as a user package:

```
uv tool install "topwrap @ git+https://github.com/antmicro/topwrap"
```

If you can't use uv, you can use regular pip instead. It may be necessary to do it in a Python virtual environment, such as [venv](#):

```
python3 -m venv venv
source venv/bin/activate
pip install "topwrap@git+https://github.com/antmicro/topwrap"
```

2.3 3. Verify the installation

Make sure that Topwrap was installed correctly and is available in your shell:

```
topwrap --help
```

This should print out the help string with Topwrap subcommands listed out.

See also:

If you want to contribute to the project, check the *Developer's setup guide* for more information.

GETTING STARTED

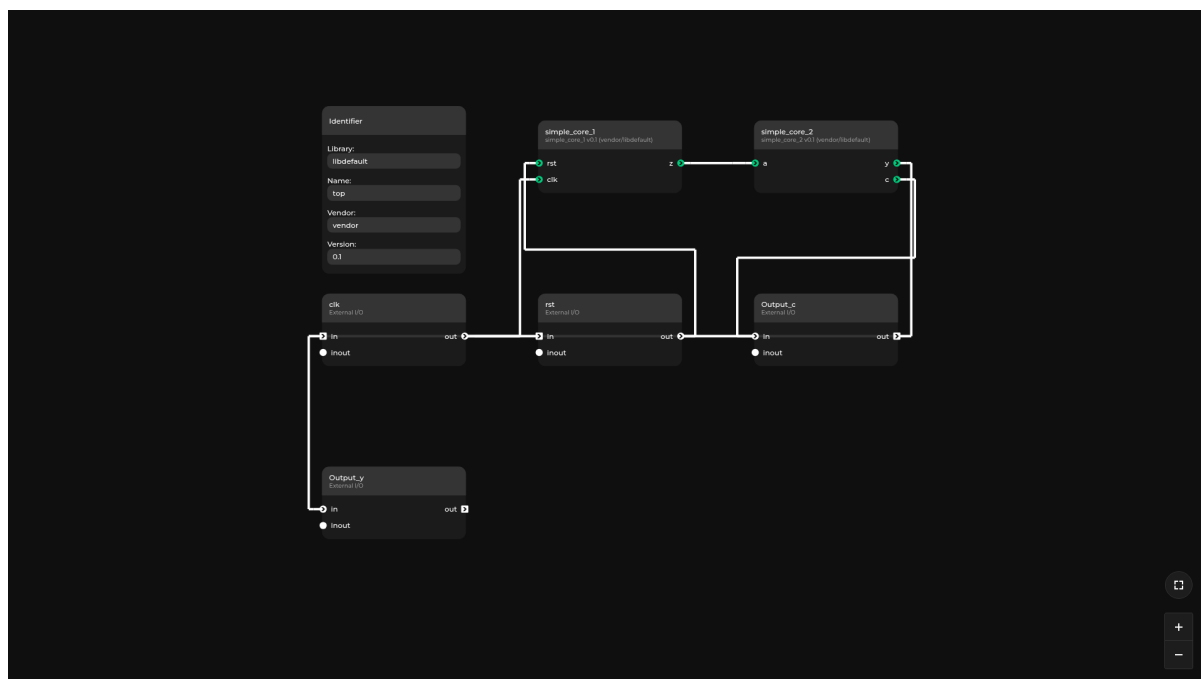
The purpose of this chapter is to provide a step by step guide on how to create a simple design with Topwrap. All the necessary files needed to follow this guide are in the [examples/getting_started_demo](#) directory.

Important

If you haven't installed Topwrap yet, go to the [Installation chapter](#).

3.1 Design overview

We are going to create a design that will be visually represented in an [interactive GUI](#), as seen below.



It consists of two cores: `simple_core_1` and `simple_core_2` that connect to each other and to an external input/output.

Note: Metanodes are always utilized in designs to represent external input/output ports,

module hierarchy ports or constant values. They can be found in the “Metanode” section.

3.2 Packaging Verilog sources

The cores directory contains two Verilog files, `simple_core_1.v` and `simple_core_2.v`. Topwrap can automatically scan them and create the necessary IP description files using topwrap package:

```
topwrap package cores/simple_core_1.v --output cores
topwrap package cores/simple_core_2.v --output cores
```

This is the most basic way of using topwrap, and we can now start building systems.

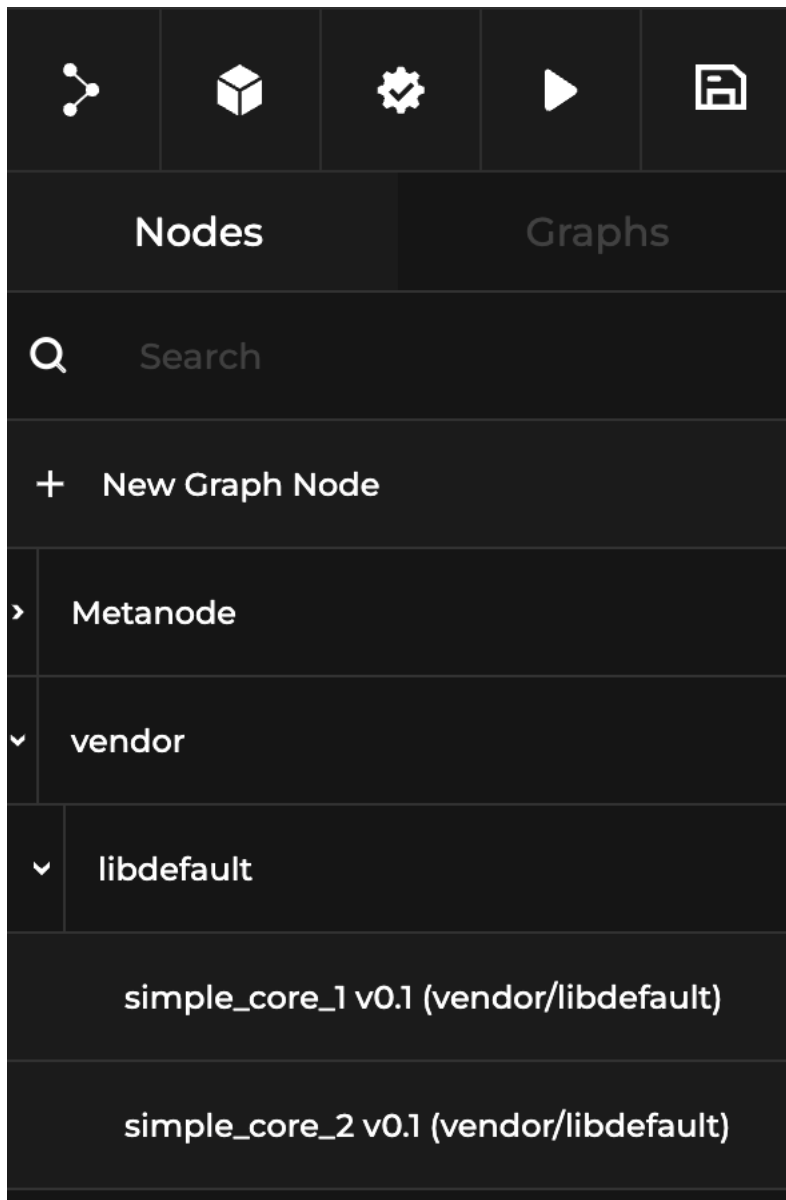
3.3 Building designs with Topwrap

3.3.1 Creating the design

The previously parsed source files can be loaded into the GUI with:

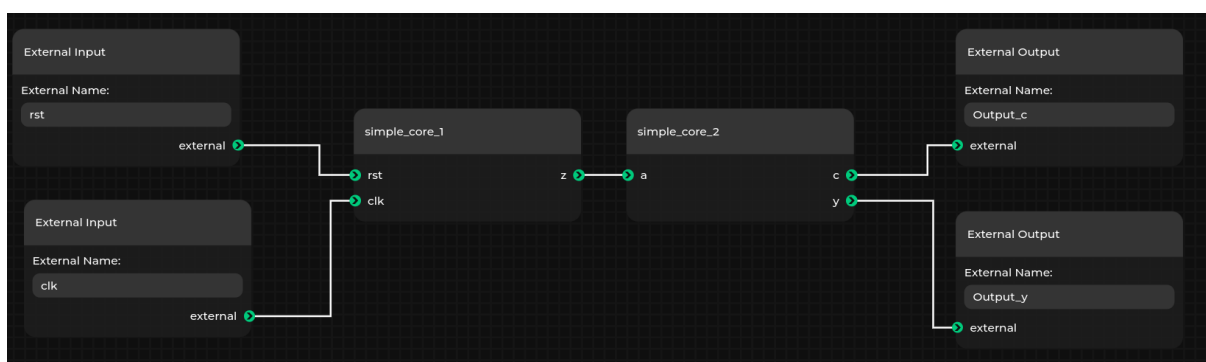
```
topwrap gui cores/simple_core_1.yaml cores/simple_core_2.yaml
```

The loaded IP cores can be found in the IPcore section:



With these IP cores and default metanodes, you can easily create designs by dragging and connecting cores.

Let's make the design from the demo in the [introduction](#).



Note: You can change the name of an individual node by right clicking on it and selecting

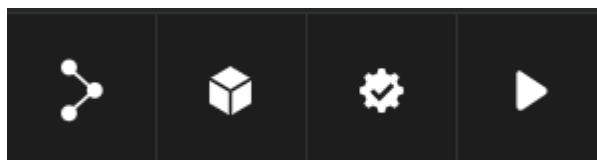
rename. This is useful when creating multiple instances of the same IP core.

You can save the design using the `Save graph file` option from the menu. This will create a **graph JSON format** file used by the GUI. This is essentially a snapshot of everything that you created in the editor and can be loaded back later.

Alternatively, you can save the design into a **design description** YAML file by using the `Save file` option from the menu. When using this option, in addition to downloading the design YAML file, Topwrap will also create an additional **positions YAML** file describing the node positions. This file, along with a copy of the design YAML, will be saved in a new subdirectory in the directory topwrap gui was run from. The positions YAML file will be referenced from the saved design YAML file (via the `positions` property), and Topwrap will automatically attempt to load it next time you open the design.

3.3.2 Generating Verilog in the GUI

You can generate Verilog from the design created in the previous section if you have the example running as described in the previous section. On the top bar, these four buttons are visible:



1. Save/Load designs.
2. Toggle the node browser.
3. Validate the design.
4. Build the design. If it does not contain errors, a top module will be created in the directory where topwrap gui was run.

3.4 Command-line flow

3.4.1 Creating designs

The manual creation of designs requires familiarity with the **Design Description** format.

First, include all the IP core files needed in the `ips` section.

```
ips:
  simple_core_1:
    file: cores/simple_core_1.yaml
  simple_core_2:
    file: cores/simple_core_2.yaml
```

Now we can start creating the design by defining connections in the `connections.ports` section. In the demo example, there is only one connection - between `simple_core_1` and `simple_core_2`.

In our design, it is represented like this:

```
connections:
  ports:
    simple_core_2:
      a: [simple_core_1, z]
```

All that is left to do is to declare external ports, like this:

```
external:
  ports:
    in:
      - rst
      - clk
    out:
      - Output_y
      - Output_c
```

Now connect them to IP cores.

```
connections:
  ports:
    simple_core_1:
      clk: clk
      rst: rst
    simple_core_2:
      a: [simple_core_1, z]
      c: Output_c
      y: Output_y
```

The final design:

```
ips:
  simple_core_1:
    file: cores/simple_core_1.yaml
  simple_core_2:
    file: cores/simple_core_2.yaml
connections:
  ports:
    simple_core_1:
      clk: clk
      rst: rst
    simple_core_2:
      a: [simple_core_1, z]
      c: Output_c
      y: Output_y
external:
  ports:
    in:
      - rst
      - clk
    out:
      - Output_y
```

(continues on next page)

(continued from previous page)

- Output_c

3.4.2 Generating Verilog top files

To generate the top file, use `topwrap generate` and provide the design. To do this, ensure you are in the `examples/getting_started_demo` directory and run:

```
topwrap generate {design_name.yaml}
```

Where `{design_name.yaml}` is the design saved at the end of the previous section. This generates a `top.sv` SystemVerilog top wrapper in the target directory (`./build/src` by default).

3.4.3 Generating IPXACT 2022 files

To generate IP-XACT 2022 files from a design, use `topwrap generate --ipxact`:

```
topwrap generate --ipxact {design_name.yaml}
```

By default the generated files are written to the `build/src` directory. Change the parent directory with the `--target-dir` argument. Use `--iface-compliance` to force interface compliance checking.

See *Backends* for details on the backend driving this command.

3.4.4 Synthesis & FuseSoC

You can additionally generate a *FuseSoC core* file during `topwrap generate` to automate further synthesis and implementation by adding `--fusesoc`. The command also accepts `--part` for the FPGA part and repeatable `--sources` directories containing additional HDL or constraint sources.

3.4.5 Logging

Topwrap uses Python's built-in logging module. By default, logging is configured with the `INFO` level. The default can be changed using the `--log-level` option:

```
topwrap --log-level DEBUG generate {design_name.yaml}
```

3.5 Using libraries

So far, the IP cores in this guide were referenced directly by their YAML files with `file:`. Once you have cores you want to reuse across multiple designs or projects, it is more convenient to register them as a library and reference them by name with `core:` instead.

A library is a directory (or git repository) of CAPI2 `.core` files, as we are leveraging the FuseSoC package management infrastructure. To also add those extra files, just add `--lib` to `topwrap` package:

```
topwrap package --lib cores/simple_core_1.v --output cores
topwrap package --lib cores/simple_core_2.v --output cores
```

This writes `simple_core_1.core` and `simple_core_2.core` next to the YAML files, which is all that's needed to register the directory as a library:

```
topwrap library add mycores cores/
```

You can check what the registered library provides with:

```
topwrap library list all
```

With the library registered, a design can reference a module by name instead of a file path:

```
ips:
  simple_core_1:
    core: simple_core_1
  simple_core_2:
    core: simple_core_2
```

The main advantage of libraries is sharing: since a library can be a git repository, a set of cores can be published once and reused across as many projects as needed, simply by registering the same URL wherever it is needed, instead of copying files around. In our example you would push the library into a repository and then use it:

```
topwrap library add antmicro https://github.com/antmicro.com/topwrap-cores
```

See the [Libraries](#) chapter for the full picture, including versioning and interface definitions.

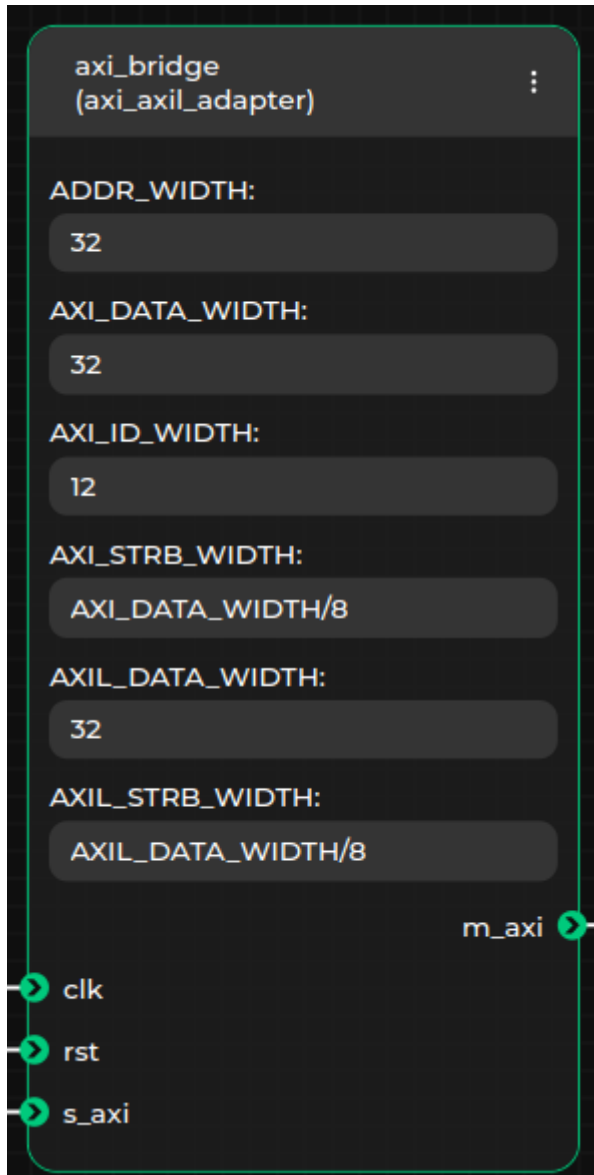
ADVANCED OPTIONS

This chapter builds upon the content covered in the *Getting started* chapter. If you have not yet reviewed it, we recommend doing so before proceeding.

4.1 Creating block designs in the GUI

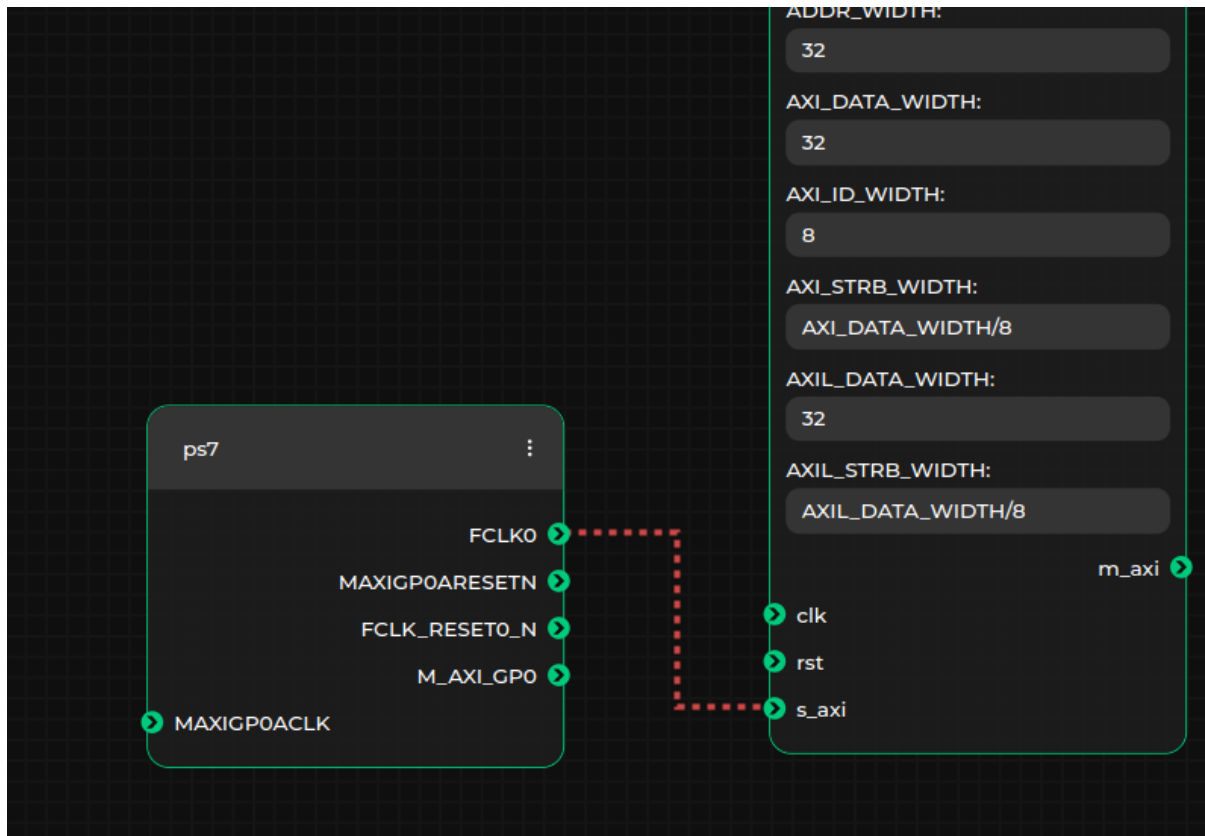
Upon successfully connecting to the server, Topwrap will generate and transmit a specification describing the structure of the selected IP cores. If the `-d` option is specified, the design will be displayed in the GUI. The following content is based on the PWM example located in `examples/pwm`. From this point, you can create or modify designs by:

- adjusting the parameter values of IP cores. Each node includes input fields where you can specify parameter values (default values are automatically assigned when an IP core is added to the block design):

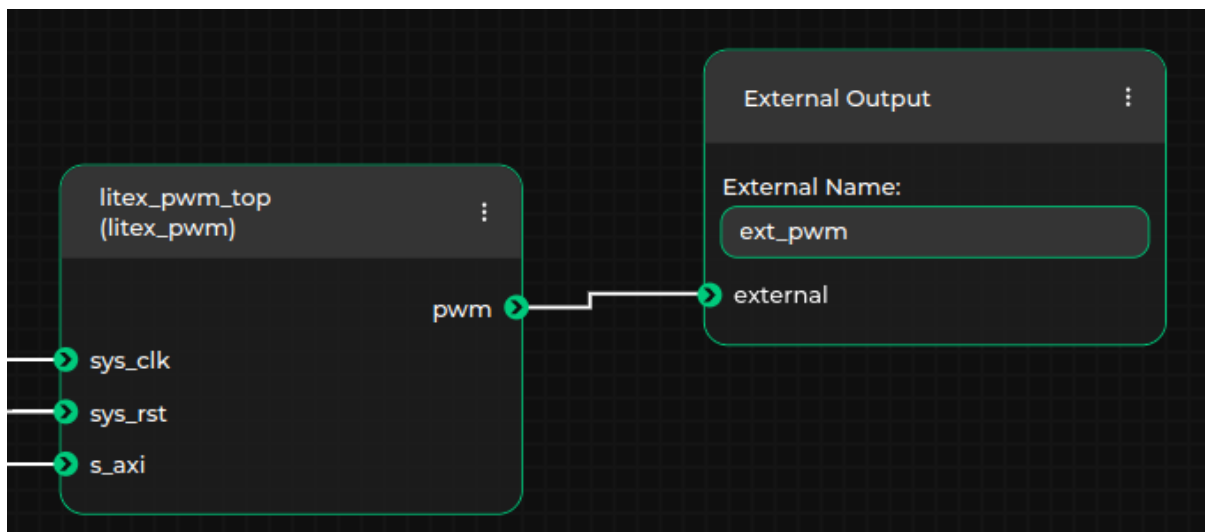


Parameter values can be specified as integers in various bases (e.g., 0x28, 40, or 0b101000) or as arithmetic expressions, which will be evaluated later (e.g., $(AXI_DATA_WIDTH + 1) / 4$ is a valid expression, provided a parameter named `AXI_DATA_WIDTH` exists in the same IP core). Additionally, parameter values can be written in Verilog format (e.g., 8'b00011111 or 8'h1F), in which case they will be interpreted as fixed-width bit vectors

- connecting the ports and interfaces of IP cores. Only connections between ports or interfaces of matching types are allowed. This is automatically validated by the GUI, which uses the type information from the loaded specification. As a result, the GUI will prevent users from making invalid connections (e.g., connecting AXI4 with AXI4Lite, or connecting a port to an interface). A green line will indicate a valid connection, while a red line will indicate an invalid one:



- specifying external ports or interfaces in the top module. To do this, add the appropriate External Input, External Output, or External Inout metanodes, and establish connections between these metanodes and the desired ports or interfaces. Ensure that the name of the external port or interface is updated in the textbox within the selected metanode. For example, in the case where the output pwm port of the `litex_pwm_top` IP core is external to the generated top module, the external port name should be set to `ext_pwm`, as shown below:



An example block design in the Topwrap GUI for the PWM project may look like this:

SAMPLE PROJECTS

These projects demonstrate how to use Topwrap on a practical level, with examples based on a variety of useful designs.

5.1 Embedded GUI

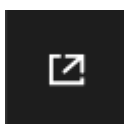
This section extensively uses an embedded version of **Topwrap's GUI** to visualize the design of all the examples.

You can use it to explore designs, while adding new blocks, connections, nodes and hierarchies.

The features that require direct connection with Topwrap's backend are not implemented in this demo version, including:

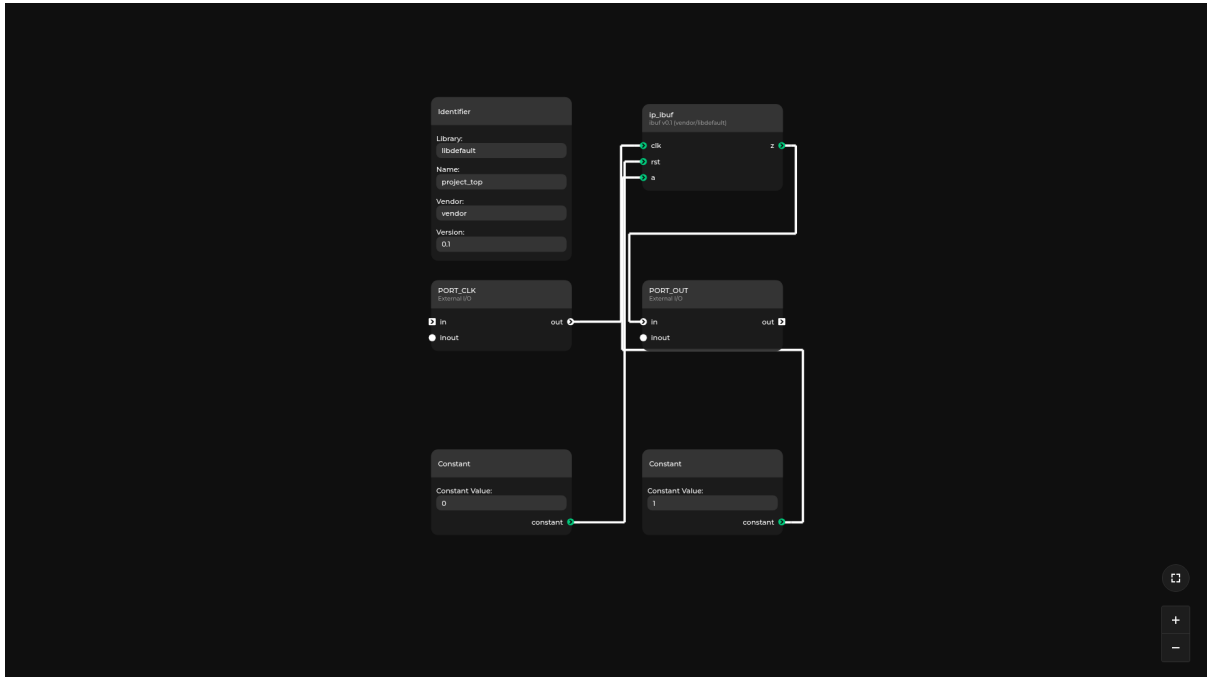
- saving and loading data in .yaml files
- building designs
- verifying designs

Tip: Don't forget to use the "Enable fullscreen" button if the viewport is too small.



5.2 Constant

[Link to source](#)



This example shows how to assign a constant value to a port in an IP core. You can see it in the GUI by using the interactive preview functionality. It is also visible in the description file (project.yaml).

Tip: You can find the constant node blueprint in the nodes browser within the Metanode section.

5.2.1 Usage

Switch to the subdirectory with the example:

```
cd examples/constant
```

Generate the HDL source:

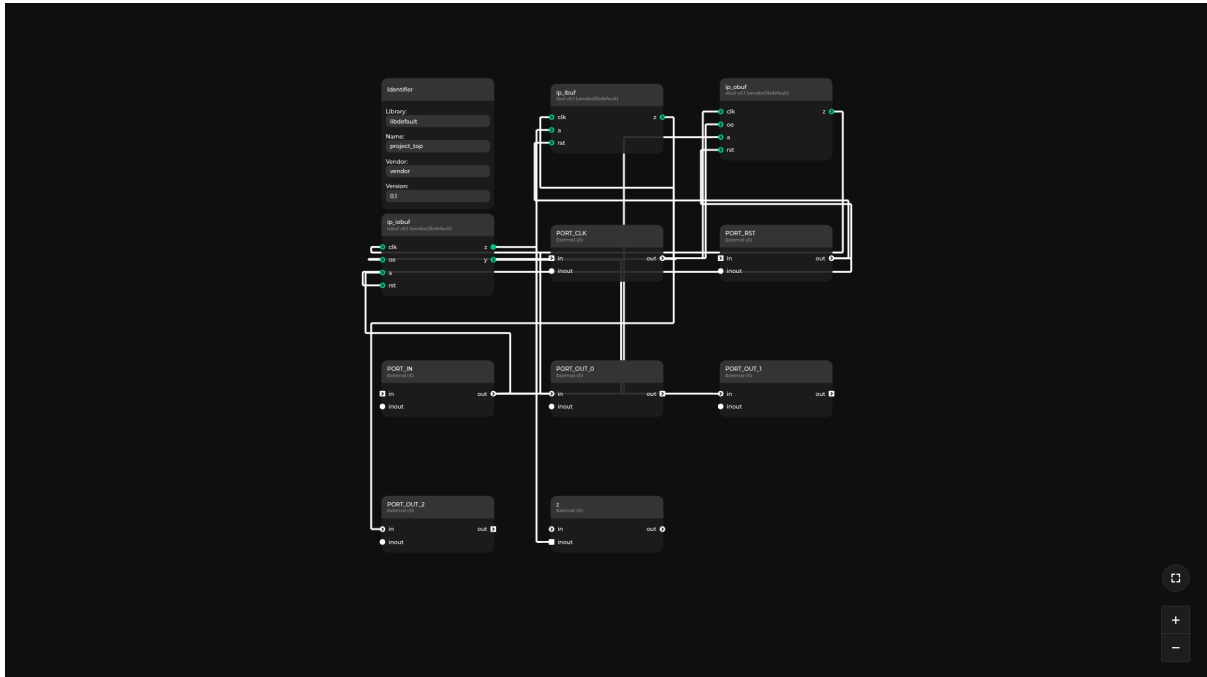
```
make generate
```

Extract an *IP description file* describing the design's top module:

```
make extract
```

5.3 Inout

[Link to source](#)



This example showcases the usage of an inout port and its representation in the GUI.

Tip: An inout port is marked in the GUI by a green circle without a directional arrow inside.

The design consists of 3 modules: input buffer `iobuf`, output buffer `obuf`, and bidirectional buffer `iobuf`. Their operation can be described as:

- the input buffer is a synchronous D-type flip flop with an asynchronous reset
- the output buffer is a synchronous D-type flip flop with an asynchronous reset and an output enable, which sets the output to a high impedance state (Hi-Z)
- the inout buffer instantiates 1 input and 1 output buffer. The input of the `iobuf` and output of the `obuf` are connected with an inout wire (port).

5.3.1 Usage

Switch to the subdirectory with the example:

```
cd examples/inout
```

Install the required dependencies:

```
pip install -r requirements.txt
```

Or using **uv**:

```
uv pip install -r requirements.txt
```

To generate the bitstream for Zynq, use:

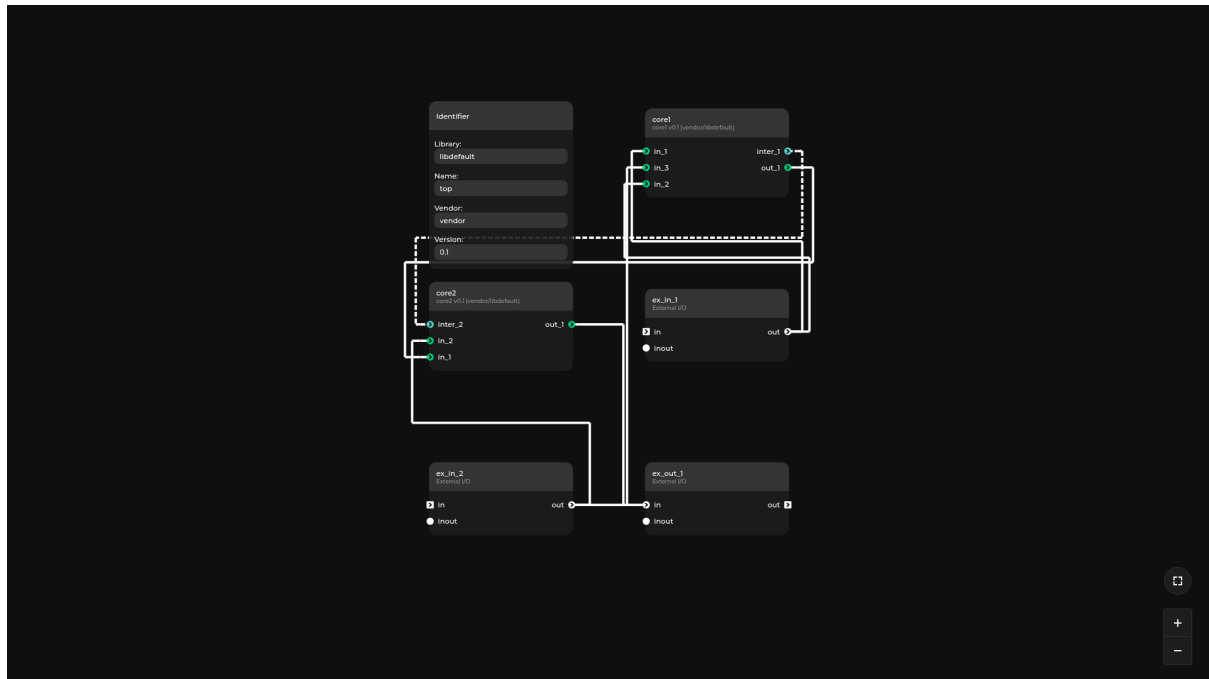
```
make
```

To generate only the HDL sources use:

```
make generate
```

User repository

Link to source



This example presents the structure of a user repository containing prepackaged IP cores with sources and custom interface definitions.

Elements of the repo directory can be easily reused in different designs by linking to them from the config file or in the CLI.

See also:

For more information about user repositories see [this chapter](#).

Tip: As other components of the design are automatically imported from the repository, it's possible to load the entire example by specifying the design file:

```
topwrap gui -d project.yml
```

5.3.2 Usage

Navigate to the `/examples/user_repository/` directory and run:

```
topwrap gui -d project.yml
```

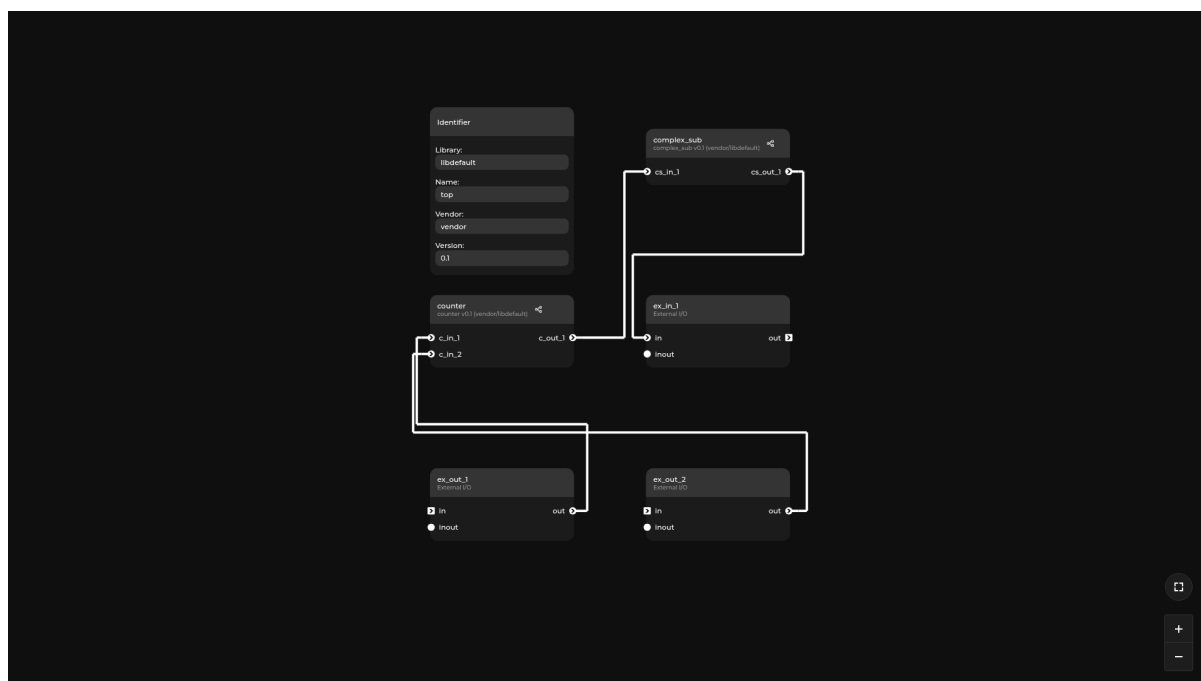
Expected result

Topwrap will load two cores from the cores directory, using the interface from the interfaces directory.

In the Nodes browser under IPcore, two loaded cores: core1 and core2, should be visible.

5.4 Hierarchy

[Link to source](#)



This example shows how to create a hierarchical design in Topwrap, including a hierarchy that contains IP cores as well as other nested hierarchies.

Check out `project.yml` to learn how the above design translates to a *design description file*

See also:

For more information, see the section on *Hierarchies*.

Tip: Hierarchies are represented in the GUI by nodes with a green header. To display inner designs, click the `Edit subgraph` option from the context menu.

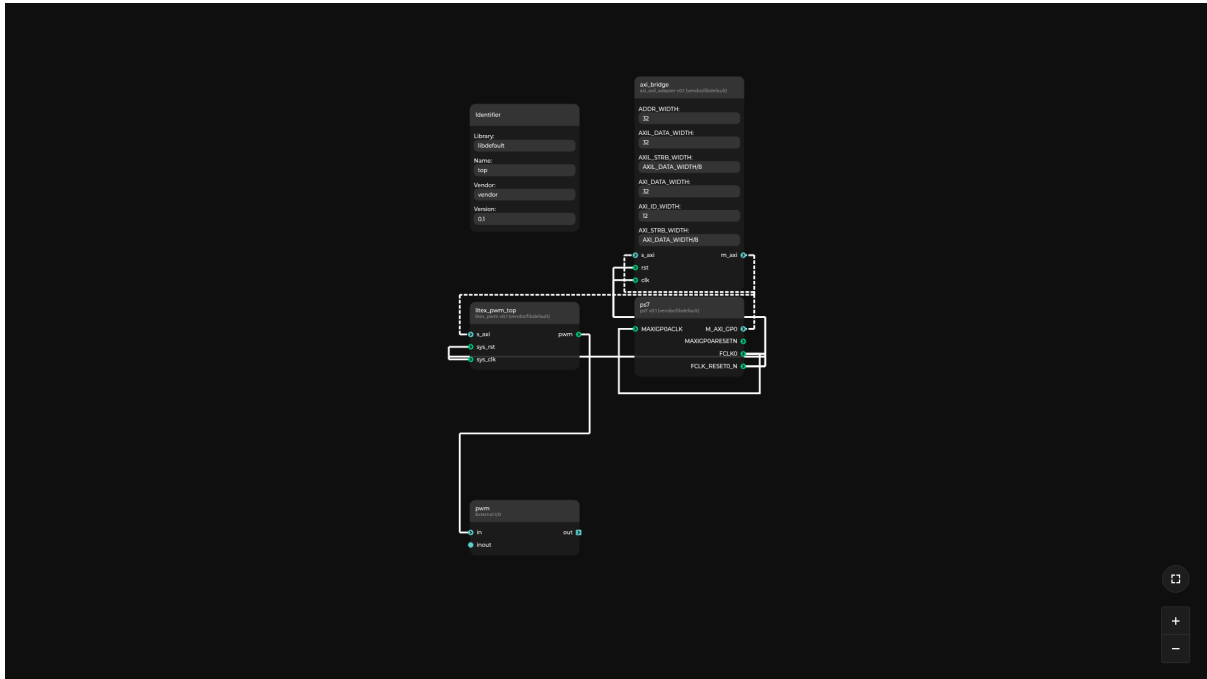
To exit from the hierarchy subgraph, use the back arrow button on the top left. To add a new hierarchy node, use the `New Graph Node` option in the node browser.

5.4.1 Usage

```
topwrap gui -d project.yaml
```

5.5 PWM

[Link to source](#)



Tip: The IP core in the center of the design (axi_axil_adapter) showcases how IP cores with overridable parameters are represented in the GUI.

This is an example of an AXI-mapped PWM IP core that can be generated with LiteX, connected to the ZYNQ Processing System. The core uses the AXILite interface, so a AXI -> AXILite converter is needed. You can access its registers starting from address 0x4000000 (the base address of AXI_GP0 on ZYNQ). The generated signal can be used in a FPGA or connected to a physical port on a board.

Note: To connect I/O signals to specific FPGA pins, you must use mappings in a constraints file. See zynq.xdc used in the setup and modify it accordingly.

5.5.1 Usage

Switch to the subdirectory with the example:

```
cd examples/pwm
```

Install the required dependencies:

```
pip install -r requirements.txt
```

Or using recommended **uv**:

```
uv pip install -r requirements.txt
```

Note: In order to generate a bitstream, install **Vivado** and add it to the PATH.

To generate bitstream for Zynq, use:

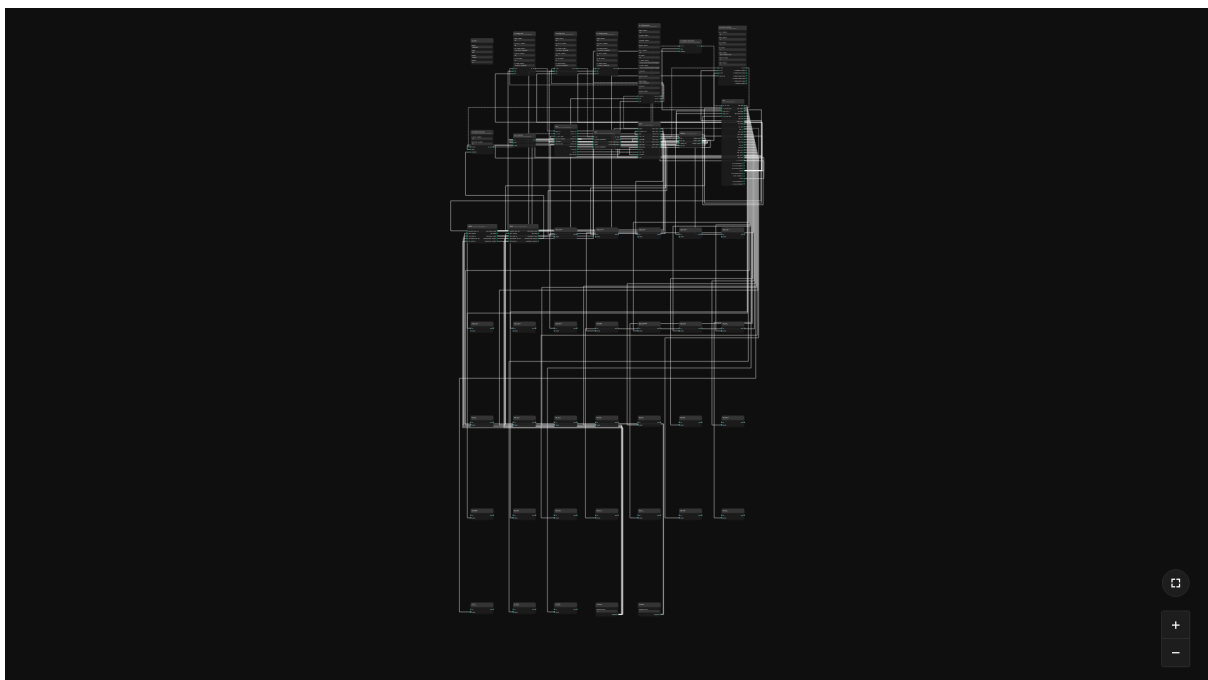
```
make
```

To generate HDL sources without running Vivado, use:

```
make generate
```

5.6 HDMI

[Link to source](#)



This is an example of how to use Topwrap to build a complex and synthesizable design.

5.6.1 Usage

Switch to the subdirectory with the example:

```
cd examples/hdmi
```

Install the required dependencies:

```
pip install -r requirements.txt
```

Or using recommended **uv**:

```
uv pip install -r requirements.txt
```

Note: In order to generate a bitstream, install Vivado and add it to the PATH.

Generate bitstream for desired target

Snickerdoodle Black:

```
make snickerdoodle
```

Zynq Video Board:

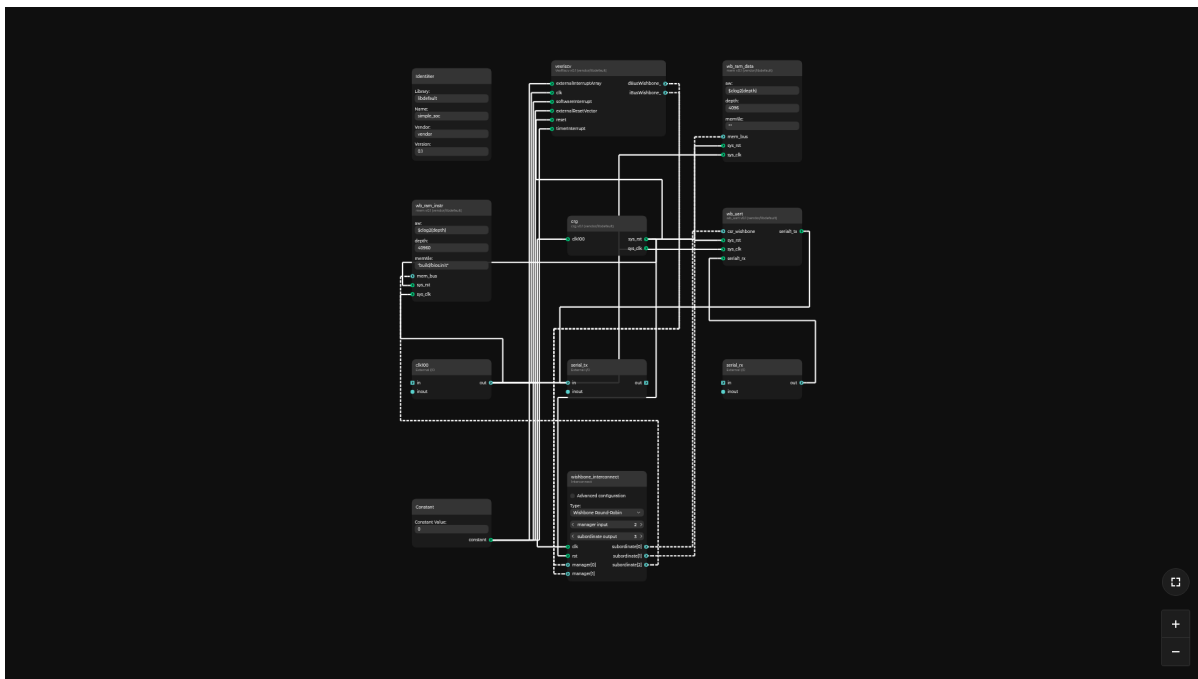
```
make zvb
```

To generate HDL sources without running Vivado, use:

```
make generate
```

5.7 SoC

[Link to source](#)



This example is SoC that has an RISC-V processor, memory, and a UART connected by Wishbone interconnect. Wishbone interconnect has source or can be generated by Topwrap, it enables to compare generated interconnect with existing source code. This example can be run in a simulator such as Verilator. To run this example, the RISC-V 64-bit toolchain and Verilator simulator need to be installed.

5.7.1 Usage

Switch to the subdirectory with the example:

```
cd examples/soc
```

Install the required dependencies:

```
sudo apt install git make g++ ninja-build gcc-riscv64-unknown-elf bsdxtrutils
```

Note: To run the simulation, you need:

- verilator

To create and load the bitstream, use:

- **Vivado** (preferably version 2020.2).
- openFPGALoader (**branch**)

Generate HDL sources:

```
make generate
```

Build and run the simulation:

```
make sim
```

The expected waveform generated by the simulation is shown in `expected-waveform.svg`. Generated waveforms by simulation are present in `build/inter-topwrap` for interconnect generated by topwrap, and `build/inter-source` for interconnect from source.

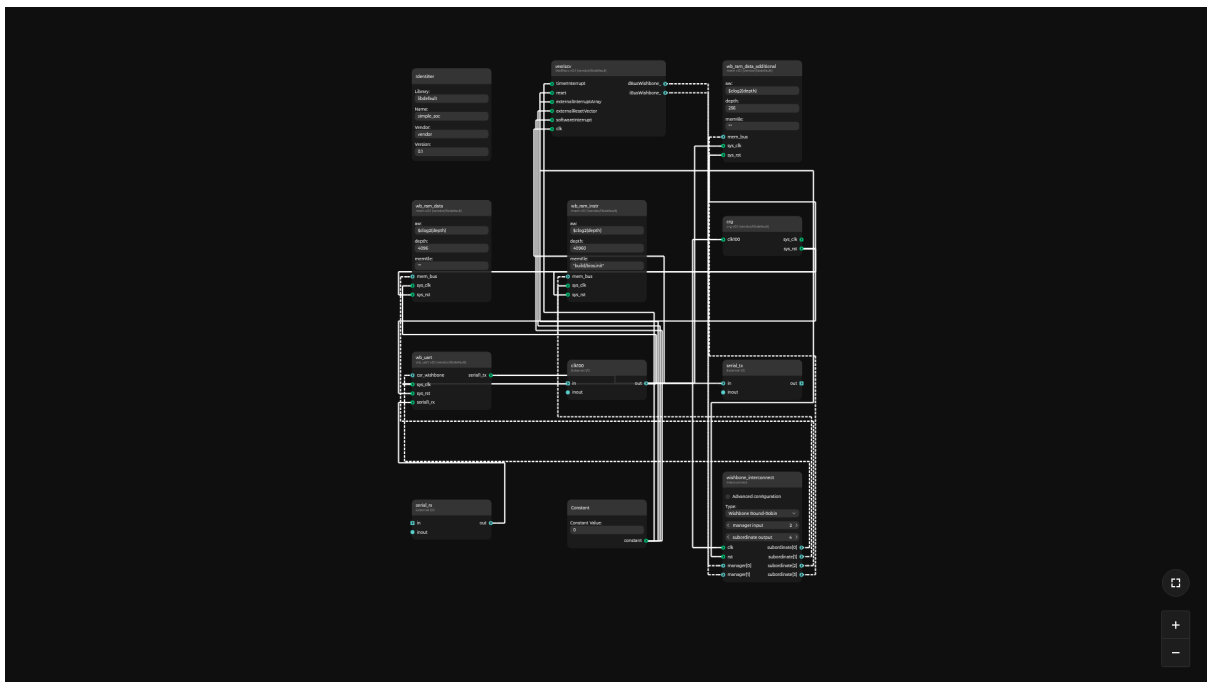
Generate the bitstream:

```
make bitstream
```

Note: For generate, `sim` and `bitstream` targets there also targets with suffix `-inter-topwrap` and `-inter-source`, they can be used to generate HDL sources, simulate or generate the bitstream using topwrap generated or from source interconnect.

5.8 Memory Map

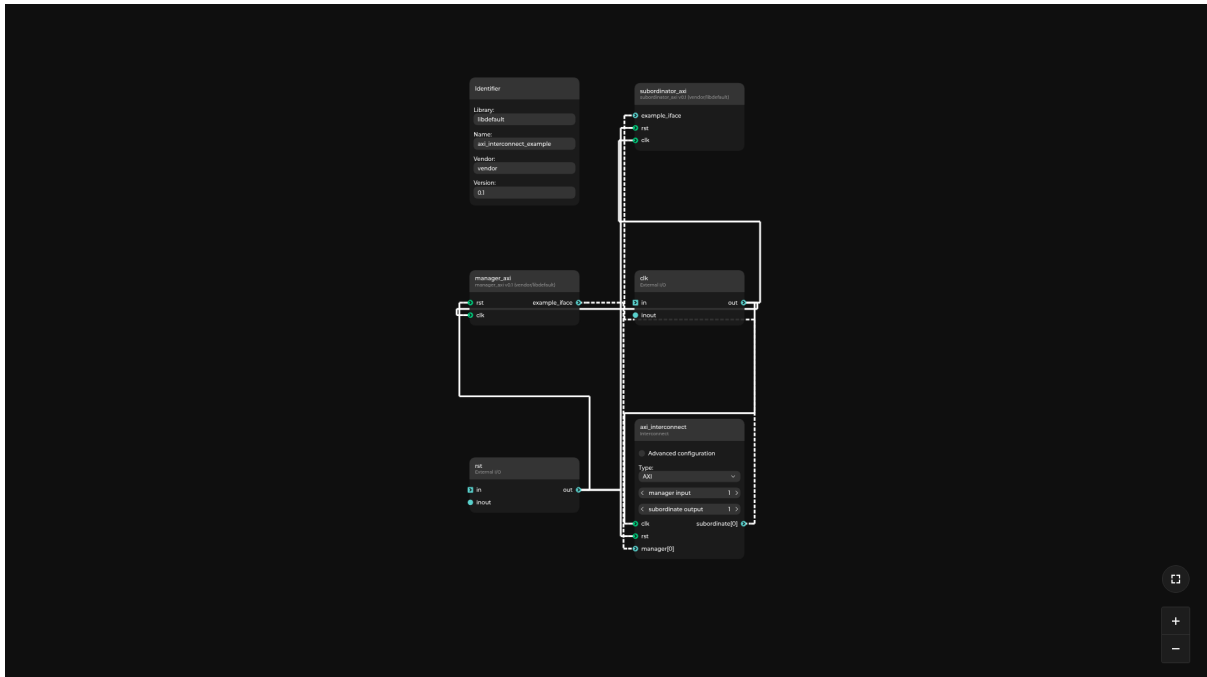
[Link to source](#)



This example is based on the SoC example and it uses memory maps instead of the subordinates section in the interconnect. The repository contains hand-edited yaml files with the interface size specified for the `wb_uart` module. Refer to the *Description Files* and the *Interconnect Generation* for more information about memory maps.

5.9 AXI interconnect

[Link to source](#)



This example has one subordinator and one manager connected to each other using AXI4 interconnect generated by Topwrap. It is mainly used for checking if AXI4 interconnect generated by Topwrap is working in simulation. Similar examples that focus more on interconnect representation in Topwrap can be found in *ir_examples*

5.9.1 Usage

Switch to the subdirectory with the example:

```
cd examples/axi_interconnect
```

To generate HDL sources, use:

```
make generate
```

To run simulation using Verilator and generate wave.vcd use:

```
make sim
```

5.9.2 IPXACT

[Link to source](#)

This example contains IP-XACT 2022 files as sources. It shows how to use *IpXactFrontend* to parse IP-XACT sources into a Topwrap repo.

5.9.3 Usage

```
cd examples/ipxact
```

To generate the HDL top file, use:

```
make generate
```

5.9.4 Existing interface definition

[Link to source](#)

This example showcases how Topwrap behaves when there is existing interface definition present in HDL files.

5.9.5 Usage

```
cd examples/existing_iface
```

To generate the HDL top file, use:

```
make generate
```

CREATING A DESIGN

This chapter explains how to create a design in Topwrap, including a detailed overview of how Topwrap design files are structured.

6.1 Design description

To create a complete and fully synthesizable design, a design file is needed. It is used for:

- specifying IP cores and their parameters
- specifying interconnects
- describing hierarchies for the project
- connecting the IPs and hierarchies
- defining design interfaces and ports

You can see example design files in the examples directory. The structure of the design file is shown below:

```
name: {design_name} # optional name of the toplevel

ips:
  # specify relations between IPs instance names in the
  # design yaml and IP cores description YAMLS
  {ip1_instance_name}:
    # exactly one of `file` or `core` identifies the IP core description
    file: {resource_path} # see "Resource path syntax" section for more_
    ↪information
    core: {vlnv}           # a module from a registered library, see "Libraries"
    parameters: # specify IP parameter values to be overridden
      {parameters_name} : {parameters_value}
    ...
  clocks:
    {module_clock_name}: {domain_name}
  resets:
    {module_reset_name}: {domain_name}
  ...

connections:
```

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```
ports:
# specify the incoming ports connections of an IP named `ip1_name`
{ip1_name}:
    {port1_name} : [{ip2_name}, {port2_name}]
    # connections between modules can be (bit-wise) inverted
    {port3_name} : ~[{ip2_name}, {port4_name}]
    ...
# specify the incoming ports connections of a hierarchy named `hier_name`
{hier_name}:
    {port1_name} : [{ip_name}, {port2_name}]
    ...
# specify the external port connections
{ip_instance_name}:
    {port_name} : ext_port_name
    # connections to external ports can be (bit-wise) inverted
    {other_port_name} : ~other_ext_port_name
    ...

interfaces:
# specify the incoming interface connections of the `ip1_name` IP
{ip1_name}:
    {interface1_name} : [{ip2_name}, {interface2_name}]
    ...
# specify the incoming interface connections of the `hier_name` hierarchy
{hier_name}:
    {interface1_name} : [{ip_name}, {interface2_name}]
    ...
# specify the external interface connections
{ip_instance_name}:
    {interface_name} : ext_interface_name
    ...

interconnects:
# see the "Interconnect generation" page for a detailed description of the_
↪format
...

clock_domains:
default:
    signal: [{ip_name}, {port_name}]
{other_domain_name}:
    signal: [{ip_name}, {port_name}]
{another_domain_name}:
    signal: {external_port_name}
...

reset_domains:
default:
    signal: [{ip_name}, {port_name}]
```

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```

    polarity: active high
  {other_domain_name}:
    signal: [{ip_name}, {port_name}]
    polarity: active low
  {another_domain_name}:
    signal: {external_port_name}
    polarity: active low
    synchronous_to: default
  ...

external: # specify the names of external ports and interfaces of the top module
ports:
  out:
    - name: {ext_port_name}
      bound: [[dim0_high, dim1_low], ..., [dimN_high, dimN, low]]
  inout:
    - [{ip_name/hierarchy_name, port_name}]
interfaces:
  in:
    - {ext_interface_name}
  # note that `inout:` is invalid in the interfaces section

hierarchies:
  # see "Hierarchies" below for a detailed description of the format
  ...

memory_maps:
  {memory_map_name}: # this name is referenced in an interconnect
  {instance_name}: # component instance reference
    {interface_name1}: # interface of component
      address: {address1}
      {additional_parameter_name}: {value_accepted_by_an_interconnect_
↪implementation} # additional parameters for specific interconnects can be_
↪specified
      ...
    {interface_name2}:
      address: {address2}
      size: {size2} # a default size can be overwritten
      ...
    {instance_name}: # when an instance has only one interface, it is not_
↪required to specify the interface name
      address: {address1}

config: # override global configuration settings (optional)
  force_interface_compliance: {true/false}
  repositories:
    {repo_name}: {repo_source}

positions: path/to/positions.yaml

```

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```
extensions: # plugin-specific settings
  {plugin_setting_scope}: ...
```

inout ports are handled differently than the in and out ports. When an IP has an inout port or when a hierarchy has an inout port specified in its `external.ports.inout` section, it must be included in the `external.ports.inout` section of the parent design. It is required to specify the name of the IP/hierarchy and the port name that contains it. The name of the external port is identical to the one in the IP core. In case of duplicate names, a suffix `$n` is added (where `n` is a natural number) to the name of the second and subsequent duplicate names. inout ports cannot be connected to each other.

The design description YAML format allows for creating hierarchical designs. In order to create a hierarchy, add its name as a key in the `hierarchies` section and describe the hierarchy design “recursively” by using the same keys and values (ports, parameters etc.) as in the top-level design (see above). Hierarchies can be nested recursively, which means that you can create a hierarchy inside another one.

Note that IPs and hierarchies names cannot be duplicated on the same hierarchy level, as each entry in `hierarchies` is treated as equal with entries in `ips`.

Additionally, designs can contain clock and reset domains. These domains allow for automatic wiring of clock and reset inputs of IP cores, and performing sanity checks for interface connections. Domains reference a port that acts as the source. This may be either a module port (for example from a PLL instance), or an external port.

Additionally, reset domains contain information about the reset signal’s polarity and whether it’s synchronous to some domain or asynchronous. The polarity may be either active low or active high. The synchronicity is specified via the `synchronous_to` key, which can be null/omitted if asynchronous, or otherwise specifies the name of a clock domain.

When instantiating IP cores, their clocks and resets can be assigned to domains via the `clocks` and `resets` keys. If a domain is not assigned explicitly, the clock/reset signal is implicitly assigned to the corresponding default domain.

For reset connections, Topwrap will automatically invert connections between resets of different polarities. For resets that don’t have the same synchronicity, an error is raised describing the problem.

The `config` option allows the design to override *configuration settings* using the same syntax as in the configuration files. This includes the list of repositories to load. Topwrap pre-parses the design document before fetching repositories, so the settings placed are picked up before the design is evaluated.

The optional `positions` property allows specifying a path to the `positions` YAML file for this design (see below). The specified path, if relative, will be checked both in the directory Topwrap was launched from, and in the directory the design YAML is in. If the `positions` YAML file is present, it will automatically be loaded alongside the design YAML file.

The `extensions` property allows the design to optionally configure settings for any *plugins* that are loaded. These settings are scoped by a label `{plugin_setting_scope}`. Every plugin supports zero or more of these setting-scopes. How these settings are interpreted depends on the plugin and should be specified as part of the plugin’s own documentation. For example, an *imaginary* plugin that checks the spelling of port names could possibly require these settings:

```
extensions:
  spelling:
    dictionary: "../path/to/dict.txt"
```

Here, spelling is the setting-scope and the key-value pair { dictionary: ... } is the setting-scope's value.

6.1.1 Hierarchies

Hierarchies allow for creating designs with subgraphs in them. The subgraphs can contain multiple IP cores and other subgraphs, allowing for the creation of nested designs in Topwrap.

6.1.2 Format

Hierarchies are specified in the *design description*. The hierarchies key must be a direct descendant of the design key.

The format is as follows:

```
hierarchies:
  {hierarchy_name_1}:
    # Design description, see above
    ...
```

A more complex example of a hierarchy can be found in the [examples/hierarchy](#) directory.

6.2 IP description files

The primary purpose of the IP core YAML is to provide the tool with essential metadata and structural information about a specific IP core to facilitate automated SoC assembly. It contains information about signals, clock domains, parameterization and interfaces. Interfaces are defined as a list of signals and parameters such as mode and type.

Such a file can be handwritten, or generated from an existing *design description* using the `topwrap extract` command, which describes the design's top module as a reusable IP core:

```
topwrap extract --design design.yaml
```

See the *Constant example* for a runnable usage of this command.

Warning: `topwrap extract` only captures the top module's external signals, interfaces, clocks, resets and parameters - it does not preserve internal hierarchy. If the design's top module is itself composed of sub-instances (via hierarchies/ips), that internal composition (instances, sub-hierarchies, internal connections) is not included in the generated IP description; the design is reduced to a single black-box IP core described only by what's externally visible. If you need to preserve the internal structure, use the *design description* format instead (the output of `topwrap build`), which does capture instances and connections.

The example below presents an example IP YAML core description file.

```
id:
  library: libdefault
  name: axi4_to_ahb
  vendor: vendor

parameters:
  RESET_ADDRESS: 32'h80000000

signals:
  in:
    - sys_clk
    - sys_rst
    - name: core_id
      bound: [3, 0]
      default: 0
    - name: wb_req
      type: wb_req_t
  out:
    - core_halted
    - name: wb_resp
      type: wb_resp_t

interfaces:
  ifu_axi:
    type:
      name: AXI4
      vendor: vendor
      library: libdefault
    mode: manager
    # the size field in manager mode is unused by topwrap
    signals:
      out:
        bready: ifu_bready
        awaddr: [ifu_awaddr, 31, 0]
        # ... remainder of AXI signals ...
      in:
        aready: ifu_aready
        rdata: [ifu_rdata, 63, 0]
        # ... remainder of AXI signals ...
  iface1_wb:
    type: wishbone
    mode: subordinate
    size: 0xFFFF # the size field in subordinate mode is optional
    signals:
      # wishbone signals
      addr:
        path: wb_req.addr

types:
```

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```
wb_req_t:
  members:
    - name: cyc
      type: [0, 0]
    - name: addr
      type: ...
    ...
wb_resp_t:
  members:
    ...
existing_iface_definitions:
- library: libdefault
  name: AXI4Lite
  vendor: vendor
  version: '0.1'

extensions: ...
```

6.2.1 File format explanation

- id - identification of the Core. An instance of *Identifier IR class*
 - library - by default libdefault
 - vendor - by default vendor
 - name - same as the name in the HDL file
- parameters - a dictionary with IP core parameters
- signals - contains the names of signals used in the module ports
 - out - a list of signals that are in the output direction
 - in - a list of signals that are in the input direction
 - inout - a list of signals that can be both input and output, similar to an inout port in Verilog
- interfaces - a list of interfaces
 - type - the *ID* of the interface definition that is used for that interface. See the *Interface Definition YAML*.
 - mode - manager, subordinate or unspecified. When generating ports, the mode is used to determine the direction of the port. unspecified behaves the same as manager. When doing inference, all newly created interfaces have their type set to unspecified.
 - size - the optional field that is only used when mode is subordinate, it is used when there is an instance of this module specified in address_maps in the design YAML.
 - signals - a list of signals mapped to ports. Signals from the interface definition need to be mapped to ports in the HDL module.
 - clock - (optional) name of the clock input this interface is synchronous to.

- reset - (optional) name of the reset input for this interface.
- types - structure type definitions used by signals (described below in more detail)
 - members - member fields of a struct type.
- existing_iface_definitions - a list of interface definitions that exist in parsed HDL code in form of *IDs*.
- extensions - plugin specific settings, has the same meaning as the extensions-property in *design files*.

Interfaces can also specify which clock and reset input of the IP core they use. This is done via the optional clock and reset keys, which specify the name of the input (see below).

When connecting interfaces that have clock inputs assigned on both sides of the connection, Topwrap will automatically perform sanity checks, and report errors for connections between interfaces that belong to different clock domains.

6.2.2 Signals

Each signal (for both port and interface definitions) can be specified in one of two formats.

New signal format

The signal is defined by a YAML object, with the following properties:

- name (optional) - the name of the signal.
- bound (optional) - the bounds of the signal. The signal can be multidimensional.
- slice (optional) - the bounds of the slice bit range (only applicable to interface definitions).
- default (optional) - default value to assign to this port if nothing is connected to it, applicable only to input ports.
- type (optional) - the name of the type (defined in the types section) used for this signal
- path (optional) - the path to a field to use as the source for this signal

A signal must have either a name or a path specified, but not both at once.

Additionally, path may only be specified for interface signals. For example, a path of `some_port.some_field` describes a signal that uses a subfield of a port. Paths can also describe slices, e.g. `some_port[31:0]` is equivalent to specifying a name of `some_port` and a slice of `[31, 0]`. Paths can use any combination of slicing and field selection operations, e.g. `some_port[3].some_field[1].some_other_field[31:0]`.

A signal may specify bound or type (or neither for a single bit port), but not both at the same time.

Example port definitions using this format:

```
signals:
  in:
    - name: foo
```

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```

    bound: [31, 0]
    default: 32'hDEADBEEF
  - name: bar
    type: some_struct_t

```

Example interface signal definitions using this format:

```

interfaces:
  foo:
    type: AXISStream
    mode: subordinate
    signals:
      in:
        BAR:
          name: bar
          bound: [63, 0]
          slice: [47, 16]
        ...
        BAZ:
          name: BAZ
        QUX:
          path: some_struct_port.qux

```

Old signal format

The signal is defined by either:

- just a name (implied one-bit signal):

```

signals:
  in:
    - foo

```

- an array consisting of the name and the bounds of the bit range:

```

signals:
  in:
    - [foo, 31, 0]

```

- an array consisting of the name, the bounds of the bit range, and the bounds of the slice bit range (only applicable to interface definitions):

```

signals:
  in:
    TDATA: [foo, 63, 0, 47, 16]

```

As an example, this is the description of ports in the Clock Crossing IP:

```

# file: clock_crossing.yaml
name: cdc_flag

```

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```
signals:
  in:
    - clkA
    - A
    - clkB
  out:
    - B
```

Types

IP core YAML files may additionally describe types used by the module's ports in a dedicated section. This is primarily intended to support modules using structure ports.

Each named type is defined in the types section:

```
types:
  my_struct_type_t:
    ...
  my_other_type_t:
    ...
```

Each type is either:

- a two element array describing a bit vector (incl. single bits), e.g. [31, 0] or [0, 0]
- an object with a members describing a struct, described below

The members of a struct are defined in an array of field objects, each of which consists of the following properties:

- name - the name of the field
- type - the type definition for the field

Example struct definition describing AXI output signals:

```
types:
  my_axi_req_t:
    members:
      - name: aw_valid
        type: [0, 0]
      - name: aw
        type:
          members:
            - name: addr
              type: [31, 0]
            ...
      ...
```

6.2.3 Differences between the IP and design formats

The following information is present in the design format, but not in the IP format:

- ips, hierarchies, connections and interconnects and memory_maps
- config
- positions

The following information is present in the IP format, but not in the design format:

- parameters
- types

The mapping between other sections is as follows:

- external/ports corresponds to signals
- external/interfaces corresponds to interfaces
- clock_domains/reset_domains corresponds to clocks/resets
- VLNv fields (vendor, library, name, versions) are packaged into id

Note that in the IP format, the name of the clock/reset signal is specified inside the clocks field and not as a separate port. The same applies to reset specification.

6.2.4 Interface definitions

The purpose of the interface YAML file is to store information about interface definitions. These definitions are used for inferring ports to interface instances. It contains the id of the interface, which is used to reference the definition from the IP core YAML file. The YAML file separates signals into those that are required for a list of ports to be interpreted as this interface and optional signals that, if present, are inferred into a single interface instance.

Regular expressions are used to find ports in the HDL module that correspond to the signals in the interface definition.

```
id
  library: libdefault
  name: wishbone
  vendor: vendor
signals:
  required:
    out:
      cyc: cyc
      stb: stb
    in:
      ack: ack
  optional:
    out:
      dat_w: dat_(w|mosi)|mosi
      adr: adr
      tgd_w: tgd_w
```

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```
lock: lock
sel: sel
tga: tga
tgc: tgc
we: we
cti: cti
bte: bte

in:
  dat_r: dat_(r|miso)|miso
  tgd_r: tgd_r
  stall: stall
  err: err
  rty: rty
```

File format explanation:

- **id** - identification of the interface. An instance of *Identifier IR class*
 - **library** - by default libdefault
 - **vendor** - by default vendor
 - **name** - same as the name in the HDL file
- **signals** - contains the names of signals with regular expressions that are used in the ports of Modules.
 - **required** - contains signals that must be present in the list of ports in the module
 - **optional** - contains signals that are connected to the interface instance when present in the list of ports in the module
 - * **out** - a list of signals that are in the output direction
 - * **in** - a list of signals that are in the input direction
 - * **inout** - a list of signals that can be both the input and the output, similar to an inout port in Verilog

Interfaces can also specify which clock and reset input of the IP core they use. This is done via the optional clock and reset keys, which specify the name of the input (see below).

When connecting interfaces that have clock inputs assigned on both sides of the connection, Topwrap will automatically perform sanity checks, and report errors for connections between interfaces that belong to different clock domains.

6.2.5 Parameterization

Port widths don't have to be hardcoded, as parameters can describe an IP core in a generic way, and values specified in IP core YAMLS can be overridden in a design description file (see [Design description](#)).

```
parameters:
  DATA_WIDTH: 8
  KEEP_WIDTH: (DATA_WIDTH+7)/8
  ID_WIDTH: 8
  DEST_WIDTH: 8
  USER_WIDTH: 1

interfaces:
  s_axis:
    type: AXI4Stream
    mode: subordinate
    signals:
      in:
        TDATA: [s_axis_tdata, DATA_WIDTH-1, 0]
        TKEEP: [s_axis_tkeep, KEEP_WIDTH-1, 0]
        ...
        TID: [s_axis_tid, ID_WIDTH-1, 0]
        TDEST: [s_axis_tdest, DEST_WIDTH-1, 0]
        TUSER: [s_axis_tuser, USER_WIDTH-1, 0]
```

The parameter values can be integers or math expressions.

6.2.6 Clock and reset inputs

IPs can define clock and reset inputs, which allow for automatic connections to clock/reset domains within a design. Each clock/reset specifies a port that is used for it. Additionally, reset inputs specify polarity and synchronicity similarly to reset domains in the design description.

Example clock and reset definition:

```
# Two independent clocks
clocks:
  some_clock:
    signal: some_clock_port
  some_other_clock:
    signal: some_other_clock_port

# Two resets, one synchronous, one asynchronous
resets:
  some_reset:
    signal: some_reset_port
    polarity: active high
    synchronous_to: some_other_clock
  some_other_reset:
    signal: some_other_reset_port
```

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```
polarity: active low
synchronous_to: null
```

In both cases, the `signal` key defines which of the module's ports belongs to this clock/reset. The `polarity` and `synchronous_to` keys are the same as the ones in the design description, with one difference: in IP cores `synchronous_to` references a clock input, not a clock domain.

6.3 Interface definition files

The purpose of the interface definition YAML file is to store information about an interface: it's signals and their directions, whether they're optional, default values, etc. The signals also contain regex patterns used for matching them up to module ports during interface inference.

Example of a (simplified) definition of the Wishbone interface:

```
id:
  name: wishbone
  library: libdefault
  vendor: vendor

signals:
  adr:
    pattern: adr
    manager: [out, required]
  dat_w:
    pattern: mosi|dat_(w|mosi)
    manager: [out, required]
  dat_r:
    pattern: miso|dat_(r|miso)
    manager: [in, required]
  sel:
    pattern: sel
    manager: [out, required]
  cyc:
    pattern: cyc
    manager: [out, required]
  stb:
    pattern: stb
    manager: [out, required]
  we:
    pattern: we
    manager: [out, required]
  ack:
    pattern: ack
    manager: [in, required]
  ...
  tga:
    pattern: tga
    manager: [out, optional]
```

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```
tgc:
  pattern: tgc
  manager: [out, optional]
```

File format explanation:

- `id` - identifier of the interface
- `signals` - dictionary of signals that this interface is comprised of; each item's key is the signal name, and the value is an object with the following keys:
 - `pattern` - the regex pattern used for matching signals to ports during interface inference
 - `manager` - (optional) the signal direction and whether it's optional or required in the manager mode of the interface
 - `subordinate` - (optional) the signal direction and whether it's optional or required in the subordinate mode of the interface
 - `unspecified` - (optional) the signal direction and whether it's optional or required in the unspecified mode of the interface
 - `default` - (optional) the value assigned to the signal if the other side does not contain the signal

For each mode specification, the first value is one of `in`, `out` or `inout`, and the second value is one of `required`, `optional`.

At least one of `manager`, `subordinate` or `unspecified` must be specified for each signal.

If only one of `manager` or `subordinate` is specified, the other is inferred as having an opposite direction and the same optionality. Explicitly specifying both `manager` and `subordinate` allows for specifying the same direction and/or different optionality. If not defined, `unspecified` is inferred to be the same as `manager`.

6.3.1 Interface compliance

During the *build process*, an optional verification of whether the interface instances used in IP cores are compliant with their respective descriptions can be enabled. The verification consists of checking in the instance if:

- all signals designated as required in the description are included.
- no additional signals beyond those defined in the description are included.

This feature is controlled by the `--iface-compliance` CLI flag or the `force_interface_compliance` key in the *configuration file* and is turned off by default.

6.4 Resource path syntax

Fields specified in the YAML file as a “resource path” support extended functionality and have their own specific syntax.

This field type is used for example in the *Design Description* for specifying an IP Core description location:

```
ips:
  ip_inst_name:
    file: {resource path}
...
```

A value with no scheme is a filesystem path, resolved relative to the YAML file it appears in:

```
ips:
  ip_inst_name:
    file: ./my_directory/core.yaml
```

To reach anything else, prefix the value with a scheme:

```
SCHEME[ARG1 | ARG2 ...]: SCHEME_PATH
```

- SCHEME is the scheme of this path (e.g. get for remote resources)
- ARGS are |-separated positional arguments for the specific scheme (e.g. the user repo name for the repo scheme)
 - If there are no arguments to supply you can omit the square brackets entirely
- SCHEME_PATH is the path to the resource interpreted by the specific scheme (e.g. the URL for the get scheme)

6.4.1 Available schemes

- file
 - SCHEME_ARGS: None
 - SCHEME_PATH: A filesystem path relative from the currently edited YAML file to the resource
 - Deprecated since version 1.0.0: Write the path directly, without the file: prefix.
- repo
 - SCHEME_ARGS: Repository name
 - SCHEME_PATH: A name of resource
 - Deprecated since version 1.0.0: The user repository mechanism is being removed. Register the sources as a *library* and reference them with core: instead.
- get
 - SCHEME_ARGS: None

- SCHEME_PATH: The URL address of the remote resource. Only `http(s)://` URLs are currently supported.
- git
 - SCHEME_ARGS:
 1. An optional git ref (branch, tag, or commit SHA) to check out. If omitted, the repository's default branch is used.
 2. An optional subdirectory inside the repository to use as the resolved path.
 - SCHEME_PATH: The URL of a git repository to clone.

Warning: If a repository was injected to the config with the `--repo` CLI option, the name of such repository will be the name of the directory containing it.

6.4.2 Examples

```
./my_directory/file.txt
```

A path to the file on the filesystem, relative to the YAML file it is written in.

```
repo[my_repo]:res.txt
```

This loads the `res.txt` file inside the `my_repo` loaded user repository.

```
get:https://raw.githubusercontent.com/antmicro/topwrap/refs/heads/main/pyproject.  
→toml
```

This loads the remote resource. When necessary, it's automatically downloaded into a temporary directory.

```
git[main]:https://github.com/antmicro/topwrap.git
```

This clones the main branch of the given git repository into a persistent cache directory and uses it as the resource location. Omitting the `[main]` argument checks out the repository's default branch instead. A commit SHA can be used in place of a branch or tag name.

```
git[main|topwrap/builtin]:https://github.com/antmicro/topwrap.git
```

This clones the main branch as above, but resolves to the `topwrap/builtin` subdirectory of the repository instead of its root.

Cloned repositories are cached persistently between runs. To remove all locally cached clones, run:

```
topwrap clean-cache --target git
```

Omitting `--target` removes every cache topwrap maintains.

6.5 Positions YAML

Positions YAML files are auxiliary files that save the positions of elements set in the GUI when saving the design to the YAML format. These files are not meant to be edited or inspected by hand, and ought to be treated as ephemeral.

The structure of the positions file is shown below:

```
modules:
- id:
  vendor: vendor
  library: libdefault
  name: my_module
  version: 0.1
  identifier: [-1000.0, -1000.0]
  components:
  - name: foo
    position: [-100.0, 200.0]
  - ...
  externals:
  - name: clk
    position: [-200.0, 200.0]
  - ...
  constants:
  - name: 32
    position: [-200.0, 200.0]
  - ...
  clock_domains:
  - ...
  reset_domains:
  - ...
  interconnects:
  - ...
  inverters:
  - source: clk
    target: [foo, clk]
    position: [-150.0, 200.0]
  - ...
```

6.5.1 File format explanation

- modules - list of objects describing positions of elements within modules
 - id - the identifier of the module this description is for
 - identifier - the position of the identifier node
 - components - list of objects describing positions of components
 - * name - the name of the component
 - * position the component's position

- externals - list of objects describing positions of external I/O nodes
 - * entries use the same format as components
- constants - list of objects describing positions of constant value nodes
 - * entries use the same format as components
- clock_domains - list of objects describing positions of clock domain nodes
 - * entries use the same format as components
- reset_domains - list of objects describing positions of reset domain nodes
 - * entries use the same format as components
- interconnects - list of objects describing positions of interconnect nodes
 - * entries use the same format as components
- inverters - list of objects describing positions of inverter nodes
 - * source - the source signal of the connection with an inverter
 - * target - the target signal of the connection with an inverter
 - * position - the inverter's position

INTERFACE INFERENCE

Warning: SystemVerilog modules with parameter types are not fully supported by inference. There is no way to override default parameter values, and as such, you must create a wrapper module that has concrete parameter values specified. Ports with non-parameterized types are unaffected by this.

This is particularly important to keep in mind when using modules that use ports with struct types, since the types are likely realized using parameter types.

In addition to explicit interface definitions, Topwrap also supports automatically inferring interfaces from module ports based on the interface and module definitions. This can be done when parsing SystemVerilog modules using `topwrap repo parse` by specifying the `--inference` flag.

Inference can be performed on groups of module ports, or fields of ports with struct types, and in the latter case, it also supports ports that are one-dimensional arrays of structs, creating separate interfaces for each array element.

The inference process is done in two steps. First, Topwrap finds all groups which might form an interface. For module ports, this is done by finding common prefixes in port names. For structures, all struct members (recursively including members of members) of a port are considered to be within one group, named after the port.

Additionally, the inference logic accepts grouping hints, which describe which groups should be merged together, and what the resulting group should be called. This is particularly useful in conjunction with the struct-based inference, as usually there are separate ports for the input and output signal structs, which need to be considered together to form a full interface. For example, modules found in `pulp-platform/axi` have two ports for each AXI interface: `req_i/o` and `resp_o/i`, each being a struct which contains all the signals.

When specified on the command line via the `--grouping-hint` argument (which can be specified multiple times to add multiple hints), grouping hints use the following syntax: `old1,old2,...,oldN=new`. Whitespace between names, commas, and the equal sign is ignored, and all group names must be non-empty. For example, grouping hints arguments for `axi_cdc` would look like this: `--grouping-hint=src_req_i,src_resp_o=src` and `--grouping-hint=dst_req_o,dst_resp_i=dst`.

The second step is checking which interfaces fit which groups, and ranking how good of a fit they are. Then, interface modes are determined based on port directions, and finally, candidate assignments are applied, going from best to worst. If a port is used by two or more interfaces, the higher scoring one takes precedence, and the lower scoring interfaces are ignored.

You can limit which interface definitions are considered during inference using the

`--inference-interface` argument. The argument takes an interface definition name, and can be specified multiple times. During inference, only interfaces with names matching the specified ones will be considered. For example, to only attempt to infer AXI4 and AHB interfaces, the arguments would look like this: `--inference-interface AXI4` and `--inference-interface AHB`.

CONFIGURATION

8.1 Configuration file location

The configuration file must be located in one of the following locations:

```
topwrap.yaml
~/.config/topwrap/topwrap.yaml
~/.config/topwrap/config.yaml
```

Additionally, *some* configuration options can be specified in the *design YAML*.

8.2 Configuration precedence

When multiple configuration files are present, the options are evaluated and overridden based on the location of the configuration file. The precedence, from highest to lowest, is as follows:

- Design YAML when evaluating the design
- `topwrap.yaml` in the current working directory
- `~/.config/topwrap/topwrap.yaml` (user-specific configuration)
- `~/.config/topwrap/config.yaml` (fallback configuration)

For example, if `force_interface_compliance` is set to `true` in `~/.config/topwrap/config.yaml` but overridden to `false` in `topwrap.yaml`, the latter value will take precedence when running Topwrap in the directory containing `topwrap.yaml`.

8.2.1 Merging strategies for configuration options

Different configuration options use different merging strategies when multiple configuration files are combined:

- **Override** (e.g. `force_interface_compliance`): The value from the higher-precedence file completely replaces the value in lower-precedence files.
- **Merge** (e.g. `repositories`): Values from all configuration files are merged. For example, repositories defined in `~/.config/topwrap/topwrap.yaml` are combined with repositories defined in `topwrap.yaml`. Note however that if a repository name is defined in two places, the higher priority setting still **overrides** the lower.

8.3 Available config options

The configuration file for Topwrap provides the following options:

- `force_interface_compliance`
 - Type: Boolean
 - Default: `false`
 - Merging strategy: Override

This option enforces compliance with interface definitions when parsing HDLs.

For more details, refer to [Interface compliance](#).

- `repositories`
 - Type: Dictionary of name: path
 - Merging strategy: Merge
 - Specifies repositories to load, with each repository defined as an entry in which:
 - * The key is the name of the repository.
 - * The value is the [resource path](#) to the repository.
 - Example of specifying multiple repositories:

```
repositories:  
  name_of_repo: file:path_to_repo  
  another_repo: file:/absolute/path/to/repo  
  remote_repo: git[main]:https://github.com/org/some-ip-repo.git
```

Repositories are used to package and load multiple IP cores and custom interfaces.

For more information, refer to [User repositories](#).

Deprecated since version 1.0.0: Use `libraries` instead.

- `libraries`
 - Type: Dictionary of name: uri
 - Merging strategy: Merge
 - Specifies the libraries to load, with each library defined as an entry in which:
 - * The key is the name the library is referred to by.
 - * The value is a local directory or a git URL, optionally suffixed with `@<ref>` to pin a branch, tag, or commit.
 - Relative local paths are resolved against the directory of the file declaring them, so a library keeps resolving regardless of the working directory.
 - Example:

```
libraries:  
  my_cores: ./cores
```

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(continued from previous page)

```
remote_cores: https://github.com/org/some-ip-repo.git
pinned_cores: https://github.com/org/some-ip-repo.git@v1.2.0
```

Entries are normally added with `topwrap library add` rather than by hand.

For more information, refer to *Libraries*.

8.3.1 Example configuration file

Here is a sample configuration file used in the *hierarchy example*

```
force_interface_compliance: true
repositories:
  my_repo: file:./repo
```

LIBRARIES

A library is a directory of **CAPI2** .core files that describe IP cores and interface definitions. Topwrap resolves them with FuseSoC, so a library can be a plain local directory or a git repository.

A library is not laid out by convention: each .core file states which of its files Topwrap should read, and what they are.

9.1 Registering a library

```
topwrap library add my_cores ./path/to/cores
topwrap library add remote_cores https://github.com/example/cores.git
```

The name is what the library is referred to by; the URI is a local directory or a git URL. A git URL may carry a @<ref> suffix to pin a branch, tag, or commit:

```
topwrap library add pinned https://github.com/example/cores.git@v1.2.0
```

Registering writes the entry to the libraries: section of topwrap.yaml in the current directory, and checks a git library out into a project-local .fusesoc-cores/ directory. Because the checkout is project-local, two projects never contend over the same clone.

To fetch the latest upstream state of the registered git libraries:

```
topwrap library update          # all of them
topwrap library update my_cores # or just one
```

9.2 Inspecting libraries

```
topwrap library list          # registered libraries and their checkout state
topwrap library list modules  # IP modules each one provides
topwrap library list interfaces # interface definitions each one provides
topwrap library list all      # both
```

Each of the listing commands accepts --design <file>, which also takes into account the libraries declared in that design's config: section.

9.3 Describing library contents

A `.core` file marks each file it contributes with a `file_type`, which is what tells Topwrap how to read it:

- `topwrapModule` — an *IP description*
- `topwrapInterface` — an *interface definition*

```
CAPI=2:

name : example.com:my-cores:fifo

filesets:
  topwrap:
    files:
      - module.yaml : { file_type : topwrapModule }
```

A single `.core` may contribute any number of modules and interfaces. Files without one of these types are ignored by Topwrap.

The identifier a module or interface is known by comes from the `id:` field of its YAML file. The `.core` name identifies the owning FuseSoC package and may differ, for example when one package provides several Topwrap modules. Generated FuseSoC dependencies use that owning `.core` name.

9.4 Referencing a library module

In a design, `core:` takes the VLNV of a module from any registered library:

```
ips:
  adapter:
    core: vendor:libdefault:axi_axil_adapter:0.1
```

The reference may be partial, and is matched right-aligned onto `vendor:library:name`, so all of these select the same module when unambiguous:

```
core: axi_axil_adapter           # just the name
core: libdefault:axi_axil_adapter # library and name
core: :libdefault:axi_axil_adapter # an empty field is a wildcard
```

Spelling out all four fields also constrains the version. A reference that matches nothing, or more than one module, is an error that names the candidates.

`core:` and `file:` are mutually exclusive — each IP instance uses exactly one.

9.5 Declaring libraries in a design

A design can register libraries for its own parse, without touching `topwrap.yaml`:

```
config:
  libraries:
    my_cores: ./cores
```

Relative paths are resolved against the design file. This is how a design stays self-contained for anyone who checks it out. The declaration is scoped to that design operation and does not affect later designs parsed in the same process.

9.6 Creating a library core

`topwrap package --lib` writes a CAPI2 `.core` file next to the generated IP description:

```
cores/widget/
├─ rtl/
│   └─ include/
│       └─ config.svh
└─ widget.sv
```

```
topwrap package cores/widget/rtl/widget.sv \
+incdir+cores/widget/rtl/include +define+WIDTH=8 \
--vlnv example.com:widgets:widget:1.0 --lib --output cores/widget
```

This creates `widget.yaml` and `widget.core` in `cores/widget`.

Interface definitions declared by the input HDL are written as separate YAML files and, with `--lib`, listed in the generated core as `topwrapInterface`. Topwrap saves each full interface VLNV once. Definitions already supplied by a built-in, registered library, or user repository are referenced rather than duplicated in the new package.

Filelists supplied with `--flist` may contain source paths, `+incdir+`, `+define+`, and nested `-f` or `-F` entries. Relative paths inside a filelist are resolved from that filelist's directory.

The generated core records source files in its RTL fileset. Files found under `+incdir+` directories are marked as include files with their include path, while `+define+NAME` and `+define+NAME=VALUE` entries become FuseSoC `vlogdefine` parameters enabled on the default target.

With `--lib`, every source and include directory must be inside the output directory. If they are elsewhere, pass `--copy` to copy them into it while packaging. Source files are copied by filename, and include directories by directory name, so the generated `.core` refers to the copies. For example:

```
topwrap package ../rtl/widget.sv +incdir+../rtl/include \
--lib --copy --output cores/widget
```

Without `--copy`, Topwrap reports an error without writing the package when sources are outside output directory. You can also choose a common parent as `--output` or move the sources

beneath the package directory. Keeping all files alongside the `.core` avoids references to files outside its directory, which FuseSoC is deprecating.

CONSTRUCTING, CONFIGURING AND LOADING REPOSITORIES

Deprecated since version 1.0.0: User repositories and the `topwrap repo` commands are being removed. Use *libraries* instead, and reference their cores with `core:` in a design.

By using Topwrap repositories, you can package and load different resources and use them in your designs.

You can specify the repositories to be loaded each time Topwrap runs, by listing them in a *configuration file* or by supplying a path to one or more repository directories using the `--repo` CLI argument.

A single repository can store multiple resource types. Each supported type is associated with a subdirectory in the top-level repository directory.

A sample repository can be found in *examples/user_repository*.

10.1 Supported resource types

10.1.1 IP cores

- Path: `repo_dir/cores/`

The “Core” resource represents a self-contained IP core/module that can then be used as a component in a custom design created by the user. It corresponds to *Internal Representation* Module object.

A resource is stored in the `module.yaml` file, it follows *IP description format*. It contains information about the HDL module and should be generated by `topwrap repo parse`, but it can be done manually. The `module.yaml` should be edited by a user to fill in information's that cannot be deduced from the HDL file or when there is a custom interface that does not have an Interface Definition.

10.1.2 Interface definitions

- Path: `repo_dir/interfaces/`

This resource represents a custom definition of an interface that can be used to make connections between IP cores.

Each such definition is stored as a separate *interface description file* under the `interfaces` sub-directory.

10.2 CLI

10.2.1 `topwrap repo init`

```
topwrap repo init [OPTIONS] REPO_NAME REPO_PATH
```

This command creates and initializes a new repository named `REPO_NAME` in a chosen `REPO_PATH`. By default, it also adds the entry with the new repository into the local Topwrap *configuration file*. If the file does not exist, it gets created. This behavior can be disabled using the `--no-config-update` CLI flag.

10.2.2 `topwrap repo list`

```
topwrap repo list
```

This will print out names and paths of all repositories from which resources are loaded and can be used in other Topwrap commands.

10.2.3 `topwrap repo parse`

```
topwrap repo parse [OPTIONS] REPOSITORY SOURCES...
```

This command will parse all supported source files given in the `SOURCES` argument, extract IP cores from them, and save them in a repository given by the `REPOSITORY` argument.

Note: When a directory path is given among the `SOURCES` argument, it gets recursively expanded and all nested files are extracted from it.

To see the listing of all supported `OPTIONS`, see `topwrap repo parse --help`

10.3 Using the open source IP cores library with Topwrap

Topwrap comes with built-in support for an extensive library of open source IP cores available through the **FuseSoC** package manager, which also serves as a build system. This library offers a wide range of reusable IP cores for various applications, enabling easy integration into Topwrap projects. Topwrap simplifies the process of accessing, downloading, and packaging these IP cores, making them readily available for local use in your designs.

To include an IP core from the open source library, there are two methods:

1. **Select the Desired Core:** Browse the available cores ([cores_export artifact](#)).
2. **Download and build all available cores:** Use Topwrap's package management command:

```
just package
```

This will download and parse all the cores from Fusesoc into `build/fusesoc_workspace/build/export/cores/`, making them accessible from within Topwrap.

You can learn more about Topwrap integration with FuseSoC [here](#)

INTERCONNECT GENERATION

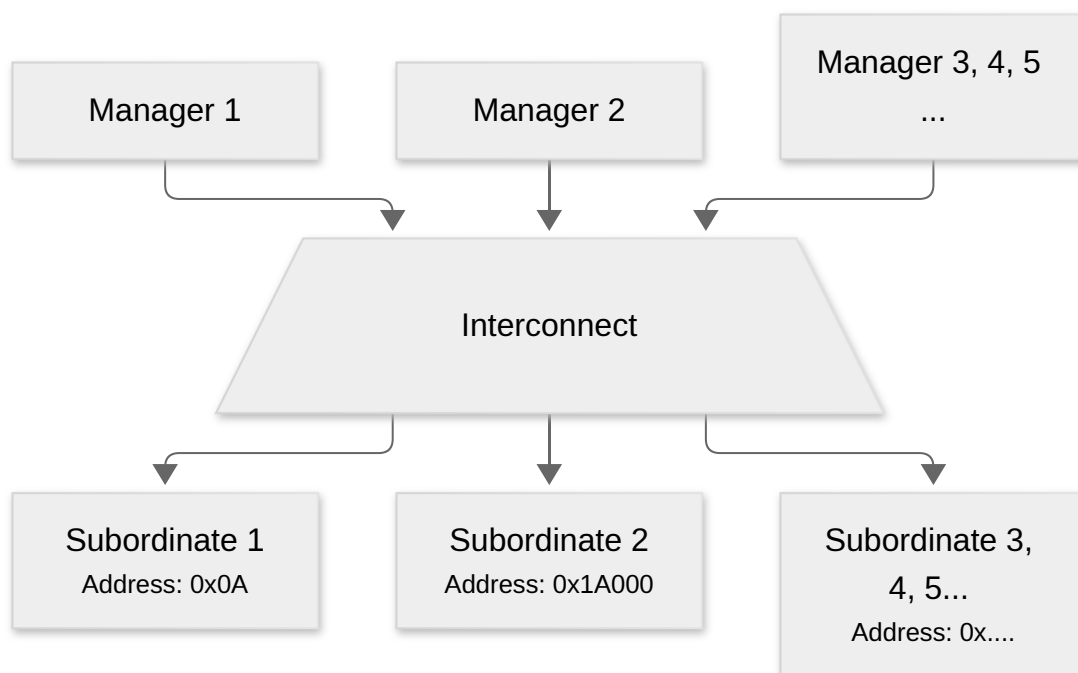
Interconnects enable the connection of multiple interfaces in a many-to-many topology, as opposed to the traditional one-to-one manager-subordinate connection. This approach facilitates data transmission between multiple IP cores over a single interface, with the interconnect serving as a middle-man.

Warning: Interconnect generation is an experimental feature.

Currently, creating and showing them is not possible in the Topwrap GUI.

Each manager can communicate with any subordinate connected to the interconnect. Every connected subordinate must be assigned a predefined address range, allowing the interconnect to route data based on the address specified by the manager.

A typical interconnect topology diagram is shown below.



In order to generate an interconnect, you have to describe its configuration in the *Design description* under the interconnects key in the following format, as specified below:

11.1 Format

The interconnects key must be a direct descendant of the design key in the *Design description*.

```
interconnects:
  {interconnect1_name}:
    # Specify clock and reset to drive the interconnect with
    clock: [{ip_name, clk_port_name}]
    reset: [{ip_name, rst_port_name}]
    # Alternatively you can specify a connection to an external port of this_
    ↪ design:
      # clock: ext_clk_port_name
      # reset: ext_rst_port_name

    # Specify the interconnect type.
    # See the "Supported interconnect types" section below for available types
    # and their characteristics
    type: {interconnect_type}

    # custom parameter values for the specific interconnect type
    parameters:
      {parameters_name1}: parameters_value1
      ...

    # specify managers and their interfaces connected to the bus
    managers:
      {manager1_name}:
        - {manager1_interface1_name}
        ...
      ...

    # specify subordinates, their interfaces connected to the bus and their bus_
    ↪ parameters
    subordinates:
      {subordinate1_name}:
        {subordinate1_interface1_name}:
          # requests in address range [address, address+size) will be routed to_
          ↪ this interface
          address: {start_address}
          size: {range_size}
          ...
        ...

    # additionally, in addition to the subordinates section, a map from the_
    ↪ memory_maps section can be specified
    # the subordinates is updated with data present in the selected memory map
    memory_map: {map_name}
    ...
```

- clock - a port that has the clock signal
- reset - a port that has the reset signal

- `type` - a type of interconnect, listed in [Supported interconnect types][#supported-interconnect-types]
- `parameters` - a list of parameters specific to the interconnect
- `managers` - a list of interfaces used as managers, each ip module can have multiple interfaces connected
- `subordinates` - a list of interfaces used as subordinates, each ip module can have multiple interfaces connected. Address and size is specified in bytes.
- `memory_map` - the memory map used to update subordinates

11.2 Supported interconnect types

11.2.1 Wishbone Round-Robin

This interconnect only supports Wishbone interfaces for managers and subordinates. It supports multiple managers, but only one of them can drive the bus at a time (i.e. only one transaction can be happening on the bus at any given moment). A round-robin arbiter decides which manager can currently drive the bus.

Parameters

Subordinate

- `addr_width` - bit width of the address line (addresses access `data_width`-sized chunks)
- `data_width` - bit width of the data line
- `granularity` - access granularity - the smallest unit of data transfer that the interconnect can transfer. Must be: 8, 16, 32, 64
- `features` - optional, list of optional wishbone signals, can contain: `err`, `rty`, `stall`, `lock`, `cti`, `bte`

Known limitations

The currently known limitations are:

- only word-sized addressing is supported (in other words - consecutive addresses can only access word-sized chunks of data)
- crossing clock domains, down-converting (initiating multiple transactions on a narrow bus per one transaction on a wider bus) and up-converting are not supported

11.2.2 AXI

This interconnect only supports AXI4 interfaces for managers and subordinates. Uses `pulp-platform/axi` as dependency.

Caution: `Generator` for SystemVerilog for this interconnect needs plugin mechanism to work, it isn't currently implemented. As workaround Topwrap downloads scripts to `$XDG_CACHE_HOME/topwrap/pulp_axi_scripts` or `~/.local/cache/topwrap/pulp_axi_scripts`.

Parameters

- `atop` - True or False, enables or disables atomic operations

Manager

- `id_width` - bit width of ID signals

USING FUSESOC FOR AUTOMATION

Topwrap uses the **FuseSoC** package manager and build tools for HDL code to automate project generation and the build process. When `topwrap generate` is used with the `--fusesoc` option, it generates a **FuseSoC .core file** along with the top-level wrapper.

12.1 Default tool for synthesis, bitstream generation and programming the FPGA

Topwrap assumes that you're using **Vivado**. You can change the default tool to something other than Vivado by modifying the generated `.core` file.

12.2 Additional build options

To enable `.core` file generation, supply `--fusesoc` to `topwrap generate`:

```
topwrap generate design.yaml --fusesoc
```

If you have any additional directories with HDL sources or constraint files required for synthesis, you can specify them using the repeatable `--sources` option. Sources from these directories get appended to the `filesets.rtl.files` entry in the generated FuseSoC `.core` file.

```
topwrap generate design.yaml --fusesoc --sources ./srcs_v --sources ./srcs_vhd
```

If you're targeting a specific FPGA chip, you can additionally specify its number using the `--part` option.

The supplied part number is passed to the FuseSoC `.core` file. It is included in the `targets.default.tools.vivado.part` entry, which is then supplied to **Vivado** when you run FuseSoC and use the default target. This can be any part number available to your local Vivado installation.

```
topwrap generate design.yaml --fusesoc --part 'xc7z020c1g400-3'
```

Library-backed IPs used by the design are emitted as dependencies of the generated core. FuseSoC therefore includes their own RTL filesets when it builds the design.

Use `--target-dir` to change the output root. The wrapper and `.core` file are written to its `src` subdirectory.

The generated core currently defines a default Vivado target. Edit the generated `.core` file if another tool, additional targets or hooks are required.

12.3 Synthesis

After generating the `.core` file, you can run FuseSoC to generate the bitstream and program the FPGA:

```
fusesoc --cores-root build/src run {design_name}
```

This requires having a suitable backend tool that is specified in the `.core` file under `targets.default.tools` available in your `PATH` (e.g. [Vivado](#)).

PLUGIN SUPPORT

Topwrap uses a plugin mechanism to allow external software to customize or extend the capabilities of Topwrap. Plugins take the form of Python modules.

13.1 Ways to get plugins

There are two ways to get plugins, install and configure pre-existing plugins or build your own.

13.1.1 Plugin repositories

Antmicro hosts plugins in <https://github.com/antmicro/topwrap-utils>.

13.1.2 Building your own

Building plugins on your own requires insight into how Topwrap works. You are encouraged to review the Developer's guide on *plugins* and to use an *existing plugin* as a start-of point.

13.2 Plugin configurations

Plugins are configured both at the IP-core level and the design level. Both files provide a configurable property extensions that is used to pass options to the plugin. See the chapter on *creating designs* for more info about the format of configuration options. Also review the documentation for each plugin, which will describe plugin-specific settings.

SETUP

It is required for developers to keep the current code style and it is recommended to frequently run tests.

In order to set up the development environment, install all the optional dependency groups as specified in `pyproject.toml`, which also includes `pre-commit`:

```
uv sync --extra all
source .venv/bin/activate
```

The `--extra` option is for installing in editable mode - meaning changes in the code under development will be immediately visible when using the package.

CODE STYLE

`pre-commit` performs automatic formatting and linting of the code.

15.1 Lint with `pre-commit`

Alternatively, use `pre-commit` to perform the same job. `pre-commit` hooks need to be installed:

```
pre-commit install
```

Now, each use of `git commit` in the shell will trigger actions defined in the `.pre-commit-config.yaml` file. `pre-commit` is easily deactivated with a similar command:

```
pre-commit uninstall
```

If you wish to run `pre-commit` asynchronously, use:

```
pre-commit run --all-files
```

Note: `pre-commit` by default also runs `ruff` and `codespell` sessions.

15.2 Tools

Tools used in the Topwrap project for maintaining the code style:

- `pre-commit` is a framework for managing and maintaining multi-language `pre-commit` hooks.
- `ruff` is a Python linter and code formatter.
- `codespell` is a Python tool to fix common spelling mistakes in text files

Topwrap functionality is validated with tests that leverage the pytest library.

16.1 Test execution

The tests are located in the tests directory. All tests can be run with just by specifying the test task:

```
just test
```

To force a specific Python version and avoid running tests for all listed versions, pass the version to the test task:

```
just test 3.10
```

Tests can also be launched without just by executing:

```
python -m pytest
```

Warning: When running tests by invoking pytest directly, tests are ran only on the locally selected Python interpreter. As the CI runs on all supported Python versions, it's recommended to run tests with just on all versions before pushing.

Ignoring a particular test can be performed with --ignore=test_path, e.g:

```
python -m pytest --ignore=tests/tests_build/test_interconnect.py
```

To run a specific test, use the -k test_name flag, e.g:

```
python -m pytest -k TestKpmSpecificationBackend
```

For debugging purposes, Pytest captures all output from the test and displays it when all tests are completed. To see the output immediately, pass the -s flag to pytest:

```
python -m pytest -s
```

16.2 Test coverage

Test coverage is automatically generated when running tests with just. When invoking pytest directly, it can be generated with the `--cov=topwrap` flag. This will generate a summary of coverage, displayed in the CLI.

```
python -m pytest --cov=topwrap
```

Additionally, the summary can be generated in HTML with the flags `--cov=topwrap --cov-report html`, where lines that were not covered by tests can be browsed:

```
python -m pytest --cov=topwrap --cov-report html
```

The generated report is available at `htmlcov/index.html`

16.3 Updating kpm test data

All kpm data from examples can be generated using just. This is useful when changing Topwrap functionality relating to kpm, as it avoids manually changing test data in every sample. Users can either update of example data such as the specification or update everything (dataflows, specifications).

To update everything run:

```
just update-testdata --dataflow --specification
```

To update only specifications run:

```
just update-testdata --specification
```

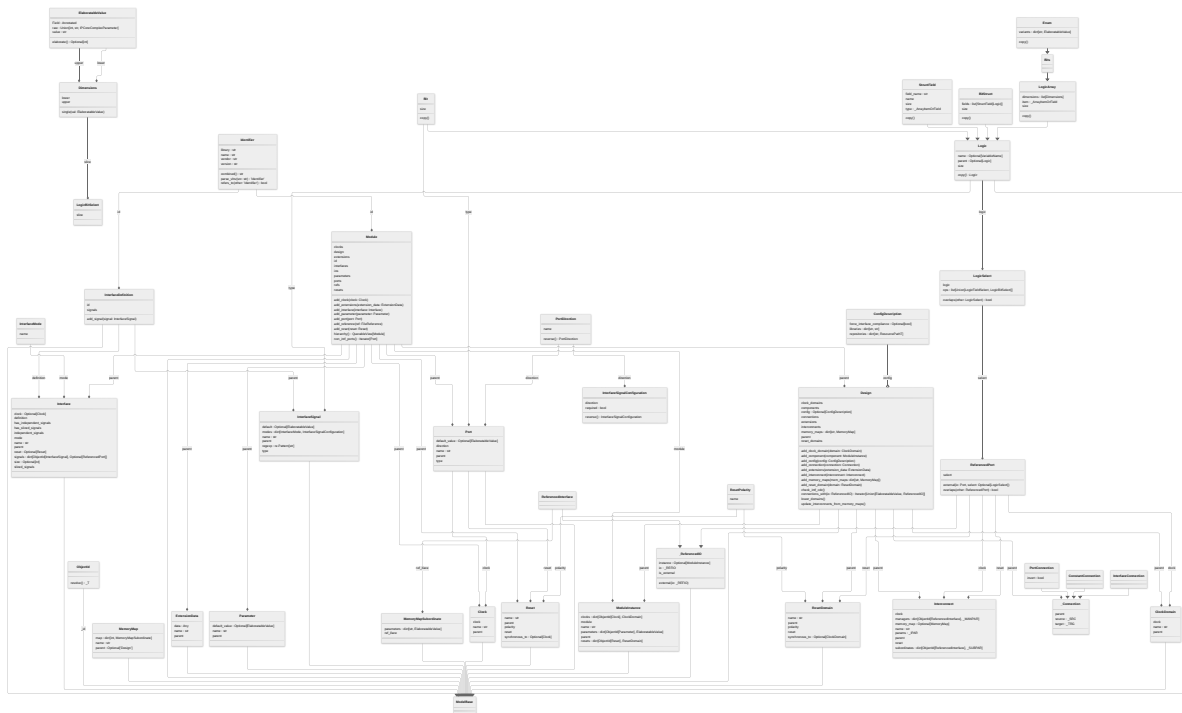
Valid options for the `update-testdata` task, are:

- `specification`
- `dataflow`

INTERNAL REPRESENTATION

Topwrap uses a custom object hierarchy, further called “internal representation” or “IR”, in order to store block design and related data in memory and operate on it.

17.1 Class diagram



17.2 Frontend & Backend

The Frontend based classes converts external formats, such as SystemVerilog, VHDL, KPM or IP-XACT into the IR. Complementarily, the Backend based classes convert our IR into external formats, such as SystemVerilog, YAML, KPM or IP-XACT.

The reason for separating the logic like this is to be able to easily add support for multiple frontends and backends formats and make them interchangeable.

17.2.1 API interface

```
class FrontendParseStrInput(name: str, content: str)
```

Bases: object

name : str

content : str

```
class FrontendMetadata(name: str, file_association: Iterable[str] = <factory>)
```

Bases: object

name : str

A short name for this frontend used in contexts when a specific frontend needs to be identified for example in a configuration file or CLI

file_association : Iterable[str]

File extensions associated with this frontend in the form of a set of extensions (e.g. {“.yaml”, “.yml”})

```
class FrontendParseOutput(modules: list[~topwrap.model.module.Module] = <factory>,
                           interfaces: list[~topwrap.model.interface.InterfaceDefinition] =
                           <factory>, positions: dict[~topwrap.model.misc.Identifier,
                           ~topwrap.backend.kpm.common.Positions] = <factory>)
```

Bases: object

Variables

modules

Modules parsed from the input sources. A parsed module is included even if its identifier matches a module provided to the frontend during initialization.

interfaces

Interface definitions parsed from the input sources.

positions

Mapping from module identifiers to the positions of elements in their corresponding KPM graphs.

modules : list[*Module*]

interfaces : list[*InterfaceDefinition*]

positions : dict[*Identifier*, Positions]

```
exception FrontendParseException
```

Bases: *TranslationError*

Exception occurred during parsing sources by the frontend

```
class Frontend(modules: Iterable[Module] = (), interfaces: Iterable[InterfaceDefinition] =
               ())
```

Bases: ABC

parse_str(sources: Iterable[str | FrontendParseStrInput]) → FrontendParseOutput

Parse a collection of string sources into IR modules

Parameters

sources: Iterable[str | FrontendParseStrInput]

Iterable of string sources. Items can either be a plain *str* with the content or the *FrontendParseStrInput* dataclass where additional parameters related to the source can be specified.

abstract property metadata: FrontendMetadata

Return metadata about this frontend such as its file associations

abstract parse_files(sources: Iterable[Path], *, include_dirs: Iterable[Path] = ()) → FrontendParseOutput

Parse a collection of source files into IR modules

Parameters

sources: Iterable[Path]

Collection of paths to sources

exception BackendParseException

Bases: TranslationError

Exception occurred during dumping internal representation by the backend

class BackendOutputInfo(filename: str, content: str)

Bases: object

Output of the backend's serialization process

filename: str

The filename for this output as suggested by the specific backend E.g. dataflow.kpm.json or axibridge.sv

content: str

The content of the file generated by the backend

save(path: Path)

Save this output as a file on the filesystem under a given path

Parameters

path: Path

The path where to save the file. If it points only to a directory, then the file is saved with the self.filename name.

class Backend(existing_interfaces: set[Identifier] | None = None)

Bases: ABC, Generic[_MODFORMAT]

The base class for backend implementations used to convert our IR represented by the Module class into various external formats, represented by the generic parameter *_MODFORMAT*.

existing_interfaces: Set[Identifier]

List of InterfaceDefinition's that already exists in source files or has been serialized, it is a hint for backend implementations

abstract represent(*module*: *Module*, /) → *_MODFORMAT*

Convert the IR into an arbitrary custom external format.

abstract serialize(*repr*: *_MODFORMAT*, /) → *Iterator*[*BackendOutputInfo*]

Serialize the custom format object into one or more text files, represented by their content, alongside with additional information about them, like the suggested file-name.

17.3 Module

```
class Module(*, id: Identifier, refs: Iterable[FileReference] = (), ports: Iterable[Port] = (),
             parameters: Iterable[Parameter] = (), interfaces: Iterable[Interface] = (),
             clocks: Iterable[Clock] = (), resets: Iterable[Reset] = (), design: Design | None
             = None, extensions: Iterable[ExtensionData] = ())
```

Bases: *ModelBase*

The top-level class of the IR. It fully represents the public interface of a HDL module, holding definitions of all of its structured ports and interfaces, parameters, and optionally its inner block design if available.

id : *Identifier*

property design

Returns the optional inner block design of this module

property ports : *QueryableView*[*Port*]

property parameters : *QueryableView*[*Parameter*]

property interfaces : *QueryableView*[*Interface*]

property ios : *QueryableView*[*Port* | *Interface*]

Returns a combined view on both ports and interfaces

property refs : *QueryableView*[*FileReference*]

Returns references to external files that define this module, if any. This information is generally added by the respective frontend used to parse this module.

property clocks : *QueryableView*[*Clock*]

property resets : *QueryableView*[*Reset*]

property extensions : *QueryableView*[*ExtensionData*]

add_port(*port*: *Port*)

add_parameter(*parameter*: *Parameter*)

add_interface(*interface*: *Interface*)

add_reference(*ref*: *FileReference*)

add_clock(*clock*: *Clock*)

add_reset(reset: Reset)

add_extensions(extension_data: ExtensionData)

non_intf_ports() → Iterator[Port]

Yield ports that don't realise signals of any interface

hierarchy() → QuerableView[Module]

Traverses the entire hierarchy tree of this module in order, using a BFS algorithm. Returns every unique module encountered on the way. The result also includes the current module.

17.4 Design

```
class ModuleInstance(*, name: VariableName, module: Module, parameters:
    Mapping[ObjectId[Parameter], ElaboratableValue] = {}, clocks:
    Mapping[ObjectId[Clock], ClockDomain] = {}, resets:
    Mapping[ObjectId[Reset], ResetDomain] = {})
```

Bases: *ModelBase*

Represents an instantiated module with values supplied for its appropriate respective parameters. This class is necessary to differentiate multiple instances of the same module in a design.

parent : *Design*

Reference to the design that contains this component

name : VariableName

The name of this instance. It corresponds to “instance_name” in this exemplary Verilog construct: `MODULE #(WIDTH(32)) instance_name (.clk(clk));`

module : *Module*

The module that this is an instance of. Corresponds to “MODULE” in the Verilog construct defined above.

parameters : dict[ObjectId[Parameter], ElaboratableValue]

Concrete parameter values for the module that this is an instance of. Corresponds to “#(WIDTH(32))” in the above Verilog construct.

clocks : dict[ObjectId[Clock], ClockDomain]

Assignments between this instance's clock inputs and clock domains.

resets : dict[ObjectId[Reset], ResetDomain]

Assignments between this instance's reset inputs and reset domains.

```
class ClockDomain(*, name: str, clock: ReferencedPort)
```

Bases: *ModelBase*

This class represents a clock domain defined within a design.

parent : *Design*

Reference to the design that contains this clock domain.

name : VariableName

clock : *ReferencedPort*

Reference to a port acting as the source for this clock domain.

class `ResetDomain`(*, **name**: *str*, **reset**: *ReferencedPort*, **polarity**: *ResetPolarity*,
synchronous_to: *ClockDomain* | *None* = *None*)

Bases: *ModelBase*

This class represents a reset domain defined within a design.

parent : *Design*

Reference to the design that contains this reset domain.

name : VariableName

reset : *ReferencedPort*

Reference to a port acting as the source for this reset domain.

polarity : *ResetPolarity*

Polarity of the reset signal.

synchronous_to : *ClockDomain* | *None*

Clock domain to which this reset domain is synchronous to. *None* if the reset signal is asynchronous.

exception `DesignDomainException`

Bases: *Exception*

Error relating to clock and reset domains within a design.

class `Design`(*, **components**: *Iterable*[*ModuleInstance*] = (), **interconnects**:
Iterable[*Interconnect*] = (), **connections**: *Iterable*[*ConstantConnection* |
PortConnection | *InterfaceConnection*] = (), **clock_domains**:
Iterable[*ClockDomain*] = (), **reset_domains**: *Iterable*[*ResetDomain*] = (),
memory_maps: *dict*[*str*, *MemoryMap*] | *None* = *None*, **extensions**:
Iterable[*ExtensionData*] = (), **config**: *ConfigDescription* | *None* = *None*)

Bases: *ModelBase*

This class represents the inner block design of a specific Module. It consists of instances of other modules (components) and connections between them, each other, and external ports of the module that this design represents.

parent : *Module*

memory_maps : *dict*[*str*, *MemoryMap*]

config : *ConfigDescription* | *None*

property components : *QueryableView*[*ModuleInstance*]

property interconnects : *QueryableView*[*Interconnect*]

property connections : *QueryableView*[*ConstantConnection* | *PortConnection* |
InterfaceConnection]

```

property clock_domains : QueryableView[ClockDomain]
property reset_domains : QueryableView[ResetDomain]
property extensions : QueryableView[ExtensionData]
add_component(component: ModuleInstance)
add_interconnect(interconnect: Interconnect)
add_connection(connection: ConstantConnection | PortConnection |
                  InterfaceConnection)
add_clock_domain(domain: ClockDomain)
add_reset_domain(domain: ResetDomain)
add_extensions(extension_data: ExtensionData)
add_memory_maps(mem_maps: dict[str, MemoryMap])
add_config(config: ConfigDescription)
connections_with(io: ReferencedPort | ReferencedInterface) →
    Iterator[ElaboratableValue | ReferencedPort | ReferencedInterface]
    Yields everything that is connected to a given IO.

    Parameters
        io: ReferencedPort | ReferencedInterface
            The IO of which connections to yield.

lower_domains()
    Lower clock/reset domain assignments into regular port connections.

check_intf_cdc()

update_interconnects_from_memory_maps()

```

17.5 Interface

```

class InterfaceMode(value, names=None, *, module=None, qualname=None, type=None,
                    start=1, boundary=None)

```

Bases: Enum

MANAGER = 'manager'

SUBORDINATE = 'subordinate'

UNSPECIFIED = 'unspecified'

```

class InterfaceSignalConfiguration(direction: PortDirection, required: bool)

```

Bases: object

Holds the mode-specific configuration of an interface signal

direction : *PortDirection*

The direction of this signal in a given InterfaceMode

required : bool

Whether this signal is required or optional

reverse() → *InterfaceSignalConfiguration*

Returns a configuration with the opposite direction.

```
class InterfaceSignal(*, name: str, regexp: Pattern[str], type: Logic, default:
    ElaboratableValue | None = None, modes: Mapping[InterfaceMode,
    InterfaceSignalConfiguration] = {})
```

Bases: *ModelBase*

This class represents a signal in an interface definition. E.g.: The awaddr signal in the AXI interface etc.

parent : *InterfaceDefinition*

The definition that this signal belongs to

name : VariableName

regexp : re.Pattern[str]

While automatically deducing interfaces, if an arbitrary signal's name matches this regular expression then that signal is considered as a candidate for realizing this signal definition

type : *Logic*

The logical type of this signal. Fulfills the same function as Port.type

default : *ElaboratableValue* | None = None

The default value for this signal, if any

modes : dict[*InterfaceMode*, *InterfaceSignalConfiguration*]

A dictionary of modes for this signal and their specific configurations E.g.: A signal that only has an InterfaceMode.MANAGER entry in this dictionary means that it's valid only on the manager's side.

```
class InterfaceDefinition(*, id: Identifier, signals: Iterable[InterfaceSignal] = ())
```

Bases: *ModelBase*

This represents a definition of an entire interface/bus. E.g. AXI, AHB, Wishbone, etc.

id : *Identifier*

property signals : *QueryableView*[*InterfaceSignal*]

A list of signal definitions that make up this interface E.g. awaddr, araddr, wdata, rdata, etc... in AXI

add_signal(signal: *InterfaceSignal*)

```
class Interface(name: str, mode: InterfaceMode, definition: InterfaceDefinition, signals:
    dict[ObjectId[InterfaceSignal], ReferencedPort | None], clock: Clock | None
    = None, reset: Reset | None = None, size: int | None = None)
```

Bases: *ModelBase*

A realised instance of an interface that can be connected with other interface instances through `InterfaceConnection`.

The relationship between this class and `InterfaceDefinition` is similar to the relationship between `ModuleInstance` and `Module` classes.

parent : *Module*

The module definition that contains this interface instance

name : `VariableName`

Name for this interface instance

mode : *InterfaceMode*

The mode of this instance (e.g. manager/subordinate)

definition : *InterfaceDefinition*

The definition of the interface that this is an instance of

signals : dict[*ObjectId*[*InterfaceSignal*], *ReferencedPort* | None]

Realization of signals defined in this interface. A signal can be realized either by:

- Slicing an already existing external port of the module that this instance belongs to (self.parent), in that case the value in this dictionary is the aforementioned port reference.
- Independently, meaning that whenever necessary, e.g. during output generation by a Backend that does not support interfaces, an arbitrarily generated port based on the `InterfaceSignal.type` should be generated to represent it. In that case the value in this dictionary is `None`.

For more information about sliced and independent signals, see [A note on “sliced” vs. “independent” signals](#)

If an entry for a specific signal that exists in the definition is not present in this dictionary, then that signal will not be realized at all. E.g. when it was configured as optional or was given a default value in `InterfaceSignalConfiguration`.

clock : *Clock* | None

Clock signal used by this interface.

reset : *Reset* | None

Reset signal used by this interface.

size : int | None

property independent_signals : Iterator[*InterfaceSignal*]

Yields signals that are not realized by any external ports of the Module

For more information about sliced and independent signals, see [A note on “sliced” vs. “independent” signals](#)

property sliced_signals : Iterator[*InterfaceSignal*]

Yields signals that are realized by external ports of the Module

For more information about sliced and independent signals, see [A note on “sliced” vs. “independent” signals](#)

`property has_independent_signals : bool`

`property has_sliced_signals : bool`

17.6 Interface inference

17.6.1 Port selector

```
class PortSelectorField(*, load_default: ~typing.Any = <marshmallow.missing>, missing:
    ~typing.Any = <marshmallow.missing>, dump_default:
    ~typing.Any = <marshmallow.missing>, default: ~typing.Any =
    <marshmallow.missing>, data_key: str | None = None, attribute:
    str | None = None, validate: ~typing.Callable[[~typing.Any],
    ~typing.Any] | ~typing.Iterable[~typing.Callable[[~typing.Any],
    ~typing.Any]] | None = None, required: bool = False, allow_none:
    bool | None = None, load_only: bool = False, dump_only: bool =
    False, error_messages: dict[str, str] | None = None, metadata:
    ~typing.Mapping[str, ~typing.Any] | None = None,
    **additional_metadata)
```

Bases: `Field`

```
class PortSelectorOp(value, names=None, *, module=None, qualname=None, type=None,
    start=1, boundary=None)
```

Bases: `Enum`

`FIELD = 1`

`SLICE = 2`

```
class PortSelector(port: str, ops: tuple[tuple[<PortSelectorOp.FIELD: 1>, str] |
    tuple[<PortSelectorOp.SLICE: 2>, tuple[int, int]], ...])
```

Bases: `object`

A selector of (potentially a smaller part of) a port.

The selector starts with an external port name, and is followed by one or more of the following operations:

- field selection (e.g. `.some_field`),
- array indexing/slicing (e.g. `[1]` or `[3:0]`).

For example, accessing a part one of the manager port fields of an instance of `axi_demux` from `pulp-platform/axi` would look like this: `mst_reqs_o[2].ar.addr[3:0]`.

port : `str`

Name of the module port this selector targets.

ops : `tuple[tuple[<PortSelectorOp.FIELD: 1>, str] | tuple[<PortSelectorOp.SLICE: 2>, tuple[int, int]], ...]`

Tuple of operations to be performed on the port.

classmethod `from_str(sel: str) → PortSelector`

Parse a port selector string into an instance of `PortSelector`.

classmethod `from_referenced_port(ref: ReferencedPort) → PortSelector`

Turn a `ReferencedPort` instance into an instance of `PortSelector`.

make_referenced_port(`module: Module`, `mode: InterfaceMode`, `signal: InterfaceSignal`)
→ `ReferencedPort`

Construct a `ReferencedPort`, potentially with an instance of `LogicSelect` based on the information contained in this selector.

17.6.2 Inference

parse_grouping_hints(`grouping_hints: Iterable[str]`) → `dict[str, str]`

Parse user-facing grouping hints into a dictionary for `infer_interfaces_from_module()`.

The incoming hints are stored as they are specified on the command line, in the form of: "old1,old2,...,oldN=new", and are parsed into dictionaries with entries like this: { "old1": "new", "old2": "new", ..., "oldN": "new" }

class `InterfaceInferenceOptions`(`min_group_size: int = 2`, `prefix_split_tokens: list[str] = <factory>`, `prefix_consider_camel_case: bool = True`)

Bases: `object`

Configuration options for `infer_interfaces_from_module()`.

min_group_size : `int = 2`

Minimum number of ports that must be in a group for it to be considered.

prefix_split_tokens : `list[str]`

Tokens on which prefixes are split on.

prefix_consider_camel_case : `bool = True`

Should camel case prefixes be considered.

infer_interfaces_from_module(`module: Module`, `intf_defs: Collection[InterfaceDefinition]`,
`grouping_hints: dict[str, str] | None = None`, `options: InterfaceInferenceOptions | None = None`)

Perform interface inference. Attempts to infer interfaces that the given module contains, and adds them to the module.

Parameters

module: `Module`

Module to perform inference on.

intf_defs: `Collection[InterfaceDefinition]`

Interface definitions to consider.

grouping_hints: `dict[str, str] | None = None`

Hints for merging discovered groups into one.

options: `InterfaceInferenceOptions | None = None`

Configuration options for inference.

17.7 Connections

```
class PortDirection(value, names=None, *, module=None, qualname=None, type=None,
                    start=1, boundary=None)
```

Bases: Enum

IN = 'in'

OUT = 'out'

INOUT = 'inout'

reverse() → *PortDirection*

```
class Port(*, name: str, direction: PortDirection, type: Logic | None = None, default_value:
           ElaboratableValue | None = None)
```

Bases: *ModelBase*

This represents an external port of a HDL module that can be connected to other ports or constant values in a design.

parent : *Module*

The module definition that exposes this port

name : VariableName

direction : *PortDirection*

type : *Logic*

The type of this port. (Bit, BitStruct, LogicArray etc.)

default_value : *ElaboratableValue* | None

The default value to assign to this port if left unconnected.

```
class ReferencedPort(*, instance: ModuleInstance | None = None, io: Port, select:
                     LogicSelect | None = None)
```

Bases: *_ReferencedIO[Port]*

Represents a correctly typed reference to a port

select : *LogicSelect*

classmethod external(io: Port, select: *LogicSelect* | None = None)

A shortcut constructor for a reference to a top-level IO of the current module

overlaps(other: *ReferencedPort*) → bool

Checks for overlap between two port references.

See docs for *overlaps()*

```
class ReferencedInterface(*, instance: ModuleInstance | None = None, io: _REFIO)
```

Bases: *_ReferencedIO[Interface]*

Represents a correctly typed reference to an interface

```
class ConstantConnection(source: _SRC, target: _TRG)
    Bases: _Connection[ElaboratableValue, ReferencedPort]
    Represents a connection between a constant value and a port of a component

class PortConnection(source: _SRC, target: _TRG, invert: bool = False)
    Bases: _Connection[ReferencedPort, ReferencedPort]
    Represents a connection between two ports of some components
    invert : bool = False
        Specifies whether the connection should be bitwise inverted.

class InterfaceConnection(source: _SRC, target: _TRG)
    Bases: _Connection[ReferencedInterface, ReferencedInterface]
    Represents a connection between two interface references.
    The source and target fields identify the endpoints of the connection, but do not determine signal direction. The direction of each interface signal is defined by the interface's mode and its InterfaceSignalConfiguration.

class Clock(*, name: str, clock: Port)
    Bases: ModelBase
    Represents a clock input
    parent : Module
        The module definition that this clock belongs to.
    name : str
    clock : Port

class ResetPolarity(value, names=None, *, module=None, qualname=None, type=None, start=1, boundary=None)
    Bases: Enum
    ACTIVE_LOW = 'active low'
    ACTIVE_HIGH = 'active high'

class Reset(*, name: str, reset: Port, polarity: ResetPolarity, synchronous_to: Clock | None = None)
    Bases: ModelBase
    Represents a reset input
    parent : Module
        The module definition that this reset belongs to.
    name : str
    reset : Port
    polarity : ResetPolarity
        Polarity of the reset signal.
```

synchronous_to : *Clock* | None

Clock to which this reset is synchronous to. None if the reset is asynchronous.

17.8 HDL Types

class Dimensions(upper: ~topwrap.model.misc.ElaboratableValue = <factory>, lower: ~topwrap.model.misc.ElaboratableValue = <factory>)

Bases: object

A pair of values representing bounds for a single dimension of a Logic type. Verilog examples: - logic -> upper == lower == 0 - logic[31:0] -> upper == 31, lower == 0 - logic[0:64] -> upper == 0, lower == 64

upper : *ElaboratableValue*

lower : *ElaboratableValue*

classmethod single(val: *ElaboratableValue*)

class Logic(name: str | None = None)

Bases: *ModelBase*, ABC

An abstract class representing anything that can be used as a logical type for a port or a signal in a module.

parent : *Logic* | None

The parent of this type. Used to create a reference tree between complex type definitions, for example between LogicArray and the inner type it contains or between a BitStruct and its fields. Is None when this represents a top-level type

name : VariableName | None

abstract copy() → *Logic*

Clones the Logic type in a way to create two separate object trees, so that a deeper modification to one tree is not be reflected in the other.

abstract property size : *ElaboratableValue*

All Logic subclasses should have an elaboratable size (the number of bits)

has_symbolic_dimensions(net_type: *Logic* | None) → bool

class Bit(name: str | None = None)

Bases: *Logic*

A single bit type. Equivalent to logic or logic[0:0] type in Verilog.

property size : *ElaboratableValue*

All Logic subclasses should have an elaboratable size (the number of bits)

copy()

Clones the Logic type in a way to create two separate object trees, so that a deeper modification to one tree is not be reflected in the other.

```
class LogicArray(*, name: str | None = None, dimensions: Iterable[Dimensions], item:
    _ArrayItemOrField)
```

Bases: `Logic`, `Generic[_ArrayItemOrField]`

A type representing a multidimensional array of logical elements.

property size

All Logic subclasses should have an elaboratable size (the number of bits)

copy()

Clones the Logic type in a way to create two separate object trees, so that a deeper modification to one tree is not be reflected in the other.

dimensions : list[*Dimensions*]

item : `_ArrayItemOrField`

```
class Bits(*, name: str | None = None, dimensions: Iterable[Dimensions])
```

Bases: `LogicArray[Bit]`

A multidimensional array of bits

```
class Enum(*, name: str | None = None, dimensions: Collection[Dimensions] = (), variants:
    Mapping[str, ElaboratableValue])
```

Bases: `Bits`

A bit vector limited to a range of predefined variants, each one with an explicit name.

copy()

Clones the Logic type in a way to create two separate object trees, so that a deeper modification to one tree is not be reflected in the other.

variants : dict[str, *ElaboratableValue*]

```
class StructField(*, name: str, type: _ArrayItemOrField)
```

Bases: `Logic`, `Generic[_ArrayItemOrField]`

A field in a BitStruct

copy()

Clones the Logic type in a way to create two separate object trees, so that a deeper modification to one tree is not be reflected in the other.

property size

All Logic subclasses should have an elaboratable size (the number of bits)

field_name : `VariableName`

type : `_ArrayItemOrField`

```
class BitStruct(*, name: str | None = None, fields: Iterable[StructField[Logic]])
```

Bases: `Logic`

A complex structural type equivalent to a struct `{...}` construct in SystemVerilog.

copy()

Clones the Logic type in a way to create two separate object trees, so that a deeper modification to one tree is not be reflected in the other.

property size

All Logic subclasses should have an elaboratable size (the number of bits)

fields : list[*StructField*[*Logic*]]

```
class LogicSelect(logic: ~topwrap.model.hdl_types.Logic, ops:
    list[~topwrap.model.hdl_types.LogicFieldSelect |
    ~topwrap.model.hdl_types.LogicBitSelect] = <factory>)
```

Bases: object

Represents an arbitrary selection of a part of a logical type. For example if self.logic references a multidimensional LogicArray, then you could have multiple LogicBitSelect operations in self.ops to select an arbitrary bit from that slice. Similarly, if there's a structure somewhere in the path you can add LogicFieldSelect to the operations to subscribe a specific logical field.

logic : *Logic*

ops : list[*LogicFieldSelect* | *LogicBitSelect*]

overlaps(other: *LogicSelect*) → bool

Checks if this selection of a logic type overlaps with another selection. An overlap occurs if two selections of types flatten to a packed bit-vector would target a range of the same bits. E.g.:

```
logic [127:0] a; wire [63:0] b = a[63:0]; wire [63:0] c = a[127:64]; wire
[51:0] d = a[100:50];
```

```
assert not b.overlaps(c) and not c.overlaps(b) assert b.overlaps(d) assert
c.overlaps(d) assert d.overlaps(c) and d.overlaps(b)
```

```
class LogicFieldSelect(field: StructField[Logic])
```

Bases: object

Represents access operation to a field of a structure

field : *StructField*[*Logic*]

```
class LogicBitSelect(slice: Dimensions)
```

Bases: object

Represents a logic array indexing operation

slice : *Dimensions*

17.9 Interconnects

```
class InterconnectParams
```

Bases: MarshmallowDataclassExtensions

Base class for parameters/settings specific to a concrete interconnect type

Schema

alias of InterconnectParams

class InterconnectManagerParams

Bases: `MarshmallowDataclassExtensions`

Base class for manager parameters specific to a concrete interconnect type

Schema

alias of `InterconnectManagerParams`

```
class InterconnectSubordinateParams(address: ~topwrap.model.misc.ElaboratableValue =
    <factory>, size:
    ~topwrap.model.misc.ElaboratableValue =
    <factory>)
```

Bases: `MarshmallowDataclassExtensions`

Base class for subordinate parameters specific to a concrete interconnect type.

Transactions to addresses in range `[self.address; self.address + self.size)` will be routed to this subordinate.

address : `ElaboratableValue.Field`

The start address of this subordinate in the memory map

size : `ElaboratableValue.Field`

The size in bytes of this subordinate's address space

Schema

alias of `InterconnectSubordinateParams`

```
class Interconnect(*, name: str, clock: ReferencedPort, reset: ReferencedPort, params:
    _IPAR, managers: Mapping[ObjectId[ReferencedInterface], _MANPAR] =
    {}, subordinates: Mapping[ObjectId[ReferencedInterface], _SUBPAR] =
    {}, memory_map: MemoryMap | None = None)
```

Bases: `ABC`, `Generic[_IPAR, _MANPAR, _SUBPAR]`

Base class for multiple interconnect generator implementations.

Interconnects connect multiple interface instances together in a many-to-many topology, combining multiple subordinates into a unified address space so that one or multiple managers can access them.

parent : *Design*

The design containing this interconnect

name : `VariableName`

clock : *ReferencedPort*

The clock signal for this interconnect

reset : *ReferencedPort*

The reset signal for this interconnect

params : `_IPAR`

Interconnect-wide type-specific parameters

managers : `dict[ObjectId[ReferencedInterface], _MANPAR]`

Manager interfaces controlling this interconnect described as a mapping between a referenced interface in a design and the type-specific manager configuration

subordinates : dict[*ObjectId*[*ReferencedInterface*], _SUBPAR]

Subordinate interfaces subject to this interconnect described in the same format as managers

memory_map : MemoryMap | None

17.10 Miscellaneous

exception TranslationError

Bases: Exception

Fatal error while translating between IR and other formats

exception RelationshipError

Bases: Exception

Logic error of an IR hierarchy, like trying to double-assign a parent to an object

exception NotElaboratedException

Bases: Exception

Elaboratable value accessed before it could be properly elaborated

set_parent(*child*: Any, *parent*: Any)

VariableName

A placeholder for a future, possibly bounded type for IR object names. For example we may want to reduce possible names to only alphanumerical strings in the future.

class QuerableView(**parts*: Sequence[_E])

Bases: Sequence[_E]

A lightweight proxy for exploring sequences of elements or concatenations of multiple sequences of elements in our IR, e.g. *Design.components*, *Module.ios*, etc. that has convenient methods for finding specific entries, for example by their name, which can replace such cumbersome constructs:

```
comp = next((c for c in design.components if c.name == "name"), None)
```

with:

```
comp = design.components.find_by_name("name")
```

```
find_by(filter: Callable[[_E], bool]) → _E | None
```

```
find_by_name(name: str) → _E | None
```

```
find_by_name_or_error(name: str) → _E
```

```
find_by_id_or_error(id: Identifier) → _E
```

class ModelBase

Bases: ABC

This is a base class for all IR objects implementing common behavior that should be shared by all of them. Currently it only assigns them unique *ObjectId* s.

```
class ObjectId(obj: _T)
```

```
Bases: Generic[_T]
```

Represents a runtime-unique id for an IR object that can always be resolved to that object and can be used as a dictionary key/set value.

```
resolve() → _T
```

Resolve this id to a concrete object instance

```
class ElaboratableValue(expr: int | str | IPCoreComplexParameter)
```

```
Bases: object
```

A WIP class aiming to represent any generic value that can be resolved to a concrete constant during elaboration.

It should be able to e.g. reference multiple Parameter s by name and perform arbitrary arithmetic operations on them.

```
raw : int | str | IPCoreComplexParameter
```

```
value : str
```

```
elaborate() → int | None
```

```
class DataclassRepr(*, load_default: ~typing.Any = <marshmallow.missing>, missing:
    ~typing.Any = <marshmallow.missing>, dump_default:
    ~typing.Any = <marshmallow.missing>, default: ~typing.Any =
    <marshmallow.missing>, data_key: str | None = None, attribute:
    str | None = None, validate: ~typing.Callable[[~typing.Any],
    ~typing.Any] | ~typing.Iterable[~typing.Callable[[~typing.Any],
    ~typing.Any]] | None = None, required: bool = False, allow_none:
    bool | None = None, load_only: bool = False, dump_only: bool =
    False, error_messages: dict[str, str] | None = None, metadata:
    ~typing.Mapping[str, ~typing.Any] | None = None,
    **additional_metadata)
```

```
Bases: Field
```

```
Field
```

```
alias of ElaboratableValue[ElaboratableValue]
```

```
class Identifier(name: str, vendor: str = 'vendor', library: str = 'libdefault', version:
    str = '0.1')
```

```
Bases: object
```

An advanced identifier of some IR objects that can benefit from storing more information than just their name. Based on the VLNv convention.

```
name : str
```

```
vendor : str = 'vendor'
```

```
library : str = 'libdefault'
```

```
version : str = '0.1'
```

```
static parse_vlnv(src: str) → Identifier
```

refers_to(other: Identifier) → bool

Whether this identifier - given as just a name, or as vendor:library:name - refers to other.

Mirrors how FuseSoC resolves a core name (eq_vln in the resolver, the bare-name lookup in fusesoc.main._get_core): name is compared case-insensitively, vendor / library are only checked when this identifier specifies them (i.e. is not left at the empty string or the field default), and version is ignored. Uniqueness / ambiguity is the caller's concern.

combined() → str

class FileReference(file: Path, line: int = 0, column: int = 0)

Bases: object

A reference to a particular location in a text file on the filesystem

file : Path

line : int = 0

column : int = 0

class Parameter(*, name: str, default_value: ElaboratableValue | None = None)

Bases: ModelBase

Represents a parameter definition for a HDL module

parent : Module

name : VariableName

default_value : ElaboratableValue | None

If a value for this parameter was not provided during elaboration, this default will be used.

class ExtensionData(*, name: str, data: Any)

Bases: ModelBase

Represents generic module data

parent : Module

name : VariableName

data : Any

17.11 A note on “sliced” vs. “independent” signals

There is specific terminology used in Topwrap in the context of interface signals. An interface is a collection of signals, each one being either sliced or independent. A sliced signal exists as a plain external port in Module.ports, either the entire port, or some arbitrary slice of it and is just a mapping for Topwrap to know that such a plain port actually realizes a specific signal of some defined interface.

For example, if the user had an IP core written in pure Verilog that used the AHB interface for data exchange and control, it would most likely have all AHB signals (haddr, htrans, hresp, etc.) present as individual external ports on it:

```
module custom_core (  
    input wire [31:0] haddr,  
    input wire [1:0]  htrans,  
    output wire       hresp,  
    ...  
);  
  
endmodule
```

If such a core was parsed into Topwrap’s internal representation, each such port would end up in `Module.ports`. Clearly though, all of these ports are actually realizing specific signals of the AHB interface. To store that information clearly in the IR, an `Interface` instance should be created and added to `Module.interfaces`. During the creation of this interface instance, the `Interface.signals` field needs to be filled with the mapping of each `InterfaceSignal` from the AHB’s `InterfaceDefinition` to a `ReferencedPort` referencing the plain port from `Module.ports`. Now each backend will know that despite there being an interface instance on this module, all of its signals are in reality just plain ports and when such a module is used in a design, appropriate code will be generated to interact with these ports. This situation, where an `InterfaceSignal` is mapped to a concrete plain port in the module, is called a “sliced” signal.

Now there is another type of a signal realization called an “independent” signal. Independent signals are not, and cannot be mapped to plain ports. They are transparent and get automatically connected to each other just by the action of connecting two interface instances together. This situation naturally corresponds to using the interface construct in SystemVerilog:

```
interface AHB_intf;  
    logic [31:0] haddr,  
    logic [1:0]  htrans,  
    logic       hresp,  
    ...  
endinterface  
  
module custom_core (  
    AHB_intf ahb_sub,  
    ...  
);  
  
endmodule
```

In the above example, the AHB interface is now explicit in the module definition itself. The individual signals still exist, but are enclosed in the interface instance and will get automatically connected in case two such interface instances are connected. There is still a need to store that interface in `Module.interfaces`, but now there doesn’t exist any plain port that the interface signals would map onto, thus instead of an `InterfaceSignal` mapping to a `ReferencedPort` in the IR, it’s mapped to `None` instead. With that, the backends will know that this signal is represented by the interface instance itself and generate appropriate code.

Generally, in a single IR `Interface` all signals are either “sliced” or “independent”, but a situation where majority of the signals are independent and a few are sliced or vice-versa is entirely

possible and should appropriately handled by a specific backend.

FRONTEND

Frontend is a class that transforms a specific format into IR. There are multiple frontends:

- SystemVerilogFrontend class supports SystemVerilog and Verilog files
- KpmFrontend class supports Pipeline Manager files
- YamlFrontend class supports YAML files
- IpXactFrontend class supports IP-XACT 2022 files

Frontends may be initialized with predefined modules and interfaces, which are used to resolve references while parsing. Parsed modules are returned in FrontendParseOutput, including modules whose identifiers match predefined modules. The handling of interfaces in FrontendParseOutput differs between frontends: SystemVerilogFrontend returns parsed or reused interface definitions, IpXactFrontend returns interface definitions parsed from abstractionDefinition files, while YamlFrontend and KpmFrontend only use predefined interfaces during parsing and do not return them. AutomaticFrontend preserves the behavior of the frontend it delegates to.

18.1 SystemVerilogFrontend

SystemVerilogFrontend class is used to parse System Verilog and Verilog files. It is mainly used for adding modules to a repo, connected by Topwrap in a design.yaml.

18.2 KpmFrontend

KpmFrontend class is used to parse KPM-specific files. It is mainly used for getting a design from a GUI.

18.3 YamlFrontend

YamlFrontend class is used to parse design.yaml and module.yaml files. It follows a format specified in *design description*.

18.4 IpXactFrontend

IpXactFrontend class is used to parse existing IP-XACT files the same way as SystemVerilogFrontend. Not all tags defined in the 2022 specification are supported. This frontend supports parsing component, design and abstractionDefinition root tags. Supported features are:

- VLNV, parameters, ports and busInterfaces in component root tag. views tag is unused and only one designConfigurationInstantiation is supported. Only one componentInstantiation tag is supported.
- componentInstances, adHocConnections and interconnections in design root tag.
- ports, with support for only logicalName, onTarget and onInitiator in port in abstractionDefinition root tag.

BACKEND

Backend is a class that transforms IR into a specific output format. There are multiple backends:

- SystemVerilogBackend class generates SystemVerilog top files
- KpmBackend class generates Pipeline Manager files
- IpCoreDescriptionBackend and DesignDescriptionBackend classes generate YAML files
- IPXACTBackend class generates IP-XACT 2022 files

19.1 SystemVerilogBackend

SystemVerilogBackend class is used to generate a SystemVerilog top wrapper from a design. It is the backend used by `topwrap generate`, see *Generating Verilog top files*.

19.2 KpmBackend

KpmBackend class is used to generate Pipeline Manager specification and dataflow files. It is mainly used to export a design to the GUI.

19.3 YAML backends

IpCoreDescriptionBackend and DesignDescriptionBackend classes are used to generate IP core description and design description YAML files, respectively. They follow the format specified in *design description*.

19.4 IPXACTBackend

IPXACTBackend class is used to generate IP-XACT 2022 files from a design. It produces component, design and abstractionDefinition/busDefinition files and relies on the `topwrap-ipxact-parser` library. For interconnects it reuses the SystemVerilog generators, as different HDL backends may yield different IR modules.

This is the backend used by `topwrap generate --ipxact`, see *Generating IPXACT 2022 files*. For details on the IP-XACT format and the Topwrap to IP-XACT conversion, see the *IP-XACT format* document.

19.4.1 UNSPECIFIED interface type

Interfaces defined in module can have MANAGER, SUBORDINATE or UNSPECIFIED types. This types are used to select direction of port. IPXACT 2022 don't have ability to represent UNSPECIFIED type. When IPXACTBackend encounters UNSPECIFIED type it will log warning and proceed as if it was MANAGER type.

19.4.2 Elaborating parameters

Elaboration of parameters that are present in widths of ports and interfaces is not supported. Generated IPXACT files can contain illegal widths, it is recommended to use sed to change them to selected values.

FUSESOCBUILDER

Topwrap supports generating FuseSoC .core files with `FuseSocBuilder`. The .core file contains information about source files and synthesis tools.

Generation of FuseSoC .core files is based on a Jinja template that defaults to `topwrap/templates/core.yaml.j2`, but can be overridden.

Here's an example of how to generate a simple project:

```
from topwrap.fuse_helper import FuseSocBuilder
fuse = FuseSocBuilder()

# add source of the IPs used in the project
fuse.add_source('DMATop.v', 'verilogSource')

# add source of the top file
fuse.add_source('top.v', 'verilogSource')

# specify the names of the core file and the directory where sources are stored
# generate the project
fuse.build('build/top.core', 'sources')
```

Warning: Default template in `topwrap/templates/core.yaml.j2` does not make use of resources added with `add_external_ip()`, i.e. they won't be present in the generated core file.

class `FuseSocBuilder`(`part`: `str` | `None`)

Use this class to generate a FuseSoc .core file

add_dependency(`dependency`: `str` | `Identifier`)

Adds a dependency to the list of dependencies in the core file

add_external_ip(`vlnv`: `str`, `name`: `str`)

Store information about IP Cores from Vivado library to generate hooks that will add the IPs in a TCL script.

add_fileset(`name`: `str`, `files`: `list[SourceFile]`, `depends`: `list[Identifier]`)

Add a complete fileset to the core file

add_script(`name`: `str`, `args`: `list[str]`)

Add a named fusesoc script

add_source(filename: Path, type: str)

Adds an HDL source to the list of sources in the core file

add_sources_dir(sources_dir: Collection[Path], core_path: Path)

Given a name of a directory, add all files found inside it. Recognize VHDL, Verilog, and XDC files.

add_target(target: FuseSocTarget)

Add a named fusesoc target

build(top_name: str, core_path: Path, sources_dir: Collection[Path] = [])

Generate the final create .core file

Parameters

sources_dir: Collection[Path] = []

additional directory with source files to add

template_name

name of jinja2 template to be used, either in working directory, or bundled with the package. defaults to a bundled template

20.1 Customizations

By default, Topwrap will generate a core file with a default target of running Vivado on the top-level defined by the Topwrap project. This can be overridden in several ways. To disable the generation of a default Vivado target, you would call

```
from topwrap.fuse_helper import FuseSocBuilder
fuse = FuseSocBuilder(None)

fuse.set_generate_vivado(False) # disables the default vivado target
```

You can add custom targets by constructing FuseSocTarget. Here's an example to create a Verilator flow-target that builds and runs a testbench:

```
from pathlib import Path

from topwrap.fuse_helper import (
    FuseSocBuilder,
    FuseSocFlowApi,
    FuseSocTarget,
    SourceFile,
)

fuse = FuseSocBuilder(None)

fuse.set_generate_vivado(False)

# Add a source to the default `rtl` fileset
fuse.add_source(Path("top.v"), "verilogSource")
toplevel = "top" # toplevel, as defined in top.v
```

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```
# Add a second fileset, `verilator_tb`, with testbench
fuse.add_fileset(
    "verilator_tb",
    files=[SourceFile(Path("top_tb.sv"), "systemVerilogSource")],
    depends=[],
)

# Add a testbench target `tb`, that references both the default fileset and the
↳ custom
fuse.add_target(
    FuseSocTarget(
        "tb",
        toplevel,
        FuseSocFlowApi(
            type="sim",
            options={
                "tool": "verilator",
                "mode": "cc",
                "verilator_options": ["-Wno-fatal", "--main", ["--timing"]],
            },
            make_options=["-s"],
        ),
        filesets=["rtl", "verilator_tb"],
        hooks=[],
    )
)

fuse.build(toplevel, Path("top.core"))
```

This will generate the following:

```
CAPI=2:
name: ::top
description: Core file generated by TopWrap
filesets:
  verilator_tb:
    files:
      - top_tb.sv:
          file_type: systemVerilogSource
  rtl:
    files:
      - top.v:
          file_type: verilogSource
targets:
  tb:
    filesets:
      - rtl
      - verilator_tb
```

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```
toplevel: top
flow: sim
flow_options:
  tool: verilator
  mode: cc
  verilator_options:
    - -Wno-fatal
    - --main
    - - --timing
  flow_make_options:
    - -s
```

INTERFACE DEFINITION

Topwrap uses *interface definition files* for its parsing functionality.

These are used to match a given set of signals that appear in the HDL source with signals in the interface definition.

InterfaceDefinition is defined as a `marshmallow_dataclass.dataclass` - this enables loading the YAML structure into Python objects and performs validation (that the YAML is in the correct format) and typechecking (that the loaded values are of the correct types).

CONFIG

The `Config` object stores configuration values. The global `topwrap.config.Config` object is used throughout the codebase to access the Topwrap configuration.

It is created by `ConfigManager` that reads the config files as defined in `topwrap.config.ConfigManager.DEFAULT_SEARCH_PATHS`, with local files taking precedence. For flows consuming a design YAML, the configuration is additionally overridden in the pre-parse stage.

```
class Config(force_interface_compliance: bool | None = False, repositories: dict[str,  
    ~topwrap.resource_field.ResourceReferenceHandler] = <factory>, libraries:  
    dict[str, str] = <factory>)
```

Global topwrap configuration

Schema

alias of `Config`

```
class ConfigManager(search_paths: Sequence[Path] | None = None)
```

Manager used to load topwrap's configuration from files.

The configuration files are loaded in a specific order, which also determines the priority of settings that are defined differently in the files. The list of default search paths is defined in the `DEFAULT_SEARCH_PATH` class variable. Configuration files that are specified earlier in the list have higher priority and can overwrite the settings from the files that follow. The default list of search paths can be changed by passing a different list to the `ConfigManager` constructor.

VALIDATION OF DESIGN

One of topwrap features is to run validation on user's design which consists of series of checks for errors user may do while creating a design.

class DataflowValidator(*dataflow*: dict[str, Any])

The main class that contains all the validation checks. The purpose of validation is to check for common errors the user may make while creating the design and make sure the design can be saved in topwrap yaml format. These functions are called in two cases:

- 1) When there is a call from KPM for `dataflow_validate` (the user has clicked Validate in GUI)
- 2) When a user tries to save the design

check_connection_to_subgraph_metanodes() → *CheckResult*

Check for any connections to exposed subgraph metanode ports.

In this context:

- **Exposed port:** A port on a subgraph metanode that represents the interface of the subgraph to the external graph. It is visible and accessible from outside the subgraph.
- **Unexposed port:** An internal port on a subgraph metanode that is used for internal connections within the subgraph but is not accessible from the external graph.

These metanodes are meant to represent ports of subgraph nodes. Connections to these metanodes should only occur via the unexposed ports. Any connection to an exposed port is considered an error because such connections cannot be represented in the design.

check_duplicate_metanode_names() → *CheckResult*

Check for duplicate names of external metanodes. The name of metanode is in "External Name" property. In design, these external metanodes are referenced by this name so if there are multiple metanodes with the same name it will not be possible to represent them, hence the error.

check_duplicate_node_names() → *CheckResult*

Check for any duplicate IP instance names in the graph (graph represents a hierarchy level). This check prevents from creating multiple nodes with the same "instanceName" in a given graph, since this is invalid in design. There can be multiple nodes with the same "instanceName" in the whole design (on various hierarchy levels).

check_external_in_to_external_out_connections() → *CheckResult*

Check for connections between two external metanodes. In our design format (YAML), connections to external nodes are always represented as *port: external*, regardless of whether the *external* node is an input or output. Therefore, connections directly between two external metanodes cannot be represented within this format and are invalid by design.

check_external_io_exposed_ifaces()

Check whether subgraph interfaces are the same as interfaces opposite to connected External I/O node interfaces inside the subgraph.

check_parameters_values() → *CheckResult*

Check if parameters in IP nodes are valid.

This check ensures users are informed of any errors in parameter definitions. While it is possible to save the design with invalid parameters (e.g. save to YAML), such a design cannot be successfully built into Verilog because integer widths of all parameters must be determined during the build process.

A parameter is considered valid if it meets any of the following conditions:

- It is an instance of `int`.
- It has a correct value format, e.g.: `16'h5A5A`.
- **It can be evaluated based on other parameters, e.g.:**
`ADDR_WIDTH: 32`
`DATA_WIDTH: ADDR_WIDTH/4` (evaluates to 8, which is valid).

check_port_to_multiple_external_metanodes() → *CheckResult*

Check for ports that have connections to multiple external metanodes. Design schema allows only one connection between an IPcore/hierarchy port and an external metanode. The connection between the port and external metanode is a single entry, not a list that's why we can't add more connections.

check_unconnected_ports_interfaces() → *CheckResult*

Check for unconnected ports or interfaces. This check helps identify any unconnected elements, warning the user about potential oversights or missed connections.

check_unnamed_external_metanodes_with_multiple_conn() → *CheckResult*

Check for external metanodes that are connected to more than one port and don't have a user-specified name. This is important to check because it is an undefined behavior when saving a design. Currently, when there is a connection to an unnamed metanode in design this metanode will have the name of the port it's connected to.

validate_kpm_design() → `dict[str, list[str]]`

Run checks to validate the user-created design in KPM. Checks are designed to inform the user about errors present in his design that make it impossible to save and display warnings about potential issues in the design.

Each check returns the following class:

```
class CheckResult(check_name: str, status: MessageType, error_count: int = 0, message: str | None = None)
```

Return type of each validation check

Parameters

check_name : str

Name of the check

status : MessageType

Check can be return one of three MessageType (OK, ERROR, WARNING)

- OK - this status is set when check was successful
- WARNING - check have failed but it is possible to represent the graph in design yaml
- ERROR - it is not possible to represent graph in design yaml

error_count : int

Number of errors if status is not OK

message : str | None

Message describing errors

23.1 Tests for validation checks

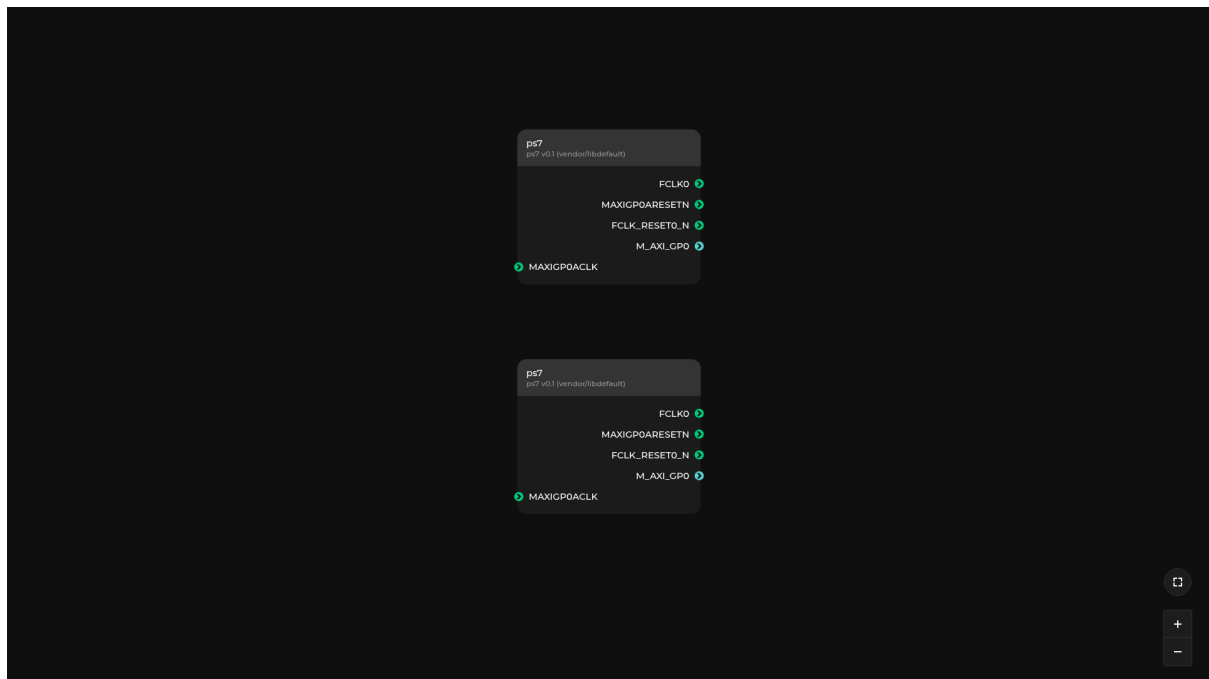
Tests for the DataflowValidator class are done using various designs that are valid or have some errors in them with the goal to check everything validation functions can do.

Below are all the graphs that are used for testing.

23.1.1 Duplicate IP names

dataflow_duplicate_ip_names()

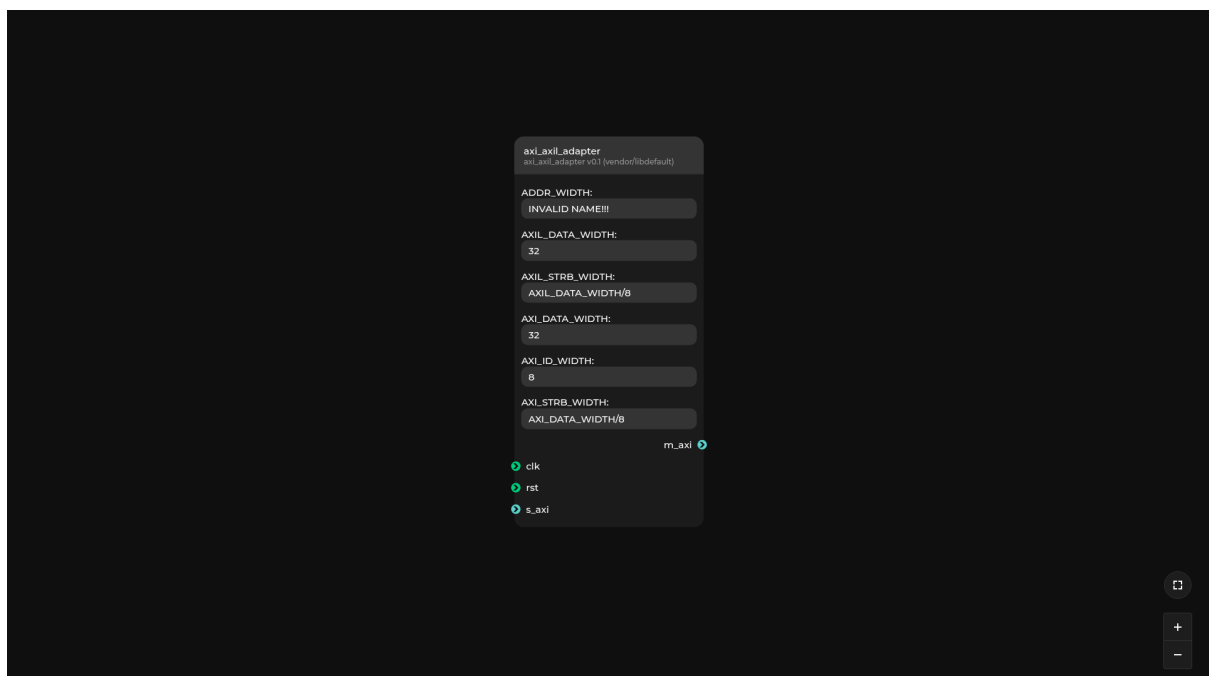
Dataflow containing two IP cores with the same instance name. This is considered as not possible to represent in design yaml since we can't distinguish them.



23.1.2 Invalid parameters' values

dataflow_invalid_parameters_values()

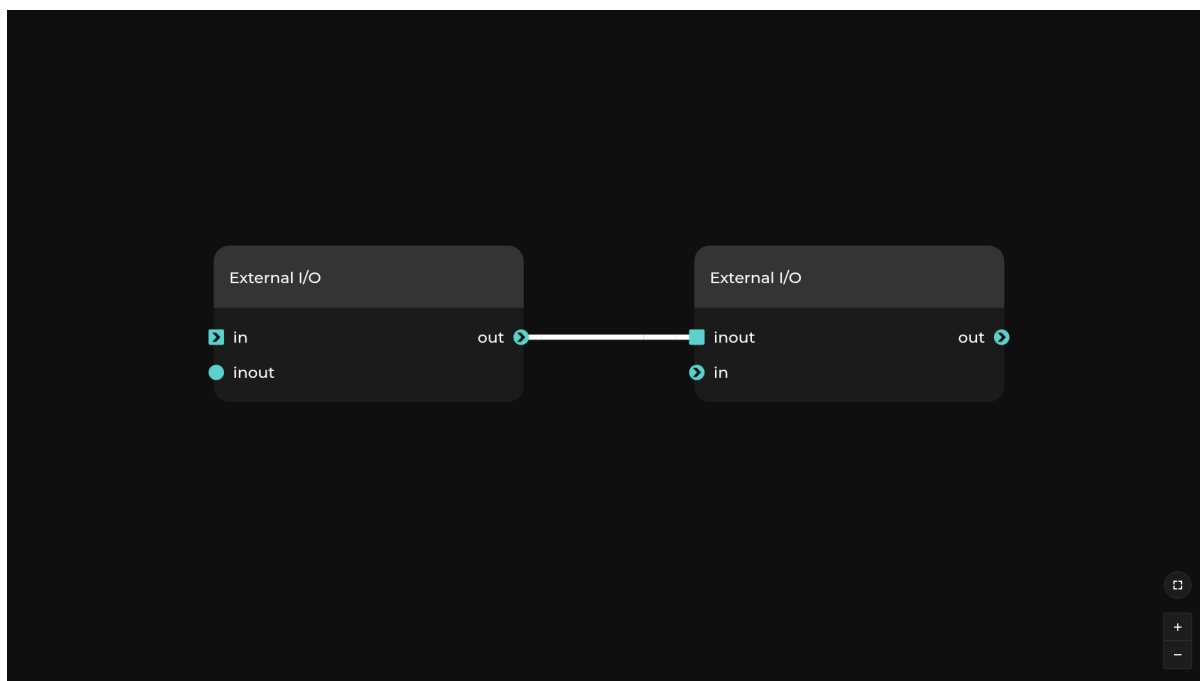
Dataflow containing an IP core with multiple parameters, but it's impossible to resolve the *INVALID NAME!!!*.



23.1.3 Connection between external Metanodes

`dataflow_ext_in_to_ext_out_connections()`

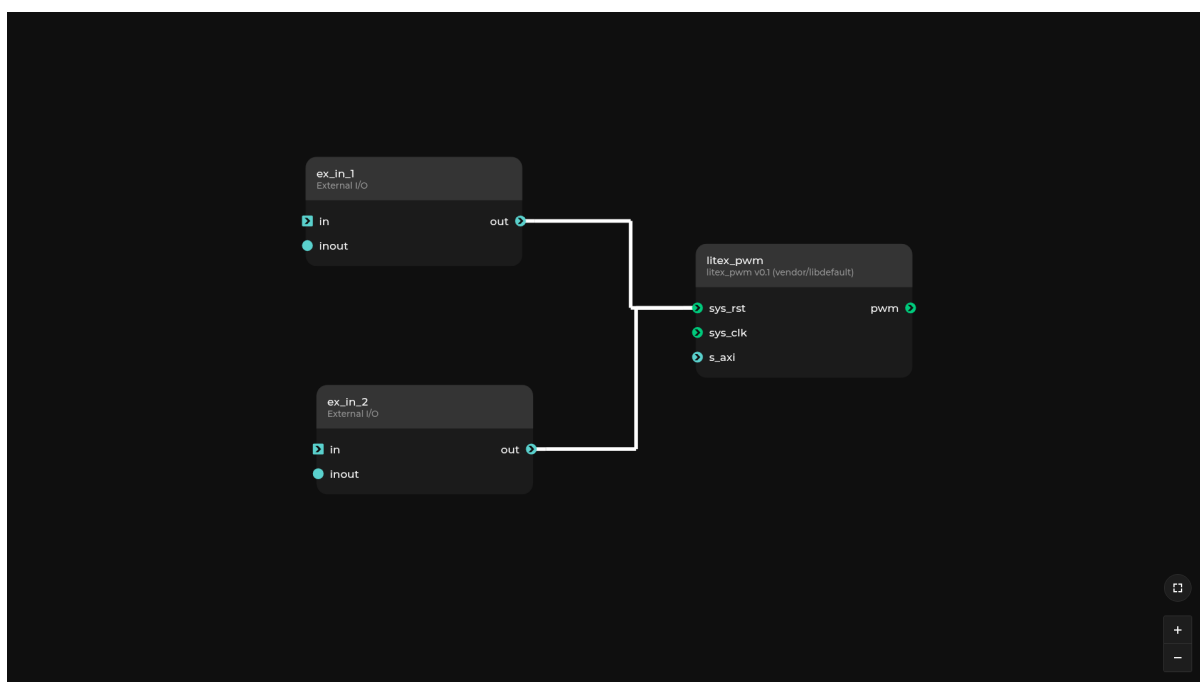
Dataflow containing Metanode<->Metanode connection.



23.1.4 Ports connected to multiple external Metanodes

`dataflow_ports_multiple_external_metanodes()`

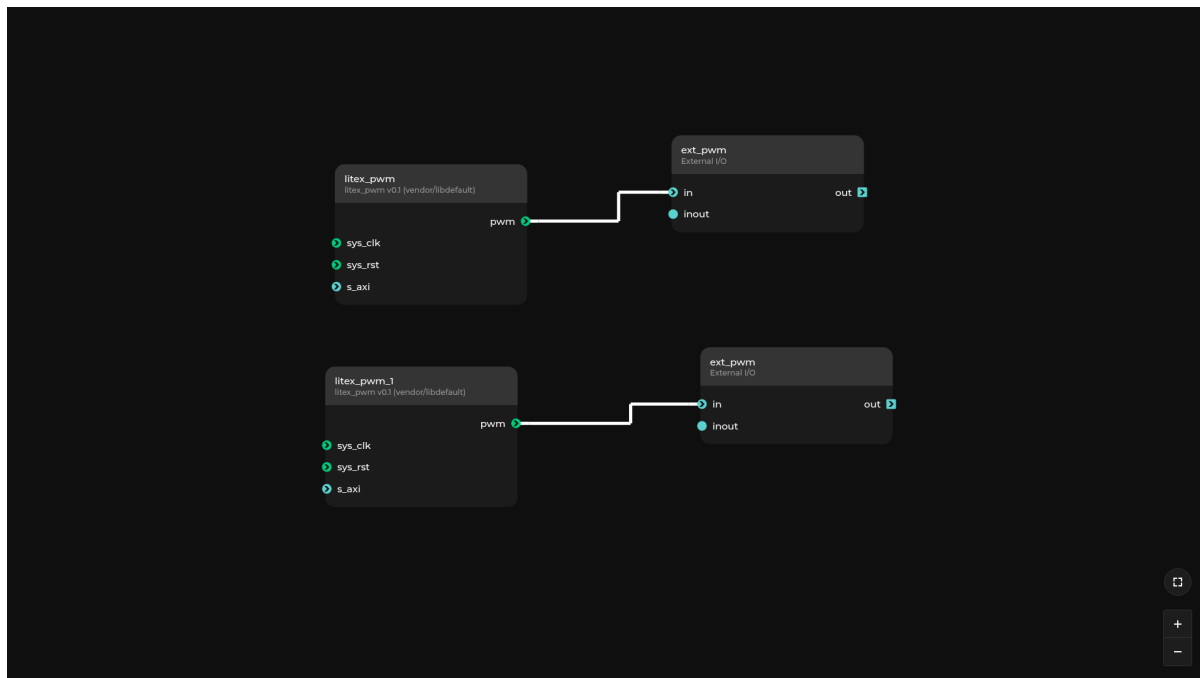
Dataflow containing a port connected to two External Metanodes.



23.1.5 Duplicate Metanode names

dataflow_duplicate_metanode_names()

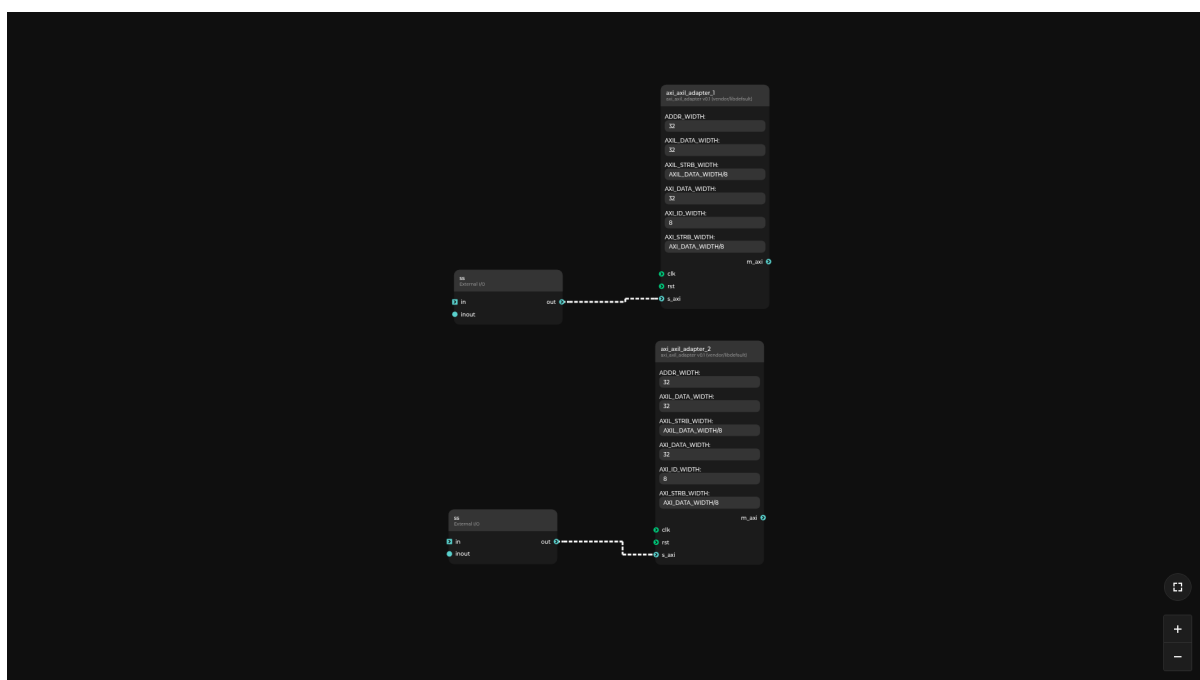
Dataflow containing two External Output Metanodes with the same “External Name” value.



23.1.6 Duplicate Metanode connected to interface

dataflow_duplicate_external_input_interfaces()

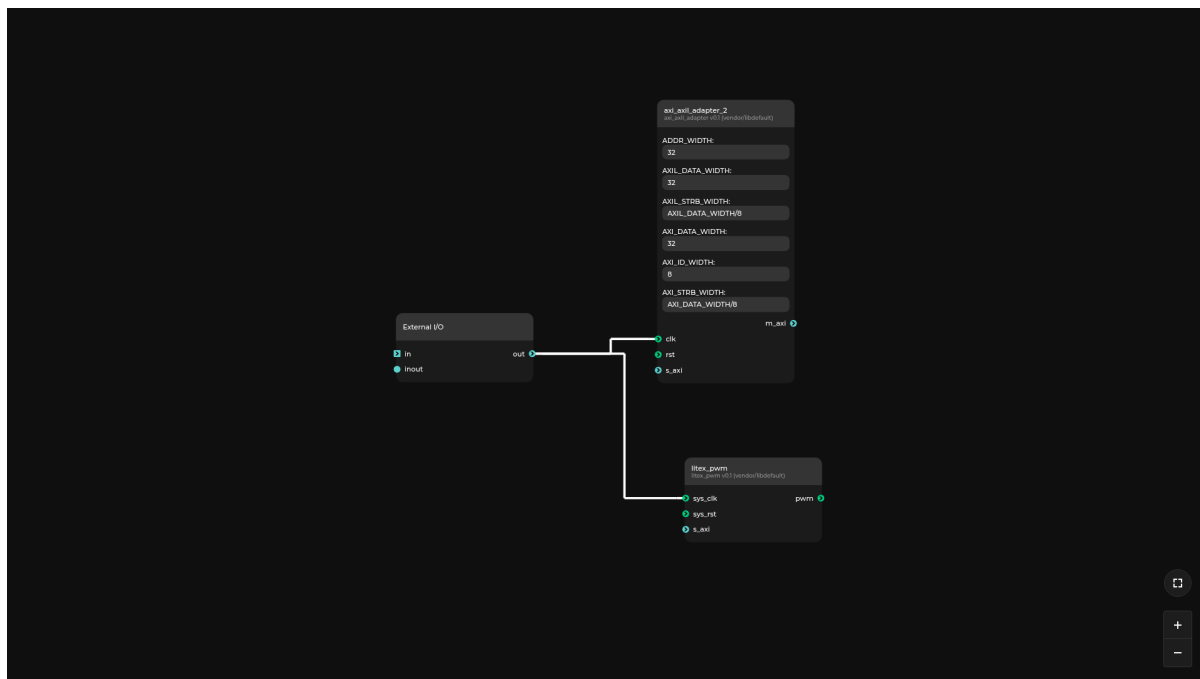
Dataflow containing two External Input Metanodes with the same name. Here connection is to interface instead of port as in the example above.



23.1.7 Unnamed Metanodes

dataflow_unnamed_metanodes()

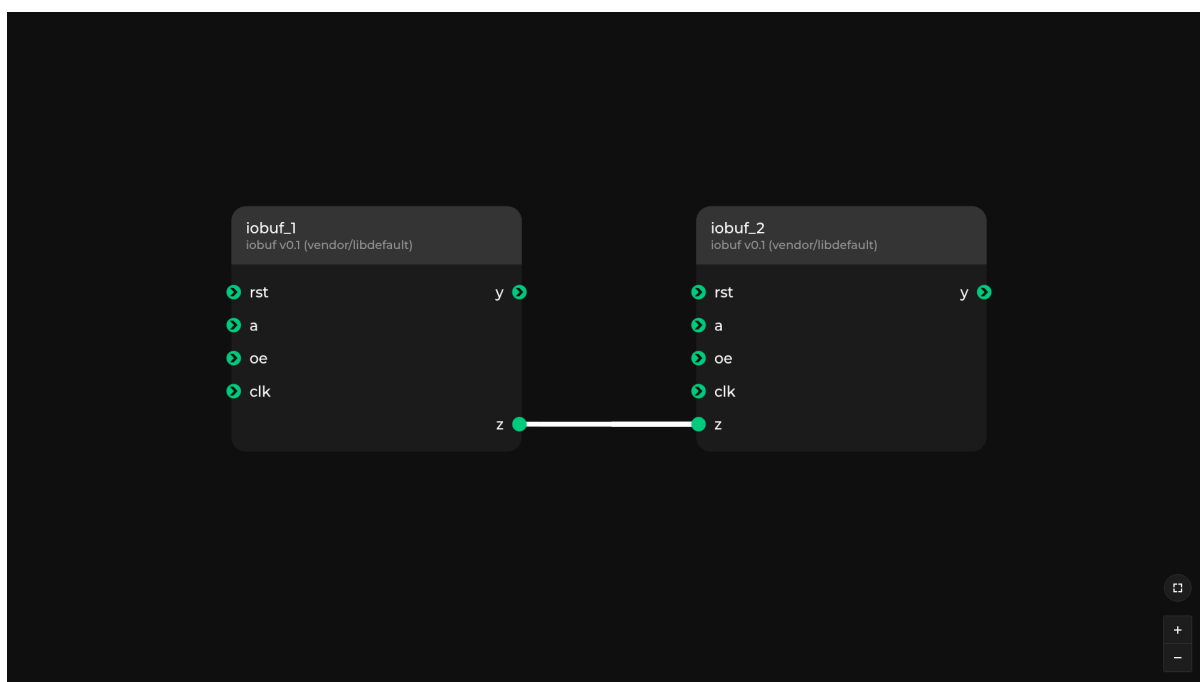
Dataflow containing unnamed External Input Metanode with multiple connections to it.



23.1.8 Connection between two inout ports

dataflow_inouts_connections()

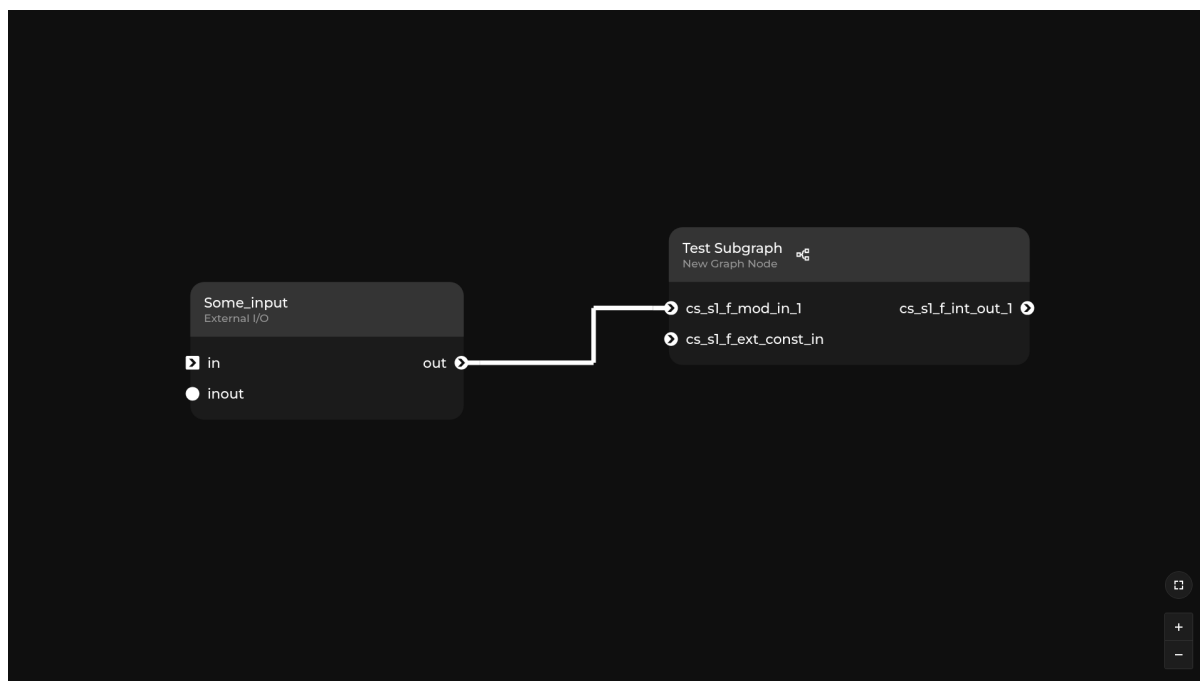
Dataflow containing a connection between two inout ports.



23.1.9 Unconnected ports in subgraph node

`dataflow_unconn_hierarchy()`

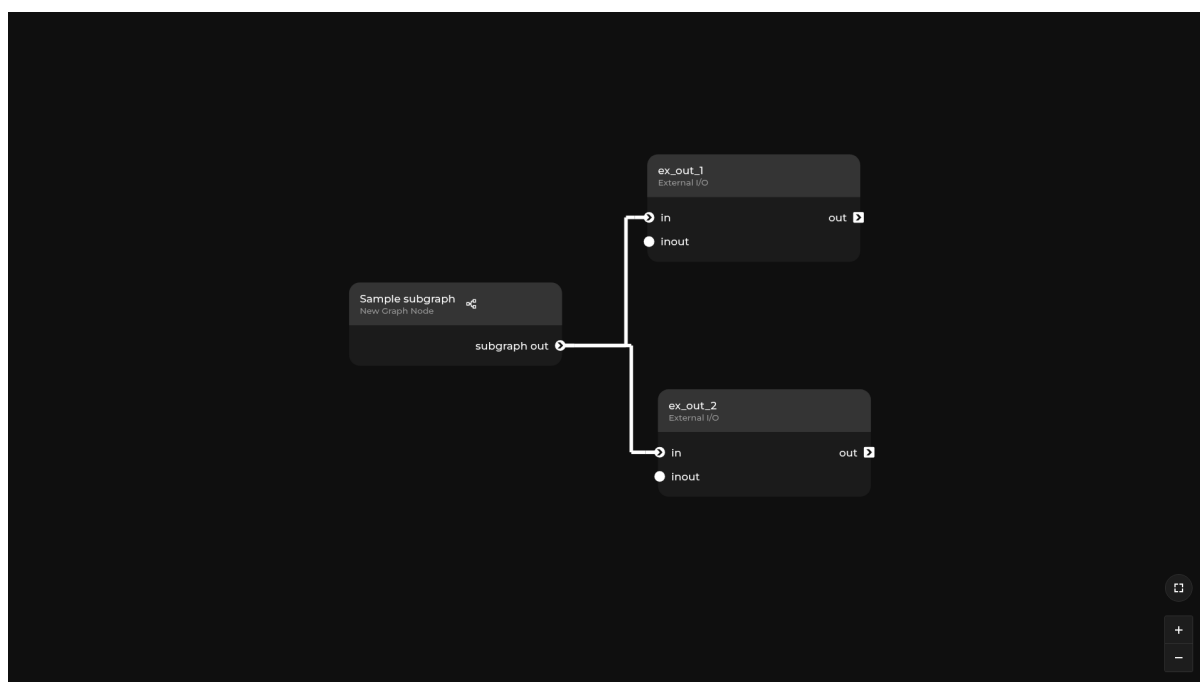
Dataflow containing subgraph node with two unconnected interfaces.



23.1.10 Connection of subgraph node to multiple External Metanodes

`dataflow_subgraph_multiple_external_metanodes()`

Dataflow containing subgraph node with connection to two External Output Metanodes.



23.1.11 Connection to subgraph Metanode

dataflow_conn_subgraph_metanode()

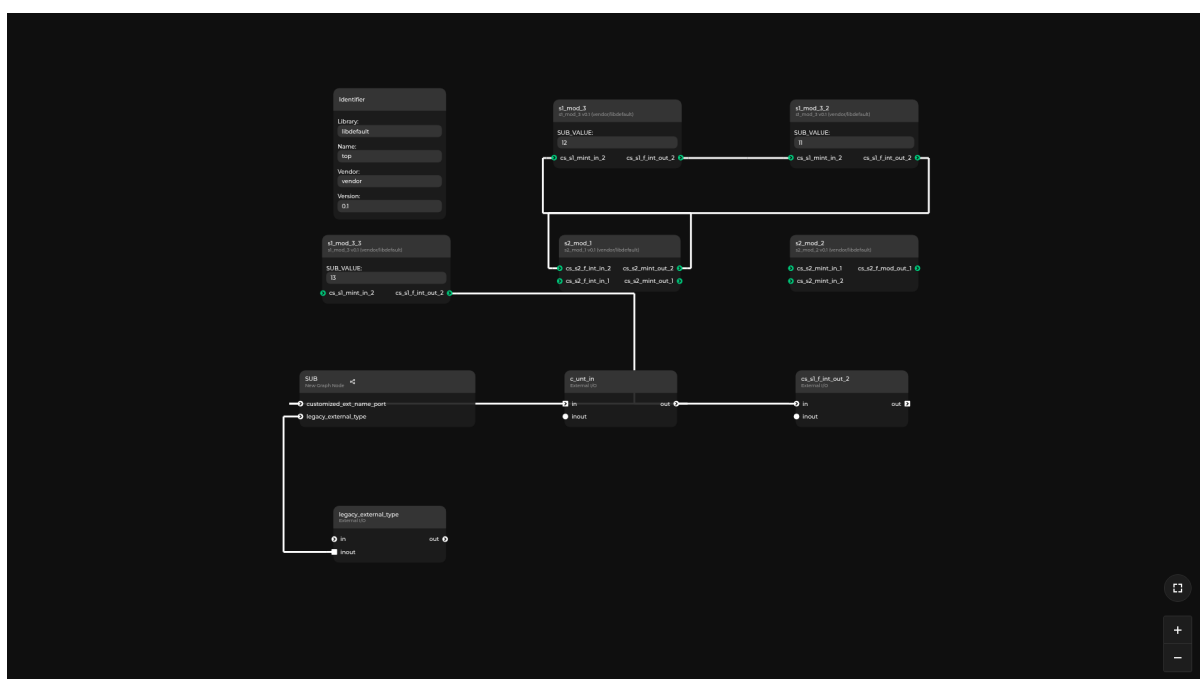
Dataflow containing subgraph metanode with connection to exposed interface. It can be seen by selecting the “Edit Subgraph” on subgraph node.



23.1.12 Complex hierarchy graph

dataflow_complex_hierarchy()

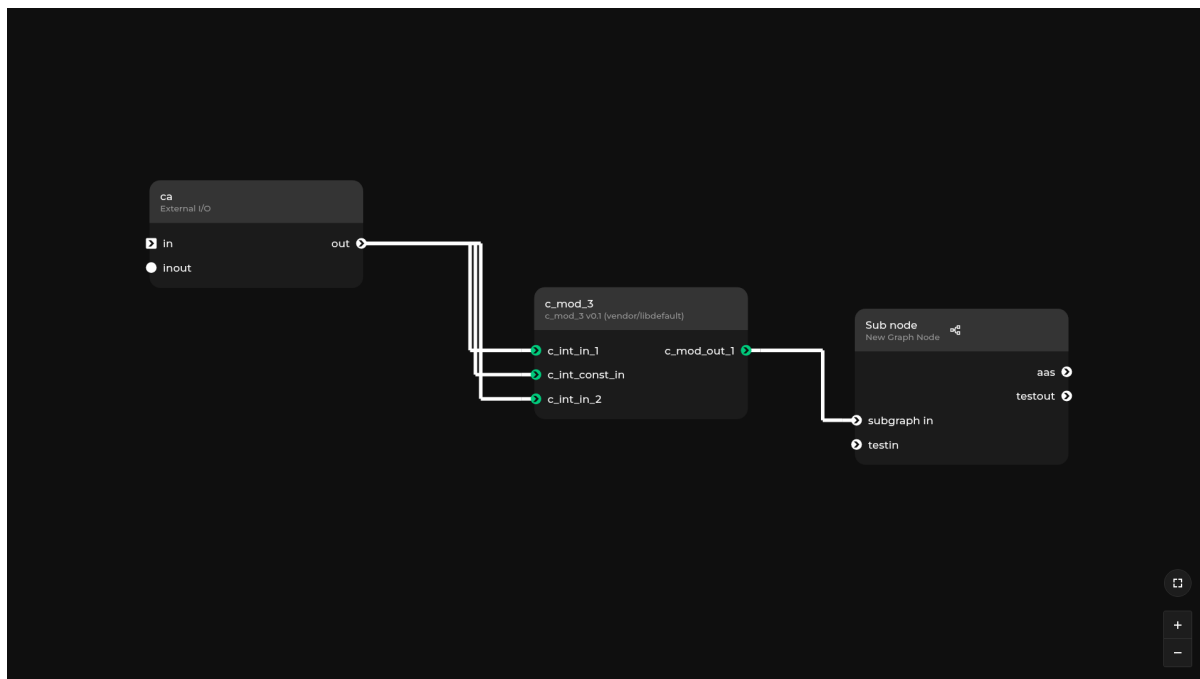
Dataflow containing many edge cases such as duplicate subgraph node names, stressing out the capabilities of saving a design.



23.1.13 Duplicate IP cores in subgraph node

`dataflow_hier_duplicate_names()`

Dataflow containing subgraph node inside which are duplicate IP's.



FUTURE PLANNED ENHANCEMENTS IN TOPWRAP

24.1 Library of open-source cores

Currently, users have to manually or semi-manually (e.g. through FuseSoC) supply all of the cores used in the design. In future, a repository of open-source cores that can be easily reused will be provided, allowing users to quickly put together designs from premade hardware blocks.

24.2 Support for hierarchical block designs in Topwrap's GUI

Topwrap supports creating hierarchical designs by manually writing the hierarchy in the design description YAML, while in future, this feature will be additionally supported in the GUI for visually organizing complex designs.

24.3 Support for parsing SystemVerilog sources

Information about IP cores is stored in *IP description files*. These files can be generated automatically from HDL source files - currently Verilog and VHDL are supported. In a future release, Topwrap will also provide the possibility of generating YAMLS from SystemVerilog.

OTHER POSSIBLE IMPROVEMENTS

25.1 Ability to produce top-level wrappers in VHDL

Topwrap currently has a SystemVerilog backend and an *IP-XACT backend* for generating top-level designs. We would also like to add the ability to produce such designs in VHDL.

25.2 Bus management

Another feature that could be introduced is allowing users to create full-featured designs with processors by providing proper support for bus management.

This should include features such as:

- the ability to specify the address of a peripheral device on the bus
- support for the most popular buses (AXI, TileLink, Wishbone)

This will require writing or creating bus arbiters (round-robin, crossbar) and providing a mechanism for connecting manager(s) and subordinate(s) together. As a result, the user would be able to create complex SoCs directly in Topwrap.

Currently, only experimental support for *Wishbone with a round-robin arbiter* is available.

25.3 Improve the process of recreating a design from a YAML file

One of the main features supported by Topwrap and the GUI is exporting and importing user-created designs, both to or from a *design description* YAML. However, during these conversions, information about the position of user-added nodes is not preserved. This is cumbersome in the case of complicated designs since the imported nodes are not retained in the most optimal positions.

Therefore, one of our objectives is to provide a convenient way of creating and restoring user-created designs in the GUI, so that the node positions are retained.

25.4 Deeper integration with other tools

Topwrap can build designs, but testing and synthesis rely on the user - they have to automate this process themselves (e.g. with makefiles). To improve the usability of Topwrap, a potential area of improvement is to integrate tools for synthesis, simulation and co-simulation (with e.g. **Renode** with Topwrap, accessible through scripts. Some could be pre-packaged with Topwrap (e.g. simulation with Verilator, synthesis with Vivado).

It could also be possible to invoke these from the GUI by adding custom buttons or through the integrated terminal.

25.5 Provide a way to parse HDL sources from the GUI level

Another issue related to HDL parsing is that the user has to manually parse HDL sources to obtain the IP core description YAMLS. These files then need to be provided as command-line parameters when launching the Topwrap GUI client application. Therefore, we aim to provide a way of parsing HDL files directly from the GUI.

USING KPM IFRAMES INSIDE DOCS

It is possible to use the `pipeline_manager` Sphinx directive to embed KPM directly inside a doc.

26.1 Usage

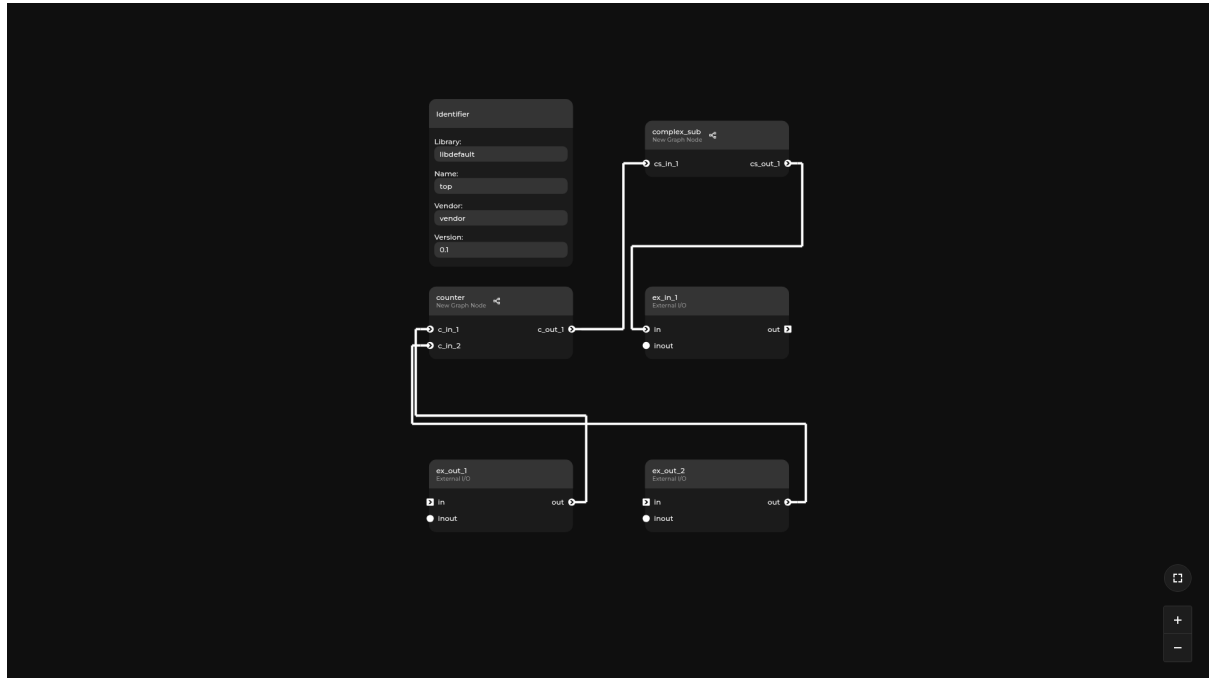
```
```{pipeline_manager}
:spec: <KPM specification .json file URI>
:graph: <KPM dataflow .json file URI>
:preview: <a Boolean value specifying whether this KPM should be started in_
↪preview mode>
:height: <a string CSS height property that sets the `height` of the iframe>
:alt: <a custom alternative text used in the PDF documentation instead of the_
↪default one>
```
```

URI represents either a local file from sources that are copied into the build directory, or a remote resource.

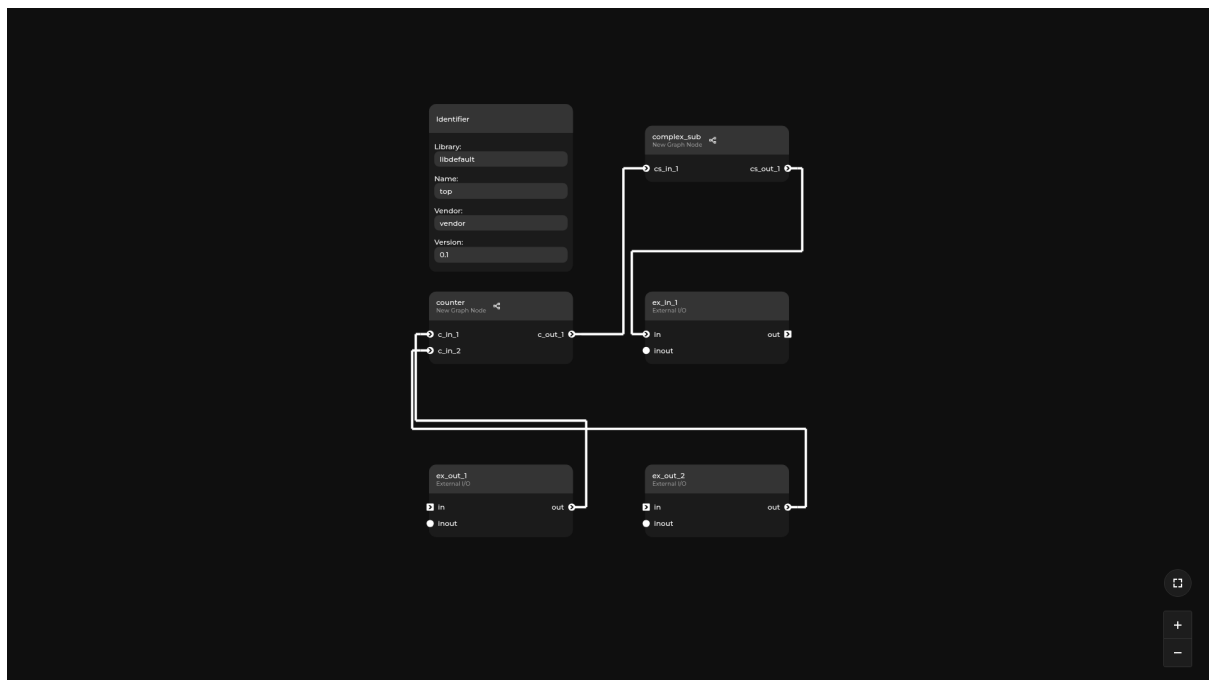
All parameters in this directive are optional.

26.2 Tests

26.2.1 Use local files

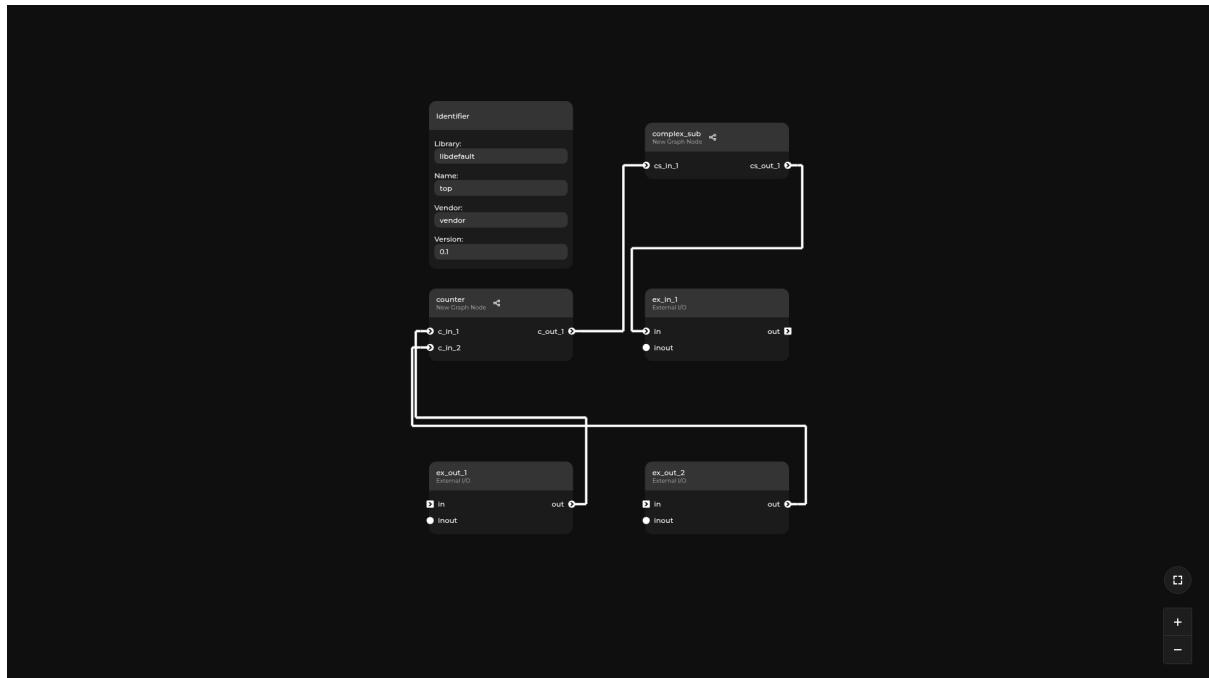


26.2.2 Open in preview mode



26.2.3 Use a custom alt text

Note: The alternative text is visible instead of the iframe in the PDF version of this documentation.



EXAMPLES FOR INTERNAL REPRESENTATION

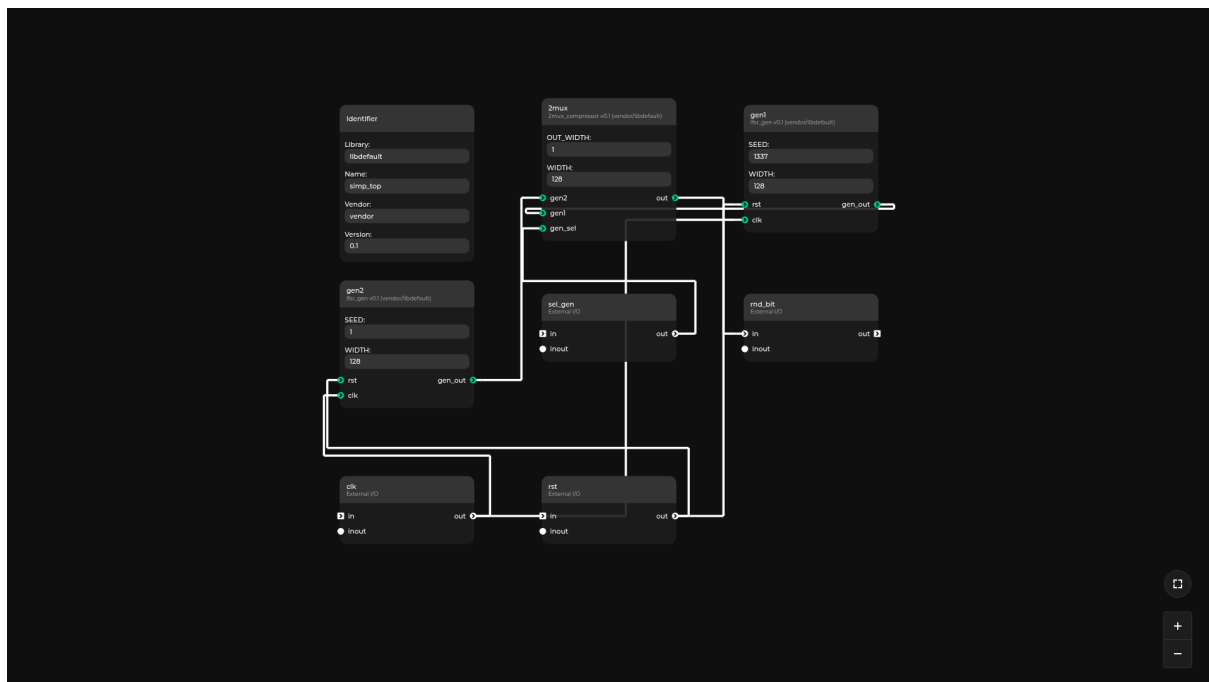
There are four examples in `examples/ir_examples` showcasing specific features of Topwrap which we want to take into consideration while creating the new internal representation.

27.1 Simple

This is a simple non-hierarchical example that uses two IPs. Inside, there are two LFSR RNGs constantly generating pseudorandom numbers on their outputs. They are both connected to a multiplexer that selects which generator's output should be passed to the `rnd_bit` external output port. The specific generator is selected using the `sel_gen` input port.

This example features:

- IP core parameters
- variable width ports

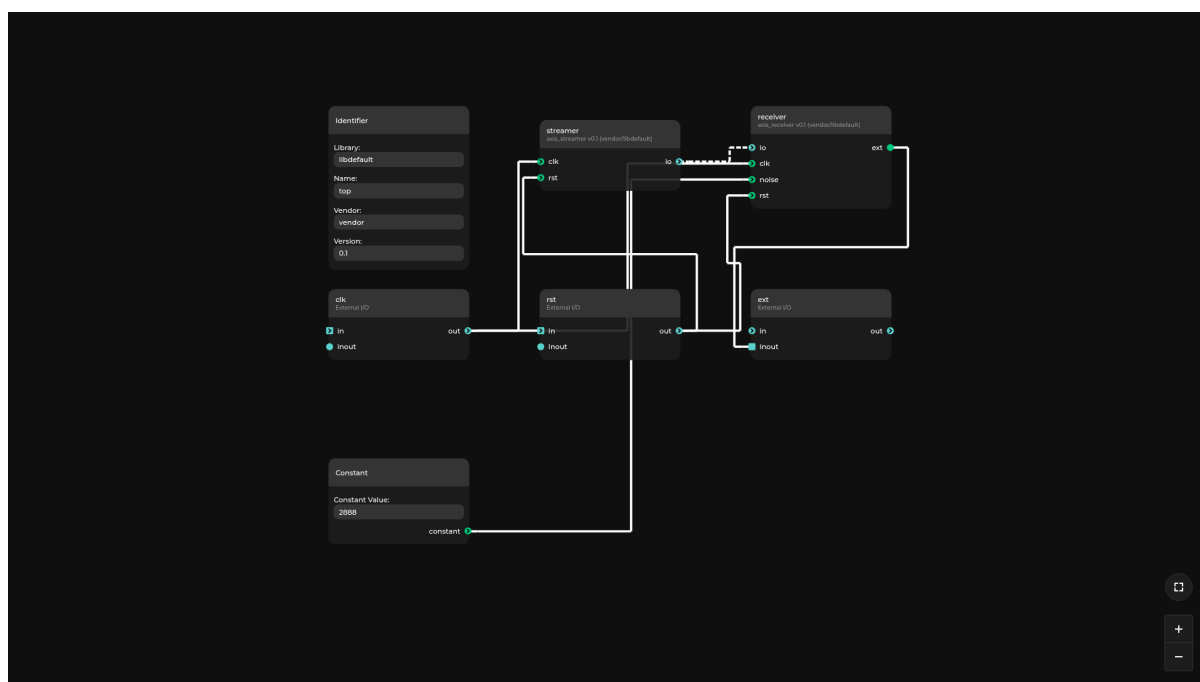


27.2 Interface

This is another simple example using two IPs, this time with an interface. The design consists of a streamer IP and a receiver IP. They both are connected using the AXI4Stream interface. The receiver then passes the data to an external inout port.

This example features:

- usage of interface ports
- port slicing
- constant value connected to a port
- an Inout port

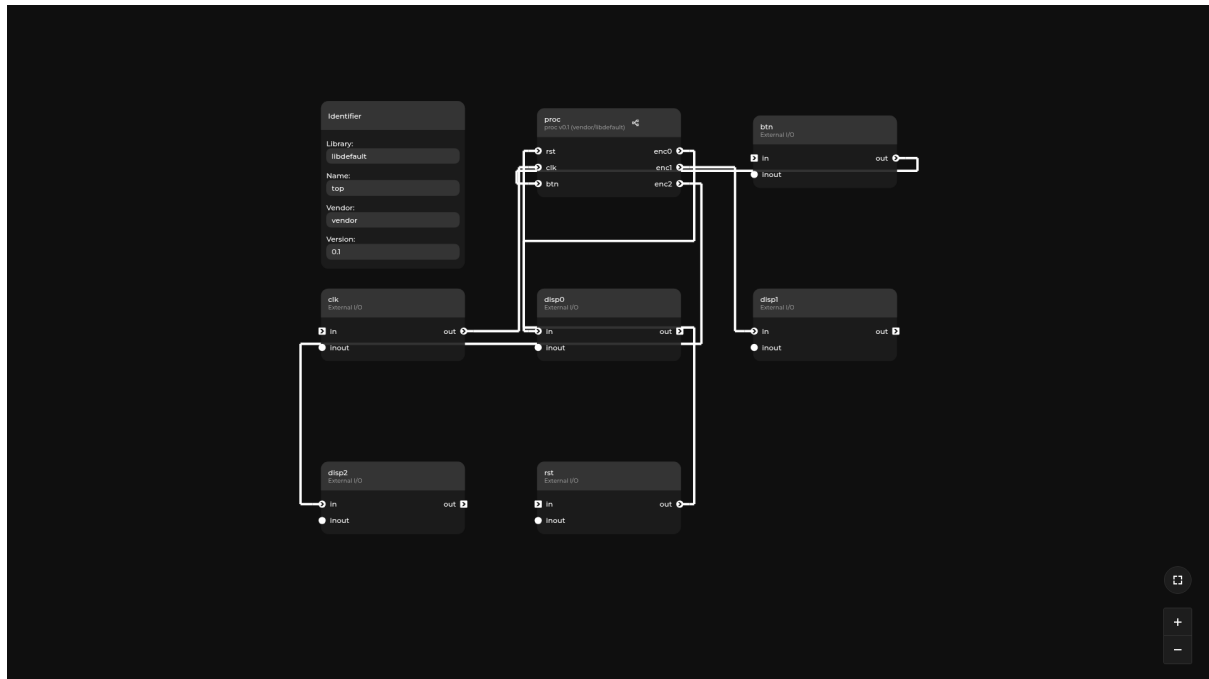


27.3 Hierarchical

This is an example of a hierarchical design. The top-level features standard external ports `clk` and `rst`, a `btn` input that represents an input from a physical button, and `disp0..2` outputs that go to an imaginary 3-wire-controlled display. All these ports are connected to a processing hierarchy `proc`. Inside this hierarchy we can see the `btn` input going into a “debouncer” IP, its output going into a 4-bit counter, the counter’s sum arriving into an encoder as the input number, and the display outputs from the encoder further lifted to the parent level. The encoder itself is a hierarchy, though an empty one with only the ports defined. The 4-bit counter is also a hierarchy that can be further explored. It consists of a variable width adder IP and a flip-flop register IP.

This example features:

- hierarchies of more than one depth



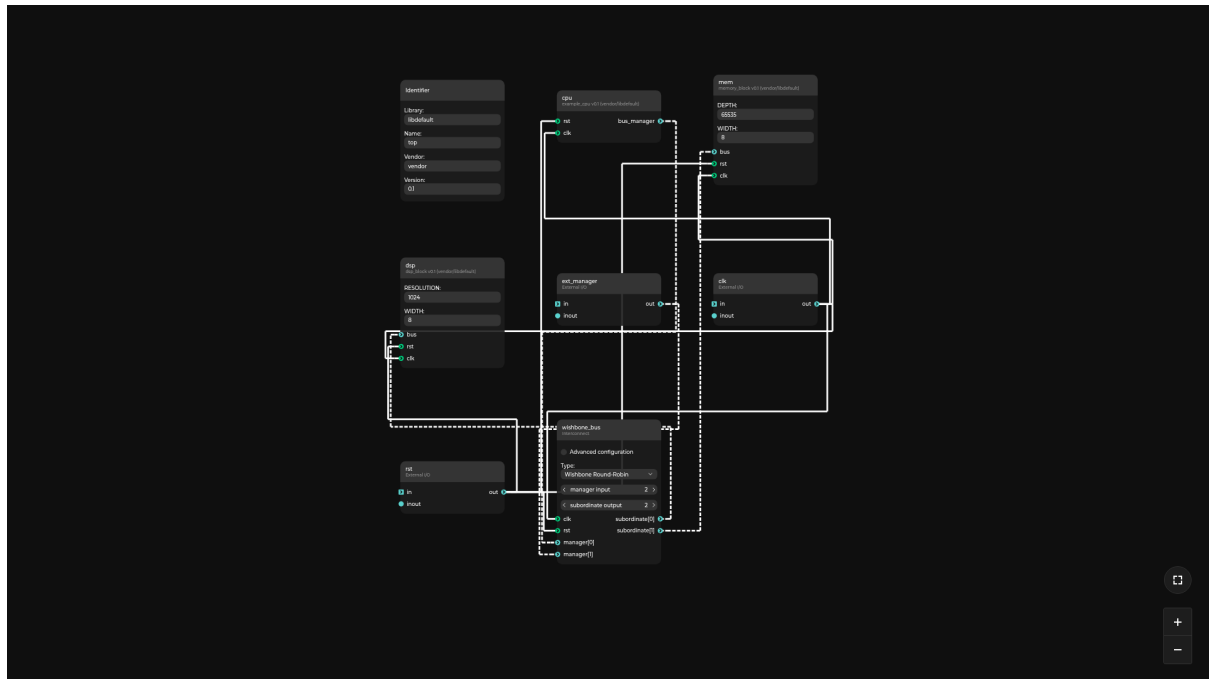
27.4 Interconnect

This is an example of our interconnect generation feature. The design features 3 IP cores: a memory core (ips/mem.yaml), a digital signal processor (ips/dsp.yaml) and a CPU (ips/cpu.yaml). All of them are connected to a wishbone interconnect where both the CPU and an external interface ext_manager act as managers and drive the bus. DSP and MEM are subordinates, one available at address 0x0, the other at 0x10000.

Note that while this specific example uses a “Wishbone Round-Robin” interconnect, we still aim to support other types of them in the future. Each one will have its own schema for the “params” section so make sure not to hardcode the parameters’ keys or values.

This example features:

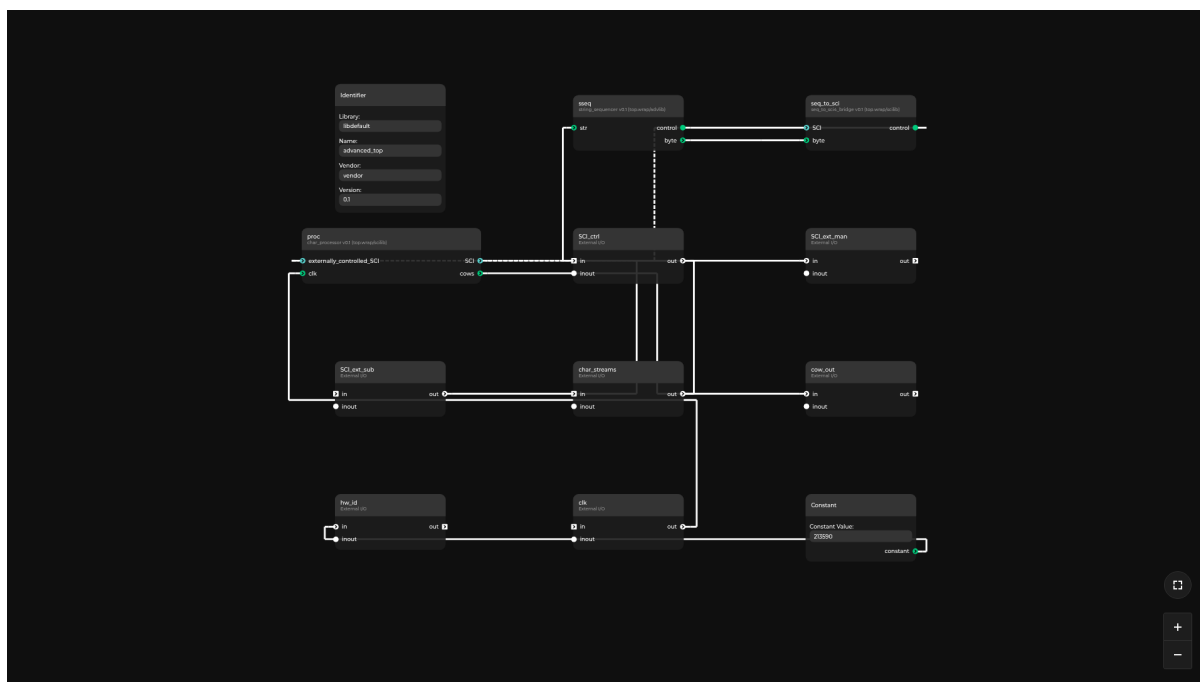
- usage of interface ports
- interconnect usage



27.5 Advanced

This example was created some time after the previous ones and it uses features that the IR didn't have previously. It's main purpose is to demonstrate and test:

- Multidimensional bit arrays
- Named vs anonymous BitStructs
- Arbitrarily sliced port connections (more complex than just a bit-vector slice)
- Partially inferred interfaces (some of their signals are realized using sliced external ports while some signals come from a “real” interface IO)
- Interface signals having types just like ports
- Interface signals having default values
- Complex interface mode configurations:
 - Signals optional for the subordinates or masters
 - Signals legal only for one side of the interface

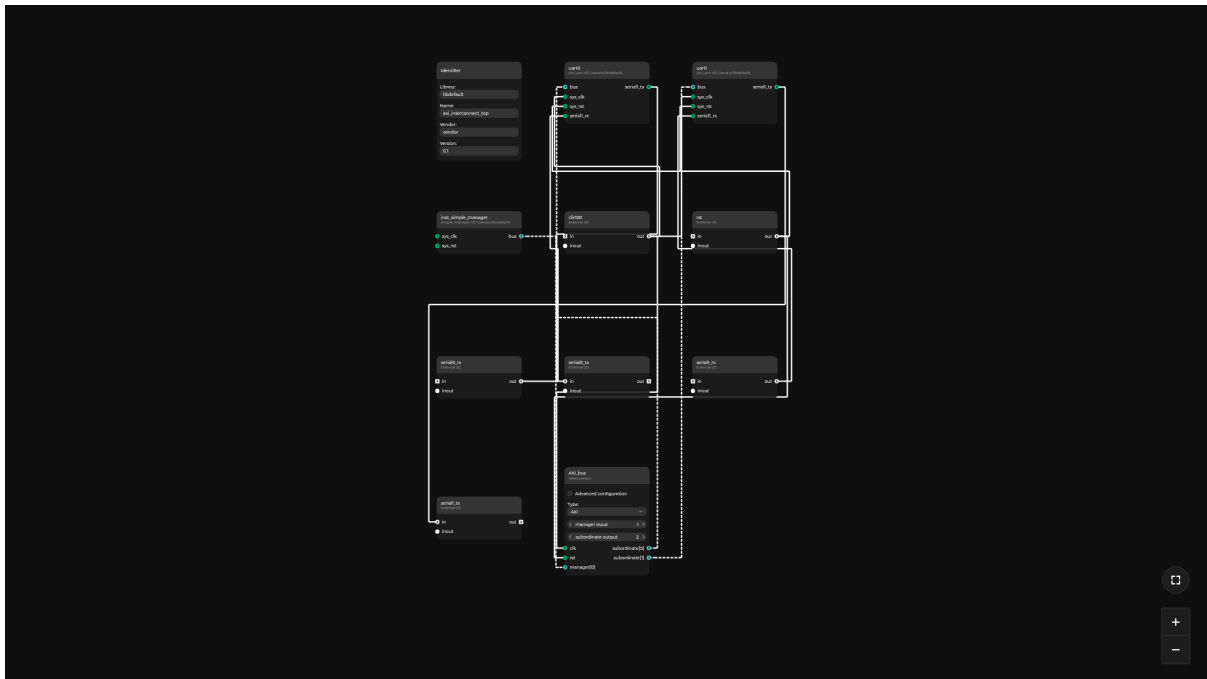


27.6 SoC

This example has an RISC-V processor, memory, and a UART connected by Wishbone interconnect. Interconnect is not present as a Verilog file, but is generated by Topwrap. Unlike other ir-examples it is localized in examples/soc. It has both IR modules defined in python files and System Verilog files that are parsed by topwrap parse. It can be run in a simulator such as Verilator. To run this example, the RISC-V 64-bit toolchain and Verilator simulator need to be installed. To generate interconnect, use `make generate`, to build Verilator sim use `make build-sim`, and to simulate the design use `make sim`.

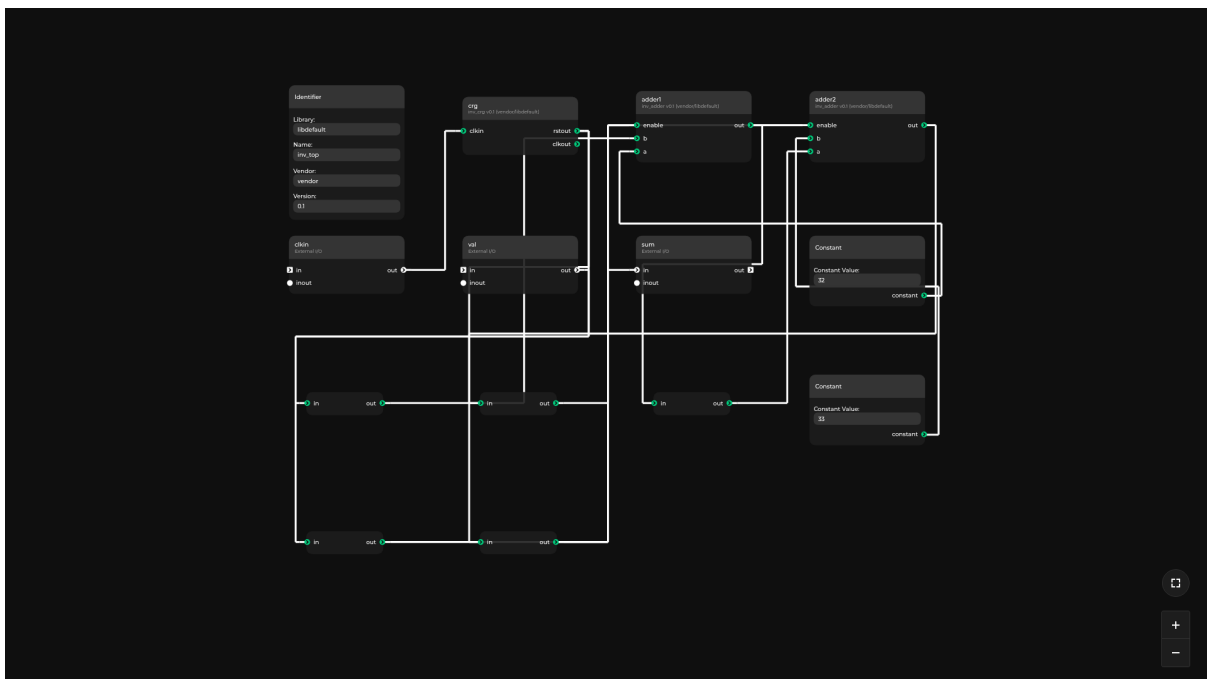
27.7 SoC_AXI

This example has connected manager and two UART subordinates to AXI interconnect. Interconnect is generated by Topwrap. UART0 subordinate has address 0xF0000000 and size 0x1000. UART1 subordinate has address 0xF0001000 and size 0x1000.



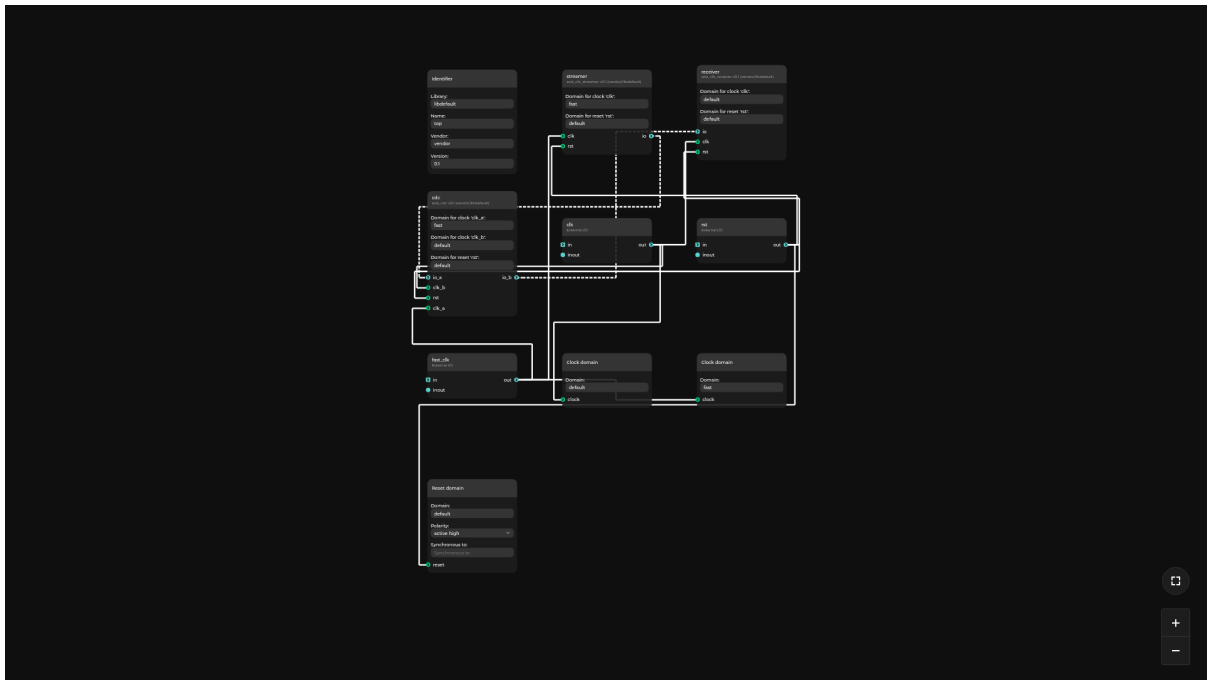
27.8 Inverted

This is an example showcasing the ability to invert (negate) connections between ports of modules and external ports.



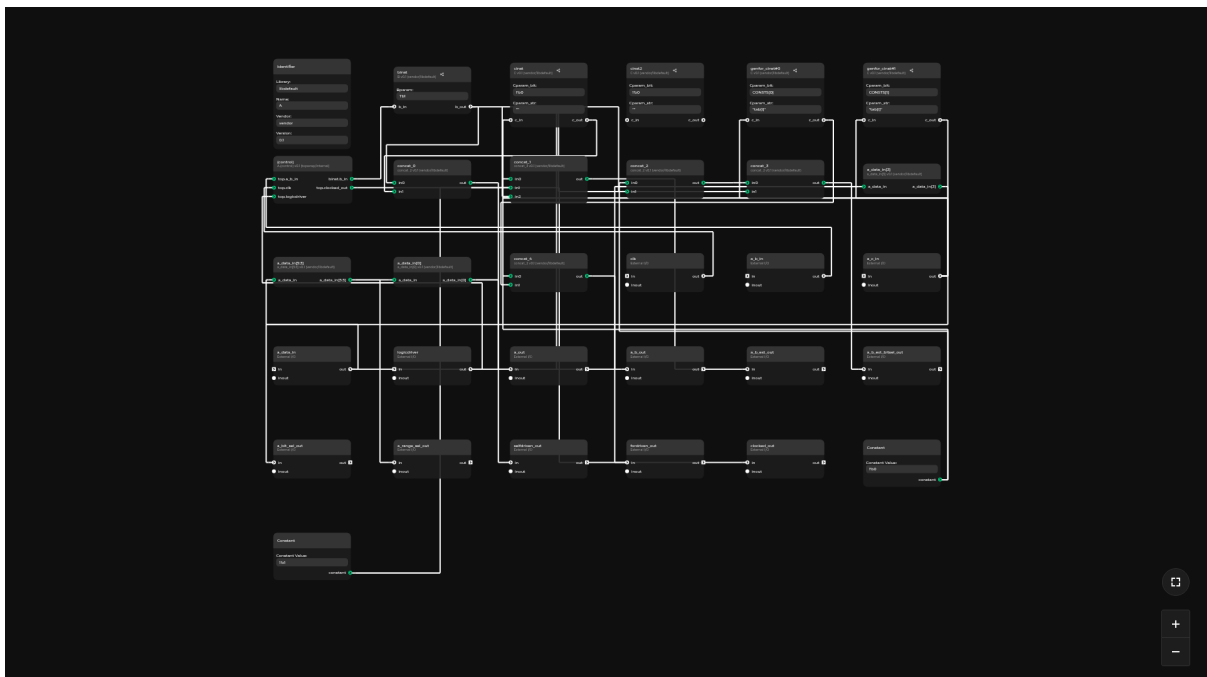
27.9 Clocks

This is an example showcasing the clock and reset domain functionality.



27.10 Complex hierarchy parsing

This example shows a complex hierarchy with subgraphs parsed from SystemVerilog files



27.11 Other

Something that was not taken into account previously, because we don't support it yet, and it's impossible to represent in either format, is a feature/syntax that would allow us to dynamically change the collection of ports/interfaces an IP/hierarchy has. Similarly to how we can control the width of a port using a parameter (like in the “simple” example).

IP-XACT FORMAT

This document is an exploration of the [IP-XACT format](#).

All IP-XACT elements generated for the IR examples are located under `examples/ir_examples/[example]/ipxact/antmicro.com/[example]` where `antmicro.com/[example]` represents the [vendor/library](#). They all conform to the 2022 version. These files can be regenerated with the `topwrap ipxact_gen` command (see [Generating IPXACT 2022 files](#)), which is driven by the *IPXACTBackend*.

28.1 General observations

28.1.1 VLNV

The IP-XACT format enforces the usage of VLNV (vendor, library, name, version) for every single design and component.

```
<ipxact:vendor>antmicro.com</ipxact:vendor>
<ipxact:library>simple</ipxact:library>
<ipxact:name>lfsr_gen</ipxact:name>
<ipxact:version>1.2</ipxact:version>
```

For now, Topwrap can only reliably handle the name value, while vendor and version are not used anywhere and their concept is unrecognised in the codebase. Arguably, library could be represented by the name of a user repository.

Special consideration needs to be taken for these values, as the XML schema defines specific allowed characters for some fields, while Topwrap doesn't sanity-check any fields that accept custom names.

Warning: Later in this document this group of four tags will be represented by `<VLNV... />` to avoid repetition.

28.1.2 Multiple versions

There are many versions of the IP-XACT schema, as [visible here](#), on the official page of Accellera - developers of the format.

Version before 2014 and after 2014 use two different XML namespaces for the tags, respectively: spirit: and ipxact:.

Vivado seemingly only supports the 2009(!) specification version.

This means the discrepancies between different versions and incompatibilities between tools must be taken into account.

There are [official XSLT templates](#) (bottom of the page) available that can convert any IP-XACT .xml file one version up, using an xslt tool like [xsltproc](#).

28.1.3 Design structure

The IP-XACT format revolves mainly around “components”. This is something that is closest to our IPCoreDescription class and its respective YAML schema:

```
<?xml version="1.0" encoding="UTF-8"?>
<ipxact:component>
  <VLNV... />
  <ipxact:model>
    <ipxact:instantiations>
      <ipxact:componentInstantiation>
        <ipxact:moduleParameters>
          ...
        </ipxact:moduleParameters>
      </ipxact:componentInstantiation>
    </ipxact:instantiations>
    <ipxact:ports>
      ...
    </ipxact:ports>
  </ipxact:model>
  <ipxact:parameters>
    ...
  </ipxact:parameters>
</ipxact:component>
```

A singular component represents a black-box, with the outside world seeing only its ports, buses and parameters. In order to represent its inner design there needs to be a separate design XML file:

```
<?xml version="1.0" encoding="UTF-8"?>
<ipxact:design>
  <VLNV... />
  <ipxact:componentInstances>
    ...
  </ipxact:componentInstances>
  <ipxact:adHocConnections>
```

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```

        <ipxact:adHocConnection>
            <ipxact:name>gen2_gen_out_to_two_mux_gen2</ipxact:name>
            <ipxact:portReferences>
                <ipxact:internalPortReference_
↪componentInstanceRef="ip1" portRef="port1"/>
                <ipxact:internalPortReference_
↪componentInstanceRef="ip2" portRef="port1"/>
            </ipxact:portReferences>
        </ipxact:adHocConnection>
        ...
    </ipxact:adHocConnections>
</ipxact:design>

```

which later *is attached* to the component description under the instantiations section, thus making the design an optional property of a module/component.

To describe a top-level wrapper you need both its description as a component, where the external IO is defined, and its design file that describes what other IPs are incorporated by this wrapper.

28.1.4 Parameter passing

IP-XACT introduces a distinction between parameters of a component, and module parameters of the component's instantiation.

This allows most IP-XACT objects to accept parameters that are only internal to them and are unrelated to the potentially generated RTL. In order to define RTL module parameters, you need to specify them under two separate sections.

Below is an example of defining a paramWIDTH parameter with default value of 64 in a component that gets realised in Verilog as parameter WIDTH = 64;;

Take note of the top-level <ipxact:parameters> tag and the <ipxact:moduleParameters> tag of the component instantiation.

```

<ipxact:instantiations>
    <ipxact:componentInstantiation>
        <ipxact:name>rtl</ipxact:name>
        <ipxact:displayName>rtl</ipxact:displayName>
        <ipxact:language>Verilog</ipxact:language>
        <ipxact:moduleParameters>
            <ipxact:moduleParameter>
                <ipxact:name>WIDTH</ipxact:name>
                <ipxact:displayName>WIDTH</ipxact:displayName>
                <ipxact:value>paramWIDTH</ipxact:value>
            </ipxact:moduleParameter>
        </ipxact:moduleParameters>
    </ipxact:componentInstantiation>
</ipxact:instantiations>
<ipxact:parameters>
    <ipxact:parameter parameterId="paramWIDTH" resolve="user" type="longint">

```

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```
<ipxact:name>paramWIDTH</ipxact:name>
<ipxact:displayName>paramWIDTH</ipxact:displayName>
<ipxact:value>64</ipxact:value>
</ipxact:parameter>
</ipxact:parameters>
```

In Topwrap, all IP parameters do get realised in the generated Verilog and there is no notion of internal parameters.

28.1.5 File sets

Each component in IP-XACT can contain an `ipxact:fileSets` section. This is a very exhaustive section about one or more groups of *files* that this component depends on. The type and purpose of every such file is marked, e.g: `verilogSource`.

```
<ipxact:fileSets>
  <ipxact:fileSet>
    <ipxact:name>fs-rtl</ipxact:name>
    <ipxact:file>
      <ipxact:name>../RTL/transmitter.v</ipxact:name>
      <ipxact:fileType>verilogSource</ipxact:fileType>
      <ipxact:logicalName>transmitter_lib</ipxact:logicalName>
    </ipxact:file>
  </ipxact:fileSet>
</ipxact:fileSets>
```

This concept currently only exists as a `--sources` CLI option for `topwrap generate --fusesoc`, where all recognized HDL and constraint sources are forwarded to the FuseSoC `.core`. There is no notion of other file dependencies inside IP Core description YAMLS.

28.1.6 Vendor extensions

The IP-XACT format allows storing completely custom data inside most of the tags using the `<ipxact:vendorExtensions>` group. Topwrap could use them to store additional data about the IPs or designs.

Example theoretical vendor extensions:

```
<ipxact:vendorExtensions>
  <topwrap:interconnectType>wishbone</topwrap:interconnectType>
  <topwrap:kpm_position x="600" y="180" />
  <topwrap:repo>builtin</topwrap:repo>
</ipxact:vendorExtensions>
```

28.1.7 Catalogs

Catalogs describe the location and the VLNV identifier of other IP-XACT elements such as components, designs, buses etc. in order to manage and allow access to collections of IP-XACT files. In most cases defining a catalog is not required as all necessary files are automatically located by the used tool.

```
<ipxact:catalog>
  <VLNV... />
  <ipxact:components>
    <ipxact:ipxactFile>
      <ipxact:vlmv vendor="antmicro.com" library="simple" name="lfsr"
↪version="1.0" />
      <ipxact:name>./antmicro.com/simple/lfsr/lfsr.1.0.xml</ipxact:name>
    </ipxact:ipxactFile>
  </ipxact:components>
  <ipxact:busDefinitions>
    ...
  </ipxact:busDefinitions>
  ...
</ipxact:catalog>
```

28.2 Simple example

This is the simplest IP-XACT example as it contains only plain IP cores with standalone ports, and parameters.

28.2.1 Instance names

Since Topwrap doesn't verify any user-defined names, an accidental creation of a 2mux.yaml IP Core named 2mux_compressor instantiated with a 2mux name, was possible in the YAML format. Many environments, IP-XACT included, don't actually allow users to start custom names with a number. The instance name of 2mux had to be changed to two_mux for this purpose.

28.2.2 Parameters

The special syntax of IP-XACT parameters is mostly explained in the *Parameter passing* section.

Variable widths

If you look at either ips/2mux.yaml or ips/lfsr_gen.yaml you'll see that there are ports with widths defined by the parameters inside an arithmetic expression:

```
# ips/2mux.yaml
out:
  - [out, OUT_WIDTH-1, 0]
```

This is easily realisable in IP-XACT because just like our port widths, they also accept arbitrary arithmetic expressions that can reference other parameters inside them:

```
<ipxact:port>
  <ipxact:name>out</ipxact:name>
  <ipxact:wire>
    <ipxact:direction>out</ipxact:direction>
    <ipxact:vectors>
      <ipxact:vector>
        <ipxact:left>paramOUT_WIDTH - 1</ipxact:left>
        <ipxact:right>0</ipxact:right>
      </ipxact:vector>
    </ipxact:vectors>
  </ipxact:wire>
</ipxact:port>
```

28.2.3 Duality of the design description

The design of the *Simple* example is defined (from the Topwrap’s perspective) purely in the design.yaml file. This is not so simple in IP-XACT, see *Design structure*.

Mostly this means that the “external” section of our design YAML lands in its own component/IP file and the connections and module instances in a separate one that is attached to the component file as a “design instantiation”.

The generated top-level component for this example and its design (top.design.1.0.xml) are located inside the top directory in the IP-XACT library.

Additionally a “design configuration” file is generated that contains additional configuration information for the main design file. Not much is specified there for this example though.

So finally the original design.yaml ends up becoming 3 interconnected .xml files in IP-XACT.

28.2.4 Connections

Port connections between IP cores, and IP cores and externals are all specified in the XML design file. There isn’t much special about them, they are represented very similarly to our design description yaml connections:

```
<ipxact:adHocConnection>
  <ipxact:name>gen2_gen_out_to_two_mux_gen2</ipxact:name>
  <ipxact:portReferences>
    <ipxact:internalPortReference componentInstanceRef="gen2" portRef="gen_out
↪"/>
    <ipxact:internalPortReference componentInstanceRef="two_mux" portRef="gen2
↪"/>
  </ipxact:portReferences>
</ipxact:adHocConnection>
```

28.3 Interface example

The key thing about this example is that it uses an interface connection (AXI 4 Stream) between two IPs, an inout port, a constant value supplied to a port and *port slicing*.

Info

An interface is a named, predefined collection of logical signals used to transfer information between different IPs or other building blocks. Common interface types include: Wishbone, AXI, AHB, and more.

Topwrap, like SystemVerilog, refers to this concept as an “interface”.

IP-XACT refers to the same concept as a “bus”.

28.3.1 Bus definitions

Custom interfaces in Topwrap are defined using *interface description files*.

Custom interfaces are well recognized and supported in IP-XACT. They are represented by two files, a “bus definition” that defines the existence of the interface/bus itself, its name and configurable parameters; and an “abstraction definition” that defines the logical signals of the interface.

It's possible to have more than one abstraction definition for a given bus definition.

Often times the necessary definitions for a given interface are already publicly available. For example, the IP-XACT bus definitions of all ARM AMBA interfaces are available [here](#) in the 2009 version of IP-XACT. For this document, they were up-converted to the 2022 version with the help of *XSLT templates*.

Format

If not, a custom definition has to be created. Starting with the bus definition:

```
<ipxact:busDefinition>
  <VLNV... />
  <ipxact:description>This is the AXI4Stream stream bus definition.</
  <ipxact:description>
  <ipxact:directConnection>true</ipxact:directConnection>
  <ipxact:isAddressable>>false</ipxact:isAddressable>
</ipxact:busDefinition>
```

VLNV entries and description are both present at the start, like in all other IP-XACT definitions. Then there are two configuration booleans:

- `<ipxact:directConnection>` decides if this bus allows direct connection between a manager/initiator and subordinate/targets. Important for “asymmetric buses such as AHB”.
- `<ipxact:isAddressable>` decides if this bus is addressable using the address space of the manager side of the bus. e.g. true for AXI4, false for AXI4Stream.

Then to specify the logical signals of the interface, an abstraction definition has to be created:

```

<ipxact:abstractionDefinition>
  <VLNV... />
  <ipxact:description>This is an RTL Abstraction of the AMBA4/AXI4Stream</
↪ipxact:description>
  <ipxact:busType vendor="amba.com" library="AMBA4" name="AXI4Stream"
↪version="r0p0_1"/>
  <ipxact:ports>
    <ipxact:port>
      <ipxact:logicalName>TREADY</ipxact:logicalName>
      <ipxact:description>indicates that the Receiver can
↪accept a transfer in the current cycle.</ipxact:description>
      <ipxact:wire>
        <ipxact:onInitiator>
          <ipxact:presence>optional</
↪ipxact:presence>
          <ipxact:width>1</ipxact:width>
          <ipxact:direction>in</ipxact:direction>
        </ipxact:onInitiator>
        <ipxact:onTarget>
          <ipxact:presence>optional</
↪ipxact:presence>
          <ipxact:width>1</ipxact:width>
          <ipxact:direction>out</ipxact:direction>
        </ipxact:onTarget>
        <ipxact:defaultValue>1</ipxact:defaultValue>
      </ipxact:wire>
    </ipxact:port>
  </ipxact:ports>
</ipxact:abstractionDefinition>

```

This is a fragment of the TREADY signal definition of the AXI 4 Stream interface.

There's the classic VLNV + Description combo at the start, then the associated bus definition is referenced and lastly the signals of the interface are defined.

In IP-XACT, unlike in Topwrap, you can specify different options for signals on both the manager and the subordinate separately, importantly a signal can be required on one side of the bus while being optional on the other. This is currently impossible to represent in Topwrap. The width specification and the default value are not supported either by Topwrap.

Moreover, unlike in Topwrap, in IP-XACT the clock and reset signals are also specified in the definition alongside other signals. They are however marked with special qualifiers that distinguish their roles and enforce certain behaviours.

Example qualifiers:

```

<ipxact:wire>
  <ipxact:qualifier>
    <ipxact:isClock>true</ipxact:isClock>
    <ipxact:isReset>true</ipxact:isReset>
  </ipxact:qualifier>
</ipxact:wire>

```

Info

While Topwrap uses the manager and subordinate terms to refer to the roles an IP can assume in the bus connection, IP-XACT pre-2022 uses master, slave and IP-XACT 2022-onwards uses initiator and target respectively.

Interface deduction

Topwrap supports specifying both a regex for each signal and the port prefix for the entire interface in order to *automatically group raw ports* from HDL sources into interfaces. None of that is possible to represent in IP-XACT, though this information can be stored anyways using *Vendor extensions*.

28.3.2 Bus instantiation

To use the bus inside a component definition you have to:

- Add all the physical ports that will get used as the bus signals just like regular *ad-hoc ports*
- Map these physical ports to logical ports of the interface

The portMap format

```
interfaces:
  io:
    type: AXI4Stream
    mode: subordinate
    signals:
      in:
        TDATA: [dat_i, 31, 0]
```

This fragment of *Design description* would translate to the below IP-XACT description, assuming the dat_i signal was previously defined in the ad-hoc ports section.

```
<ipxact:busInterfaces>
  <ipxact:busInterface>
    <ipxact:name>io</ipxact:name>
    <ipxact:busType vendor="amba.com" library="AMBA4" name="AXI4Stream"
    ↪version="r0p0_1"/>
    <ipxact:abstractionTypes>
      <ipxact:abstractionType>
        <ipxact:abstractionRef vendor="amba.com" library="AMBA4" name=
        ↪"AXI4Stream_rtl" version="r0p0_1"/>
      <ipxact:portMaps>
        <ipxact:portMap>
          <ipxact:logicalPort>
            <ipxact:name>TDATA</ipxact:name>
          </ipxact:logicalPort>
```

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```

        <ipxact:physicalPort>
          <ipxact:name>dat_i</ipxact:name>
        </ipxact:physicalPort>
      </ipxact:portMap>
    </ipxact:portMaps>
  </ipxact:abstractionType>
<ipxact:abstractionTypes>
  <ipxact:target/>
</ipxact:busInterface>
</ipxact:busInterfaces>

```

The `<ipxact:busInterfaces>` tag is a direct child of the top-level `<ipxact:component>` tag.

Port slicing is supported as well:

```

<ipxact:physicalPort>
  <ipxact:name>ctrl_i</ipxact:name>
  <ipxact:partSelect>
    <ipxact:range>
      <ipxact:left>4</ipxact:left>
      <ipxact:right>4</ipxact:right>
    </ipxact:range>
  </ipxact:partSelect>
</ipxact:physicalPort>

```

28.3.3 Inout ports

This example contains an external inout port raised from one of the IPs. While the *Topwrap syntax* for specifying inout ports in a design is a bit awkward, in IP-XACT inout ports are represented just like ports with other directions.

28.3.4 Constant assignments

This example also features a constant value (2888) assigned to the noise port of the receiver IP instead of any wire. In IP-XACT this is done similarly to *Connections*:

```

<ipxact:adHocConnection>
  <ipxact:name>receiver_0_noise_to_tiedValue</ipxact:name>
  <ipxact:tiedValue>2888</ipxact:tiedValue>
  <ipxact:portReferences>
    <ipxact:internalPortReference componentInstanceRef="receiver_0" portRef=
↪ "noise"/>
  </ipxact:portReferences>
</ipxact:adHocConnection>

```

Additionally, the `tiedValue` can be given by an arithmetic expression that resolves to a constant value.

28.4 Hierarchical example

The hierarchical example features deeply nested hierarchies. The purpose of a hierarchical design is to group together into separate levels/modules, connections that could just as well be realised flatly in the top-level.

In Topwrap, all hierarchies are specified in the respective *design description file* YAML using a special syntax that allows multiple design descriptions to be nested together in a single file.

IP-XACT has no notion of any special syntax for hierarchies, because it doesn't need to. Due to the *architecture of design XMLs* being extensions to component XMLs, it's possible to just generate a component+design pair for every hierarchy and connect them just as if they were regular IPs that happen to have a design available alongside them. This is exactly what was done to represent this example.

28.5 Interconnect example

This example features the *Interconnect generation* functionality of Topwrap.

Specifying interconnects in the Topwrap design description implies dynamic generation of necessary arbiters and bus components during build-time using parameters defined under the interconnect instance key.

IP-XACT doesn't support such functionality because it's just a file format and it doesn't necessarily have any dynamic code associated with it.

Conversion from Topwrap -> IP-XACT should probably just generate the interconnect bus component with the required amount of manager and subordinate ports and package it alongside the generated RTL implementation of routers and arbiters.

Reverse conversion (from the concrete generated IP-XACT interconnect to Topwrap's interconnect entry) is probably impossible, we can't know the interconnect specifics to know which type to pick after it's already generated. However, all this necessary information could be stored in a vendor extension.

28.5.1 The interconnect component

The generated interconnect is located in `./antmicro.com/interconnect/interconnect/wishbone_interconnect1.xml`. As mentioned, it has just enough interface ports to connect the two specified managers and two subordinates.

The Wishbone interface definition from `opencores.org` was used.

The main difference that differentiates the interconnect component from raw interface connections like in the *Interface example* is the explicit definition and mapping of the address space with the `<ipxact:addressSpaces>` tag and assignment of each manager port to one or more subordinates.

The extensions used in the bus instance element in the component definition. Focus on the `ipxact:addressSpaceRef` tag where the base address of this subordinate is specified:

```
<ipxact:busInterface>
  <ipxact:name>target_1</ipxact:name>
  <ipxact:busType vendor="opencores.org" library="interface" name="wishbone"
↪version="b4"/>
  <ipxact:abstractionTypes>
    ...
  </ipxact:abstractionTypes>
  <ipxact:initiator>
    <ipxact:addressSpaceRef addressSpaceRef="address">
      <ipxact:baseAddress>'h10000</ipxact:baseAddress>
    </ipxact:addressSpaceRef>
  </ipxact:initiator>
</ipxact:busInterface>
```

The extension used at the top-level in the component definition to map the address space:

```
<ipxact:addressSpaces>
  <ipxact:addressSpace>
    <ipxact:name>address</ipxact:name>
    <ipxact:range>2**32/8-1</ipxact:range>
    <ipxact:width>8</ipxact:width>
    <ipxact:segments>
      <ipxact:segment>
        <ipxact:name>mem</ipxact:name>
        <ipxact:addressOffset>'h0</ipxact:addressOffset>
        <ipxact:range>'hFFFF+1</ipxact:range>
      </ipxact:segment>
      <ipxact:segment>
        <ipxact:name>dsp</ipxact:name>
        <ipxact:addressOffset>'h10000</ipxact:addressOffset>
        <ipxact:range>'hFF+1</ipxact:range>
      </ipxact:segment>
    </ipxact:segments>
    <ipxact:addressUnitBits>8</ipxact:addressUnitBits>
  </ipxact:addressSpace>
</ipxact:addressSpaces>
```

The assignment of a manager port to specified subordinates(targets):

```
<ipxact:busInterface>
  <ipxact:name>manager0</ipxact:name>
  <ipxact:busType vendor="opencores.org" library="interface" name="wishbone"
↪version="b4"/>

  <ipxact:target>
    <ipxact:transparentBridge initiatorRef="target_0"/>
    <ipxact:transparentBridge initiatorRef="target_1"/>
  </ipxact:target>
</ipxact:busInterface>
```

28.5.2 External interface

In the Topwrap definition of this example, a wishbone_passthrough IP core is used in order to allow the external interface to be connected as a manager to the interconnect. This is due to limitations of the schema and the fact that under the managers key Topwrap expects the IP instance name with the specified manager port, completely disregarding the possibility of it being external.

28.6 Other features

28.6.1 Dynamic number of ports/interfaces based on a parameter

This is not possible in IP-XACT. All ports/interfaces and connections need to be explicitly defined. While the amount of bits in a port can vary based on a parameter value, as was presented in *Variable widths*, higher level concepts such as the number of ports cannot.

28.7 Conclusion

In most aspects IP-XACT is a superset of what's possible to describe in Topwrap, making the Topwrap -> IP-XACT conversion pretty trivial.

Syntax impossible to represent natively in IP-XACT such as:

- Abstract interconnects without concrete implementation
- Interface signal name regexes and port prefixes (see *Interface inference*)

can even if not implemented, be at least preserved using *Vendor extensions*.

Other visible issue for this conversion are:

- *VLNV* being mandatory for IP-XACT files, but Topwrap containing only the name information
- Lack of input sanitization of string fields on Topwrap's side

On the other hand, the conversion from a generic IP-XACT file to Topwrap's internal representation may prove more tricky and definitely suffer from information loss as the IP-XACT format is packed with more features and elements that are not exactly useful for our purposes and were not even mentioned in this document at all.

GENERATOR

Generator is used for generating **ModuleInstance** and HDL code. There can be a **Generator** for each **Interconnect** and for each **Backend**.

Each Generator needs to implement the **generate()** method that will generate interconnect code specific for used backend.

```
generate(self, interconnect: _IT, module_instance: ModuleInstance) -> _T:  
    pass
```

_IT is bound to **Interconnect** and is set by interconnect-specific implementation (e.g. **WishboneRRSystemVerilogGenerator**).

_T isn't bound and is set by backend-specific implementation (e.g. **SystemVerilogGenerator**).

Note: Backend-specific generators inheritance from **Generator** (e.g. **SystemVerilogGenerator**).
Interconnect-specific generators inheritance from backend-specific (e.g. **WishboneRRSystemVerilogGenerator**).

Generated HDL code need to follow naming convention, for ports it is set by **get_name()**, and for Module by default it is **interconnect_{interconnect.name}**. **add_module_instance_to_design()** is used to create **ModuleInstance** and add it to **Design**, it can be overridden when generated HDL code needs it.

Important: **clk** and **rst** ports are always generated by default, if **generate()** method don't create these ports it is needed to override **add_module_instance_to_design()** to change that behavior.

Backend-specific implementation can introduce new methods that the interconnect-specific class can implement or use. Each backends need to have its own lookup list that contains **Interconnect** and is mapped to **Generator**

29.1 How to implement a Generator

Based on example of WishboneRRSystemVerilogGenerator, a new SystemVerilog-based generator can be implemented as follows. Create subclass of SystemVerilogGenerator and implement generate(). It needs to return generated System Verilog code, the code needs to have same ports as generated ModuleInstance. To make name generation less prone to errors use get_name() in implementation of generate() or override get_name() with your naming convention.

29.2 Lookup maps

SystemVerilogBackend uses verilog_generators_map as lookup map. IPXACTBackend reuses the same verilog_generators_map, since different HDL backends may yield different IR modules for interconnects.

29.3 API Reference

class Generator

add_module_instance_to_design(interconnect: *_INTERCONNECT*) → *ModuleInstance*

Returns generated *ModuleInstance* based on *Interconnect*, generated *ModuleInstance* always has *rst* and *clk*, *ModuleInstance* also has additional ports and interfaces based on what bus is used with managers and subordinates. *ModuleInstance*'s of subordinates and managers are connected to generated *ModuleInstance*

Parameters

interconnect: *_INTERCONNECT*

Interconnect to represent as *ModuleInstance*

abstract generate(interconnect: *_INTERCONNECT*, module_instance: *ModuleInstance*) → *_HDL*

Returns generated HDL code wrapped in class specific for backend

Parameters

interconnect: *_INTERCONNECT*

HDL code is generated based on this *Interconnect*

module_instance: *ModuleInstance*

generated based on *Interconnect*, it don't need to be used for generation, but can be helpful

Raises

InterconnectGenerationError – Raised when there is problem with generating HDL code

get_name(referenced_interface: *ReferencedInterface*, signal: *InterfaceSignal*) → str

Returns name for *InterfaceSignal*, generated backend specific code need to have same naming convention

Parameters

referenced_interface: *ReferencedInterface*
InterfaceInstance containing this InterfaceSignal

signal: *InterfaceSignal*
Signal to give name

class SystemVerilogGenerator

It is System Verilog specific generator, it's empty and need subclass for each Interconnect that SV backend need to support

class WishboneRRSystemVerilogGenerator

add_module_instance_to_design(*interconnect*: WishboneInterconnect) → *ModuleInstance*

Returns generated *ModuleInstance* based on *Interconnect*, generated *ModuleInstance* always has *rst* and *clk*, *ModuleInstance* also has additional ports and interfaces based on what bus is used with managers and subordinates. *ModuleInstance* 's of subordinates and managers are connected to generated *ModuleInstance*

Parameters

interconnect: WishboneInterconnect
Interconnect to represent as *ModuleInstance*

generate(*interconnect*: WishboneInterconnect, *module_instance*: *ModuleInstance*) → SVFile

Returns generated HDL code wrapped in class specific for backend

Parameters

interconnect: WishboneInterconnect
HDL code is generated based on this *Interconnect*

module_instance: *ModuleInstance*
generated based on *Interconnect*, it don't need to be used for generation, but can be helpful

Raises

InterconnectGenerationError – Raised when there is problem with generating HDL code

get_name(*referenced_interface*: *ReferencedInterface*, *signal*: *InterfaceSignal*) → str
Returns name for *InterfaceSignal*, generated backend specific code need to have same naming convention

Parameters

referenced_interface: *ReferencedInterface*
InterfaceInstance containing this *InterfaceSignal*

signal: *InterfaceSignal*
Signal to give name

class AXIVerilogGenerator

add_module_instance_to_design(*interconnect*: AXIInterconnect) → *ModuleInstance*

Returns *ModuleInstance* with ports interfaces generated based on *Interconnect* *ModuleInstance* and connections are added to design

Parameters

interconnect: `AXIInterconnect`

Interconnect to represent as *ModuleInstance*

generate(*interconnect*: `AXIInterconnect`, *module_instance*: `ModuleInstance`) → `SVFile`

Returns generated HDL code wrapped in class specific for backend

Parameters

interconnect: `AXIInterconnect`

HDL code is generated based on this *Interconnect*

module_instance: `ModuleInstance`

generated based on *Interconnect*, it don't need to be used for generation, but can be helpful

Raises

InterconnectGenerationError – Raised when there is problem with generating HDL code

get_name(*referenced_interface*: `ReferencedInterface`, *signal*: `InterfaceSignal`) → `str`

Returns name for *InterfaceSignal*, generated backend specific code need to have same naming convention

Parameters

referenced_interface: `ReferencedInterface`

InterfaceInstance containing this *InterfaceSignal*

signal: `InterfaceSignal`

Signal to give name

verilog_generators_map : `dict[type[Interconnect], type[SystemVerilogGenerator[Any]]]`

Used by SV backend to get correct generator. All implementations of *Generator* for SV backend need to be present in this map.

INTERCONNECT

This document is about implementing new *Interconnect*, check *Interconnect generation* to read about Interconnect concept in Topwrap.

Interconnect is base class for all interconnects, it has 3 generic classes that are used to represent params: *InterconnectParams*, *InterconnectManagerParams* and *InterconnectSubordinateParams*. All new implementations of interconnect need to be placed in `topwrap/interconnects/` and added to `INTERCONNECT_TYPES`. Each interconnect needs to have implemented *Generator*, refer to *Generator* to check how to implement one.

Base class for multiple interconnect generator implementations.

Interconnects connect multiple interface instances together in a many-to-many topology, combining multiple subordinates into a unified address space so that one or multiple managers can access them.

Base class for parameters/settings specific to a concrete interconnect type

Base class for subordinate parameters specific to a concrete interconnect type.

Transactions to addresses in range `[self.address; self.address + self.size)` will be routed to this subordinate.

Base class for manager parameters specific to a concrete interconnect type

```
InterconnectTypeInfo(intercon:      Type[topwrap.model.interconnect.Interconnect],
params:      Type[topwrap.model.interconnect.InterconnectParams],      man_params:
Type[topwrap.model.interconnect.InterconnectManagerParams],      sub_params:
Type[topwrap.model.interconnect.InterconnectSubordinateParams])
```

INTERCONNECT_TYPES : dict[str, InterconnectTypeInfo]

Maps name to specific interconnect implementation. Used by YAML frontend.

REPOSITORY

Repositories are used for storing, packaging and loading different types of resources that can be used by Topwrap.

An example of the implementation of a concrete repository is the `topwrap.repo.user_repo.UserRepo` class. Its user interface is documented in *Constructing, configuring and loading repositories*.

31.1 API reference

class `Resource(name: str)`

Base class for representing a resource in a repository. Each derived resource should define its own structure.

name : str

Name of the resource

class `ResourceHandler`

Base for classes that can perform various operations on resources of a given type.

The main responsibilities of a resource handler are saving and loading resources of a given type in a repository.

add_resource(resources: dict[str, ResourceType], res: ResourceType, exists_strategy: ExistsStrategy = ExistsStrategy.RAISE)

Custom behavior for adding a resource to a loaded repository :raises ResourceExistsException: Resource already exists in the repository

abstract **load**(repo_path: Path) → Iterator[ResourceType]

Loads list of resources from the repo_path repository

remove_resource(resources: dict[str, ResourceType], res: ResourceType)

Custom behavior for removing a resource from a loaded repository :raises ResourceNotFoundException: Could not find that resource

resource_type : Type[ResourceType]

For which resource type this handler is responsible

abstract **save**(res: ResourceType, repo_path: Path) → None

Saves a resource in the repo_path repository

```
class Repo(resource_handlers: list[ResourceHandler[Resource]], name: str)
```

Base class for implementing repositories. A repository is a container for resources of various types.

Derived classes should be associated with a set of supported resource handlers that define what types of resources can be stored in the repo. An example of such derived repo is UserRepo

```
add_files(handler: FileHandler, exist_strategy: ExistsStrategy =  
          ExistsStrategy.RAISE) → None
```

Parses resources available in files and adds them to the repository

Parameters

handler: *FileHandler*

Handler that contains sources

exist_strategy: *ExistsStrategy* = *ExistsStrategy.RAISE*

What to do if resource exists in repo already

Raises

- **ResourceExistsException** – Raised when *exist_strategy* is set to *RAISE*
- **ResourceNotSupportedException** – Raised when handler returns resources not supported by repo

```
add_resource(resource: Resource, exist_strategy: ExistsStrategy =  
             ExistsStrategy.RAISE) → None
```

Adds a single resource to the repository

Parameters

resource: *Resource*

Resource to add to repo

exist_strategy: *ExistsStrategy* = *ExistsStrategy.RAISE*

What to do if resource exists

Raise

ResourceExistsException: Raised if *exist_strategy* is set to *RAISE*

Raise

ResourceNotSupportedException: Raised if the repository doesn't have a handler for this resource type

```
get_resource(resource_type: type[ResourceType], name: str) → ResourceType
```

Searches for resource with given type in repository

Raises

- **ResourceNotFoundException** – Raised when resource with given name isn't present
- **ResourceNotSupportedException** – Raised when resource is not supported by repo implementation

get_resources(*type*: *type[ResourceType]*) → list[ResourceType]

Implements the same operation as `self.resources[type]` but gives correct hints to the typechecker

load(*repo_path*: *Path*, ***kwargs*: *Any*) → None

Loads repository from *repo_path*

name : str

Name of the repository

remove_resource(*resource*: *Resource*) → None

Removes a single resource from repository

Parameters

resource: *Resource*

Resource to remove from repo

Raises

- **ResourceNotFoundException** – Raised when resource is not present in repository
- **ResourceNotSupportedException** – Raised if repo don't have handler for this resource type

save(*dest*: *Path*, ***kwargs*: *Any*) → None

Saves repository to *dest* :raises ResourceNotSupportedException:

class FileHandler(*files*: *Iterable[File]*)

Base class for file handlers. A file handler is used to extract repository resources from a set of given files.

abstract parse() → list[*Resource*]

Parses a file to extract resources

32.1 Using a Custom Logging Configuration

A custom logging configuration file can be provided with the `--log-cfg` option:

```
topwrap --log-cfg logger.cfg build --design {design_name.yaml}
```

Example configuration:

```
[loggers]
keys=root,frontend,backend

[handlers]
keys=rootStreamHandler,rootFileHandler,frontendStreamHandler,frontendFileHandler,
↪backendStreamHandler,backendFileHandler

[formatters]
keys=rootFormatter,frontendFormatter,backendFormatter

[logger_root]
level=DEBUG
handlers=rootStreamHandler,rootFileHandler

[logger_frontend]
level=DEBUG
handlers=frontendFileHandler,frontendStreamHandler
qualname=topwrap.frontend.yaml.frontend
propagate=0

[logger_backend]
level=DEBUG
handlers=backendFileHandler,backendStreamHandler
qualname=topwrap.backend.sv.backend
propagate=0

[handler_rootStreamHandler]
class=StreamHandler
formatter=rootFormatter
args=(sys.stdout,)
```

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```
[handler_rootFileHandler]
class=FileHandler
formatter=rootFormatter
args=("topwrap.log",)

[handler_frontendStreamHandler]
class=StreamHandler
formatter=frontendFormatter
args=(sys.stdout,)

[handler_frontendFileHandler]
class=FileHandler
formatter=frontendFormatter
args=("topwrap.log", "w")

[handler_backendStreamHandler]
class=StreamHandler
formatter=backendFormatter
args=(sys.stdout,)

[handler_backendFileHandler]
class=FileHandler
formatter=backendFormatter
args=("topwrap.log", "w")

[formatter_rootFormatter]
format=%(levelname)s: %(message)s

[formatter_frontendFormatter]
format=%(levelname)s: frontend: %(message)s

[formatter_backendFormatter]
format=%(levelname)s: backend: %(message)s
```

If both `--log-level` and `--log-cfg` are provided, the logging configuration file is loaded first, and the log level specified by `--log-level` overrides the configured levels.

32.2 Creating a New Logger

Since Topwrap relies on Python's standard logging module, users can easily add custom loggers. Each logger should correspond to a Python module and use the module name as its qualname. The module name can be obtained by:

- printing `__name__` inside the module, or
- converting the file path into dotted module notation.

For example:

```
topwrap/frontend/frontend.py
```

corresponds to:

```
topwrap.frontend.frontend
```

PLUGINS

Plugins are Python modules that are installed in the same environment as Topwrap. They must define an entry point in the `topwrap.plugins` group. The entry point is a class that inherits from `BasePlugin`. `pyproject.toml` must contain the following:

```
[project.entry-points."topwrap.plugins"]
<plugin-name> = "<plugin-name>.<module-path>:<PluginBase-subclass>"
```

Important: Plugin support is experimental and both the mechanism and API may change partially or completely between Topwrap versions.

33.1 Examples

Use an existing plugin as a base for developing your own: github.com/antmicro/topwrap-utils.

33.2 Plugin Base

By defining implementations for the various hooks defined by `BasePlugin`, the plugin can modify or extend Topwrap's capabilities. All methods are passed the current `BuildContext` which contains the *internal representation* of the design and other metadata.

```
class BasePlugin
    Bases: object

    priority : int = 0
        Priority of the plugin. Hooks are invoked in order of decreasing priority.

    pre_ir_generation(ctx: BuildContext)
        Hook invoked before parsing sources.

    post_ir_generation(ctx: BuildContext)
        Hook invoked after parsing sources.

    pre_transform(ctx: BuildContext)
        Hook invoked before applying transformations.
```

post_transform(ctx: BuildContext)

Hook invoked after applying transformations.

pre_validate(ctx: BuildContext)

Hook invoked before performing validation.

post_validate(ctx: BuildContext)

Hook invoked after performing validation.

pre_output_generation(ctx: BuildContext)

Hook invoked before generating outputs.

post_output_generation(ctx: BuildContext)

Hook invoked after generating outputs (but before writing outputs to files).

pre_output_writing(ctx: BuildContext, target_dir: OutputDir)

Hook invoked before writing outputs to files.

post_output_writing(ctx: BuildContext, target_dir: OutputDir)

Hook invoked after writing outputs to files.

33.3 Build Context

The **BuildContext** exposes runtime metadata including the internal representation of the design. It is **shared** between Topwrap and any loaded plugins. Use the documentation on the *internal representation* for insight into what the metadata represents.

```
class BuildContext(repo_modules: list[topwrap.model.module.Module], repo_interfaces:
    list[topwrap.model.interface.InterfaceDefinition], design_source:
    Union[topwrap.plugin.base.FileSource, topwrap.plugin.base.StringSource,
    NoneType], extra_sources:
    list[typing.Union[topwrap.plugin.base.FileSource,
    topwrap.plugin.base.StringSource]], top_module:
    Optional[topwrap.model.module.Module], loaded_modules:
    list[topwrap.model.module.Module], existing_interfaces:
    set[topwrap.model.misc.Identifier], outputs: dict[str, typing.Any] =
    <factory>, positions: dict[topwrap.model.misc.Identifier,
    topwrap.backend.kpm.common.Positions] = <factory>)
```

Bases: object

repo_modules : list[Module]

Modules loaded from repositories.

repo_interfaces : list[InterfaceDefinition]

Interface definitions loaded from repositories.

design_source : FileSource | StringSource | None

Path to the source file containing the design.

extra_sources : list[FileSource | StringSource]

Paths to additional source files to be parsed.

top_module : *Module* | None
Top-level module containing the design.

loaded_modules : list[*Module*]
All loaded modules.

existing_interfaces : set[*Identifier*]
List of identifiers of existing definitions in HDL code

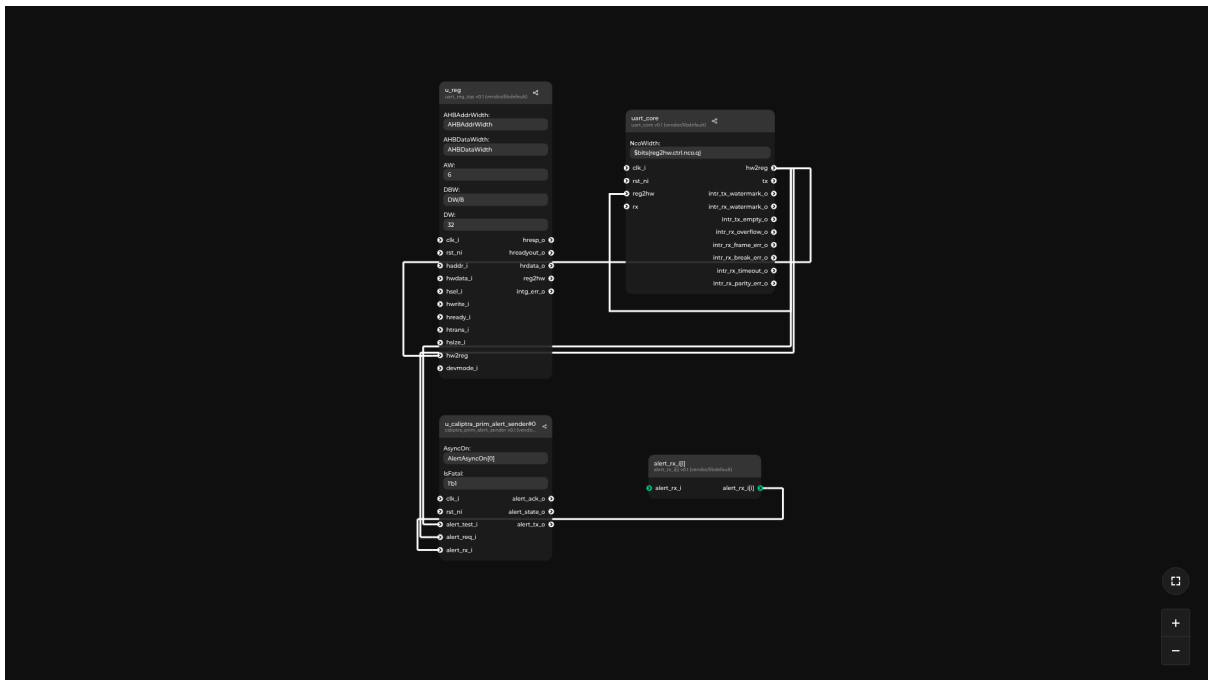
outputs : dict[str, Any]
Map of generated outputs, keyed on the output stage name.

positions : dict[*Identifier*, Positions]
Map of module identifiers to the KPM position definitions.

property all_modules : Iterable[*Module*]

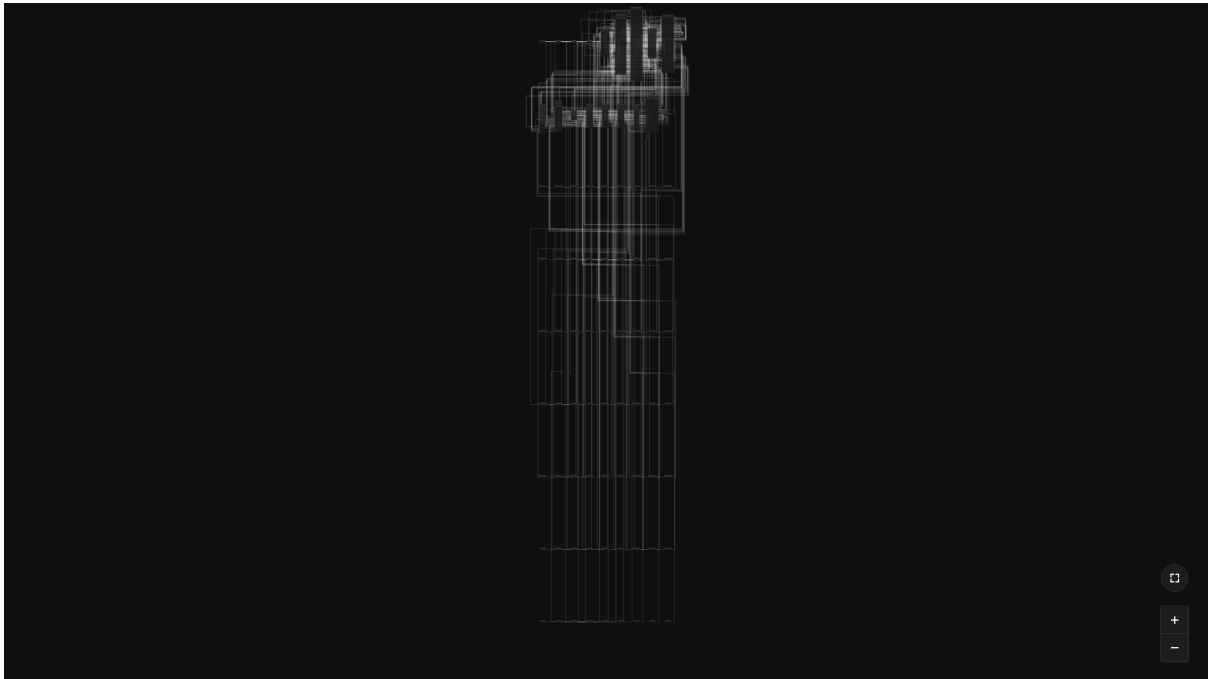
CHAPTER THIRTYFOUR

CALIPTRA UART



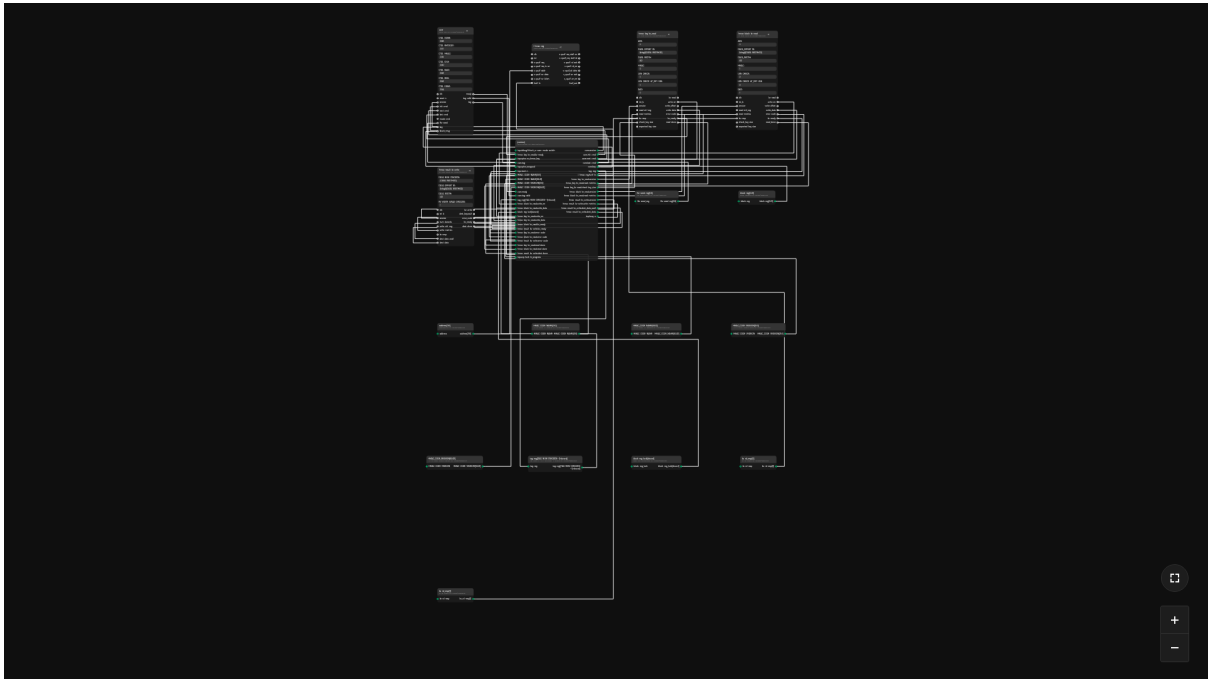
CHAPTER
THIRTYFIVE

VEER EL2



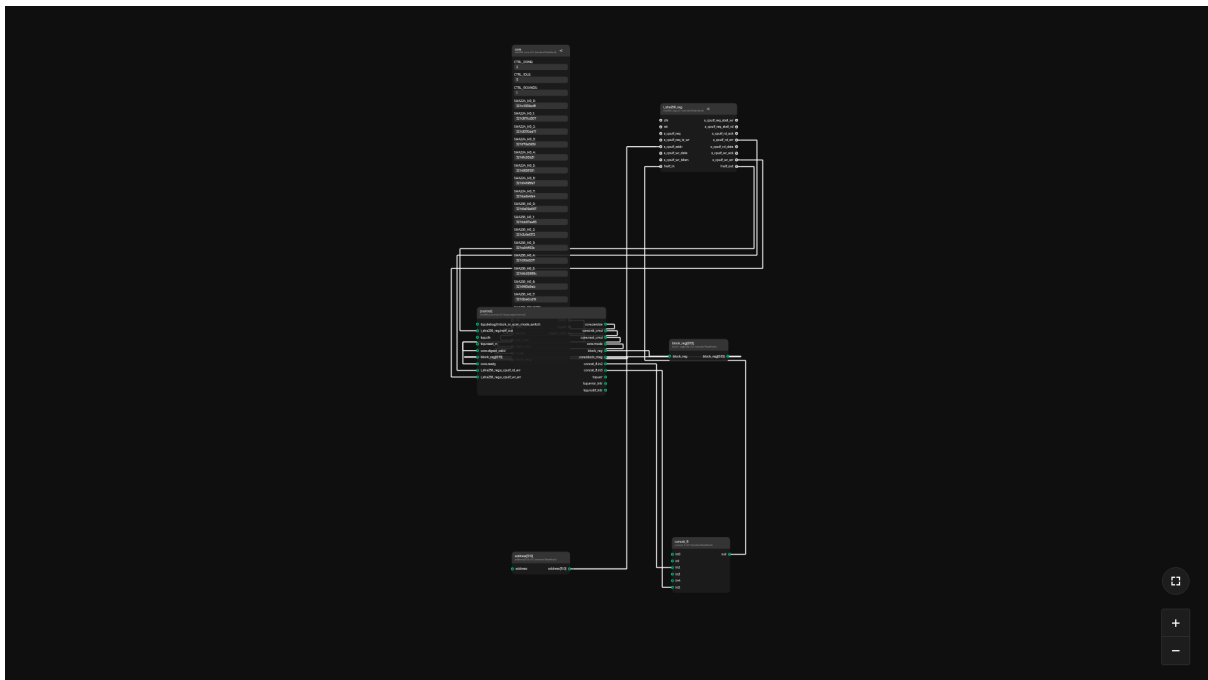
CHAPTER THIRTYSIX

HMAC



CHAPTER THIRTYSEVEN

SHA256



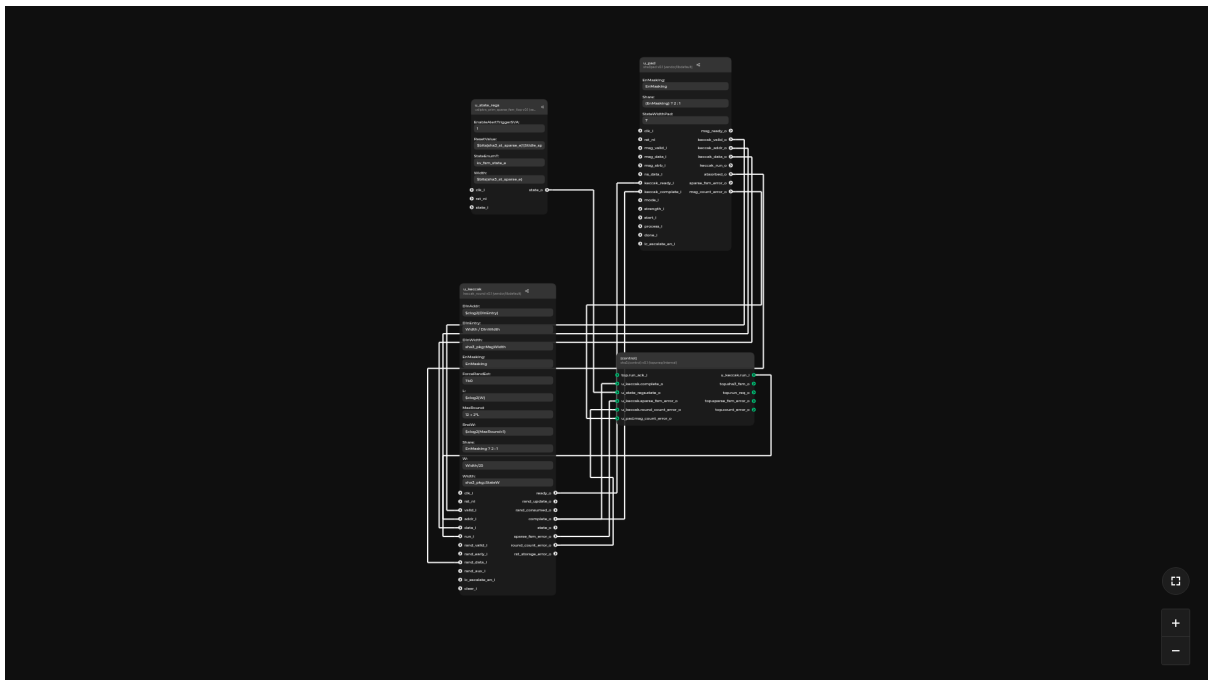
CHAPTER THIRTYEIGHT

SHA512



CHAPTER THIRTYNINE

SHA3



PYTHON MODULE INDEX

t

- topwrap.backend.backend, [71](#)
- topwrap.frontend.frontend, [70](#)
- topwrap.interconnects.types.InterconnectTypeInfo,
[142](#)
- topwrap.model.connections, [80](#)
- topwrap.model.design, [73](#)
- topwrap.model.hdl_types, [82](#)
- topwrap.model.inference.inference, [79](#)
- topwrap.model.inference.port, [78](#)
- topwrap.model.interconnect, [84](#)
- topwrap.model.interface, [75](#)
- topwrap.model.misc, [86](#)
- topwrap.model.module, [72](#)
- topwrap.plugin.base, [150](#)

A

ACTIVE_HIGH (*ResetPolarity attribute*), 81
 ACTIVE_LOW (*ResetPolarity attribute*), 81
 add_clock() (*Module method*), 72
 add_clock_domain() (*Design method*), 75
 add_component() (*Design method*), 75
 add_config() (*Design method*), 75
 add_connection() (*Design method*), 75
 add_dependency() (*FuseSocBuilder method*), 95
 add_extensions() (*Design method*), 75
 add_extensions() (*Module method*), 73
 add_external_ip() (*FuseSocBuilder method*), 95
 add_files() (*Repo method*), 144
 add_fileset() (*FuseSocBuilder method*), 95
 add_interconnect() (*Design method*), 75
 add_interface() (*Module method*), 72
 add_memory_maps() (*Design method*), 75
 add_module_instance_to_design() (*AXIVerilogGenerator method*), 140
 add_module_instance_to_design() (*Generator method*), 139
 add_module_instance_to_design() (*WishboneRRSystemVerilogGenerator method*), 140
 add_parameter() (*Module method*), 72
 add_port() (*Module method*), 72
 add_reference() (*Module method*), 72
 add_reset() (*Module method*), 72
 add_reset_domain() (*Design method*), 75
 add_resource() (*Repo method*), 144
 add_resource() (*ResourceHandler method*), 143
 add_script() (*FuseSocBuilder method*), 95
 add_signal() (*InterfaceDefinition method*), 76
 add_source() (*FuseSocBuilder method*), 95
 add_sources_dir() (*FuseSocBuilder method*), 96
 add_target() (*FuseSocBuilder method*), 96
 address (*InterconnectSubordinateParams at-*

tribute), 85

all_modules (*BuildContext property*), 151
 AXIVerilogGenerator (*class in topwrap.backend.sv.generators*), 140

B

Backend (*class in topwrap.backend.backend*), 71
 BackendOutputInfo (*class in topwrap.backend.backend*), 71
 BackendParseException, 71
 BasePlugin (*class in topwrap.plugin.base*), 149
 Bit (*class in topwrap.model.hdl_types*), 82
 Bits (*class in topwrap.model.hdl_types*), 83
 BitStruct (*class in topwrap.model.hdl_types*), 83
 build() (*FuseSocBuilder method*), 96
 BuildContext (*class in topwrap.plugin.base*), 150

C

check_connection_to_subgraph_metanodes() (*DataflowValidator method*), 101
 check_duplicate_metanode_names() (*DataflowValidator method*), 101
 check_duplicate_node_names() (*DataflowValidator method*), 101
 check_external_in_to_external_out_connections() (*DataflowValidator method*), 101
 check_external_io_exposed_ifaces() (*DataflowValidator method*), 102
 check_intf_cdc() (*Design method*), 75
 check_parameters_values() (*DataflowValidator method*), 102
 check_port_to_multiple_external_metanodes() (*DataflowValidator method*), 102
 check_unconnected_ports_interfaces() (*DataflowValidator method*), 102
 check_unnamed_external_metanodes_with_multiple_conn() (*DataflowValidator method*), 102

CheckResult (class in topwrap.kpm_dataflow_validator), 102
 Clock (class in topwrap.model.connections), 81
 clock (Clock attribute), 81
 clock (ClockDomain attribute), 74
 clock (Interconnect attribute), 85
 clock (Interface attribute), 77
 clock_domains (Design property), 74
 ClockDomain (class in topwrap.model.design), 73
 clocks (Module property), 72
 clocks (ModuleInstance attribute), 73
 column (FileReference attribute), 88
 combined() (Identifier method), 88
 components (Design property), 74
 Config (class in topwrap.config), 100
 config (Design attribute), 74
 ConfigManager (class in topwrap.config), 100
 connections (Design property), 74
 connections_with() (Design method), 75
 ConstantConnection (class in topwrap.model.connections), 80
 content (BackendOutputInfo attribute), 71
 content (FrontendParseStrInput attribute), 70
 copy() (Bit method), 82
 copy() (BitStruct method), 83
 copy() (Enum method), 83
 copy() (Logic method), 82
 copy() (LogicArray method), 83
 copy() (StructField method), 83

D

data (ExtensionData attribute), 88
 dataflow_complex_hierarchy() (in module tests_kpm.test_kpm_validation), 109
 dataflow_conn_subgraph_metanode() (in module tests_kpm.test_kpm_validation), 109
 dataflow_duplicate_external_input_interfaces() (in module tests_kpm.test_kpm_validation), 106
 dataflow_duplicate_ip_names() (in module tests_kpm.test_kpm_validation), 103
 dataflow_duplicate_metanode_names() (in module tests_kpm.test_kpm_validation), 106
 dataflow_ext_in_to_ext_out_connections() (in module tests_kpm.test_kpm_validation), 105
 dataflow_hier_duplicate_names() (in module tests_kpm.test_kpm_validation), 110
 dataflow_inouts_connections() (in module tests_kpm.test_kpm_validation), 107
 dataflow_invalid_parameters_values() (in module tests_kpm.test_kpm_validation), 104
 dataflow_ports_multiple_external_metanodes() (in module tests_kpm.test_kpm_validation), 105
 dataflow_subgraph_multiple_external_metanodes() (in module tests_kpm.test_kpm_validation), 108
 dataflow_unconn_hierarchy() (in module tests_kpm.test_kpm_validation), 108
 dataflow_unnamed_metanodes() (in module tests_kpm.test_kpm_validation), 107
 DataflowValidator (class in topwrap.kpm_dataflow_validator), 101
 default (InterfaceSignal attribute), 76
 default_value (Parameter attribute), 88
 default_value (Port attribute), 80
 definition (Interface attribute), 77
 Design (class in topwrap.model.design), 74
 design (Module property), 72
 design_source (BuildContext attribute), 150
 DesignDomainException, 74
 Dimensions (class in topwrap.model.hdl_types), 82
 dimensions (LogicArray attribute), 83
 direction (InterfaceSignalConfiguration attribute), 75
 direction (Port attribute), 80

E

ElaboratableValue (class in topwrap.model.misc), 87
 ElaboratableValue.DataclassRepr (class in topwrap.model.misc), 87
 elaborate() (ElaboratableValue method), 87
 Enum (class in topwrap.model.hdl_types), 83
 existing_interfaces (Backend attribute), 71
 existing_interfaces (BuildContext attribute), 151
 ExtensionData (class in topwrap.model.misc),

88
 extensions (*Design property*), 75
 extensions (*Module property*), 72
 external() (*ReferencedPort class method*), 80
 extra_sources (*BuildContext attribute*), 150

F

Field (*ElaboratableValue attribute*), 87
 field (*LogicFieldSelect attribute*), 84
 FIELD (*PortSelectorOp attribute*), 78
 field_name (*StructField attribute*), 83
 fields (*BitStruct attribute*), 84
 file (*FileReference attribute*), 88
 file_association (*FrontendMetadata attribute*), 70
 FileHandler (*class in topwrap.repo.resource*), 145
 filename (*BackendOutputInfo attribute*), 71
 FileReference (*class in topwrap.model.misc*), 88
 find_by() (*QueryableView method*), 86
 find_by_id_or_error() (*QueryableView method*), 86
 find_by_name() (*QueryableView method*), 86
 find_by_name_or_error() (*QueryableView method*), 86
 from_referenced_port() (*PortSelector class method*), 79
 from_str() (*PortSelector class method*), 78
 Frontend (*class in topwrap.frontend.frontend*), 70
 FrontendMetadata (*class in topwrap.frontend.frontend*), 70
 FrontendParseException, 70
 FrontendParseOutput (*class in topwrap.frontend.frontend*), 70
 FrontendParseStrInput (*class in topwrap.frontend.frontend*), 70
 FuseSocBuilder (*class in topwrap.fuse_helper*), 95

G

generate() (*AXIVerilogGenerator method*), 141
 generate() (*Generator method*), 139
 generate() (*WishboneRRSystemVerilogGenerator method*), 140
 Generator (*class in topwrap.backend.generator*), 139
 get_name() (*AXIVerilogGenerator method*), 141
 get_name() (*Generator method*), 139
 get_name() (*WishboneRRSystemVerilogGenerator method*), 140

get_resource() (*Repo method*), 144
 get_resources() (*Repo method*), 144

H

has_independent_signals (*Interface property*), 77
 has_sliced_signals (*Interface property*), 78
 has_symbolic_dimensions() (*in module topwrap.model.hdl_types*), 82
 hierarchy() (*Module method*), 73

I

id (*InterfaceDefinition attribute*), 76
 id (*Module attribute*), 72
 Identifier (*class in topwrap.model.misc*), 87
 IN (*PortDirection attribute*), 80
 independent_signals (*Interface property*), 77
 infer_interfaces_from_module() (*in module topwrap.model.inference.inference*), 79
 INOUT (*PortDirection attribute*), 80
 Interconnect (*class in topwrap.model.interconnect*), 85
 INTERCONNECT_TYPES (*in module topwrap.interconnects.types*), 142
 InterconnectManagerParams (*class in topwrap.model.interconnect*), 84
 InterconnectParams (*class in topwrap.model.interconnect*), 84
 interconnects (*Design property*), 74
 InterconnectSubordinateParams (*class in topwrap.model.interconnect*), 85
 Interface (*class in topwrap.model.interface*), 76
 InterfaceConnection (*class in topwrap.model.connections*), 81
 InterfaceDefinition (*class in topwrap.model.interface*), 76
 InterfaceInferenceOptions (*class in topwrap.model.inference.inference*), 79
 InterfaceMode (*class in topwrap.model.interface*), 75
 interfaces (*FrontendParseOutput attribute*), 70
 interfaces (*Module property*), 72
 InterfaceSignal (*class in topwrap.model.interface*), 76
 InterfaceSignalConfiguration (*class in topwrap.model.interface*), 75
 invert (*PortConnection attribute*), 81
 ios (*Module property*), 72
 item (*LogicArray attribute*), 83

L

library (*Identifier attribute*), 87
 line (*FileReference attribute*), 88
 load() (*Repo method*), 145
 load() (*ResourceHandler method*), 143
 loaded_modules (*BuildContext attribute*), 151
 Logic (*class in topwrap.model.hdl_types*), 82
 logic (*LogicSelect attribute*), 84
 LogicArray (*class in topwrap.model.hdl_types*), 82
 LogicBitSelect (*class in topwrap.model.hdl_types*), 84
 LogicFieldSelect (*class in topwrap.model.hdl_types*), 84
 LogicSelect (*class in topwrap.model.hdl_types*), 84
 lower (*Dimensions attribute*), 82
 lower_domains() (*Design method*), 75

M

make_referenced_port() (*PortSelector method*), 79
 MANAGER (*InterfaceMode attribute*), 75
 managers (*Interconnect attribute*), 85
 memory_map (*Interconnect attribute*), 86
 memory_maps (*Design attribute*), 74
 metadata (*Frontend property*), 71
 min_group_size (*InterfaceInferenceOptions attribute*), 79
 mode (*Interface attribute*), 77
 ModelBase (*class in topwrap.model.misc*), 86
 modes (*InterfaceSignal attribute*), 76
 module
 topwrap.backend.backend, 71
 topwrap.frontend.frontend, 70
 topwrap.interconnects.types.InterconnectTypeInfo, 142
 topwrap.model.connections, 80
 topwrap.model.design, 73
 topwrap.model.hdl_types, 82
 topwrap.model.inference.inference, 79
 topwrap.model.inference.port, 78
 topwrap.model.interconnect, 84
 topwrap.model.interface, 75
 topwrap.model.misc, 86
 topwrap.model.module, 72
 topwrap.plugin.base, 149, 150
 Module (*class in topwrap.model.module*), 72
 module (*ModuleInstance attribute*), 73
 ModuleInstance (*class in topwrap.model.design*), 73

modules (*FrontendParseOutput attribute*), 70

N

name (*Clock attribute*), 81
 name (*ClockDomain attribute*), 73
 name (*ExtensionData attribute*), 88
 name (*FrontendMetadata attribute*), 70
 name (*FrontendParseStrInput attribute*), 70
 name (*Identifier attribute*), 87
 name (*Interconnect attribute*), 85
 name (*Interface attribute*), 77
 name (*InterfaceSignal attribute*), 76
 name (*Logic attribute*), 82
 name (*ModuleInstance attribute*), 73
 name (*Parameter attribute*), 88
 name (*Port attribute*), 80
 name (*Repo attribute*), 145
 name (*Reset attribute*), 81
 name (*ResetDomain attribute*), 74
 name (*Resource attribute*), 143
 non_intf_ports() (*Module method*), 73
 NotElaboratedException, 86

O

ObjectId (*class in topwrap.model.misc*), 86
 ops (*LogicSelect attribute*), 84
 ops (*PortSelector attribute*), 78
 OUT (*PortDirection attribute*), 80
 outputs (*BuildContext attribute*), 151
 overlaps() (*LogicSelect method*), 84
 overlaps() (*ReferencedPort method*), 80

P

Parameter (*class in topwrap.model.misc*), 88
 parameters (*Module property*), 72
 parameters (*ModuleInstance attribute*), 73
 params (*Interconnect attribute*), 85
 parent (*Clock attribute*), 81
 parent (*ClockDomain attribute*), 73
 parent (*Design attribute*), 74
 parent (*ExtensionData attribute*), 88
 parent (*Interconnect attribute*), 85
 parent (*Interface attribute*), 77
 parent (*InterfaceSignal attribute*), 76
 parent (*Logic attribute*), 82
 parent (*ModuleInstance attribute*), 73
 parent (*Parameter attribute*), 88
 parent (*Port attribute*), 80
 parent (*Reset attribute*), 81
 parent (*ResetDomain attribute*), 74
 parse() (*FileHandler method*), 145
 parse_files() (*Frontend method*), 71

- parse_grouping_hints() (in module `topwrap.model.inference.inference`), 79
 parse_str() (Frontend method), 70
 parse_vlnv() (Identifier static method), 87
 polarity (Reset attribute), 81
 polarity (ResetDomain attribute), 74
 Port (class in `topwrap.model.connections`), 80
 port (PortSelector attribute), 78
 PortConnection (class in `topwrap.model.connections`), 81
 PortDirection (class in `topwrap.model.connections`), 80
 ports (Module property), 72
 PortSelector (class in `topwrap.model.inference.port`), 78
 PortSelectorField (class in `topwrap.model.inference.port`), 78
 PortSelectorOp (class in `topwrap.model.inference.port`), 78
 positions (BuildContext attribute), 151
 positions (FrontendParseOutput attribute), 70
 post_ir_generation() (BasePlugin method), 149
 post_output_generation() (BasePlugin method), 150
 post_output_writing() (BasePlugin method), 150
 post_transform() (BasePlugin method), 149
 post_validate() (BasePlugin method), 150
 pre_ir_generation() (BasePlugin method), 149
 pre_output_generation() (BasePlugin method), 150
 pre_output_writing() (BasePlugin method), 150
 pre_transform() (BasePlugin method), 149
 pre_validate() (BasePlugin method), 150
 prefix_consider_camel_case (InterfaceInferenceOptions attribute), 79
 prefix_split_tokens (InterfaceInferenceOptions attribute), 79
 priority (BasePlugin attribute), 149
- ## Q
- QuerableView (class in `topwrap.model.misc`), 86
- ## R
- raw (ElaboratableValue attribute), 87
 ReferencedInterface (class in `topwrap.model.connections`), 80
 ReferencedPort (class in `topwrap.model.connections`), 80
 refers_to() (Identifier method), 87
 refs (Module property), 72
 regexp (InterfaceSignal attribute), 76
 RelationshipError, 86
 remove_resource() (Repo method), 145
 remove_resource() (ResourceHandler method), 143
 Repo (class in `topwrap.repo.repo`), 143
 repo_interfaces (BuildContext attribute), 150
 repo_modules (BuildContext attribute), 150
 represent() (Backend method), 71
 required (InterfaceSignalConfiguration attribute), 76
 Reset (class in `topwrap.model.connections`), 81
 reset (Interconnect attribute), 85
 reset (Interface attribute), 77
 reset (Reset attribute), 81
 reset (ResetDomain attribute), 74
 reset_domains (Design property), 75
 ResetDomain (class in `topwrap.model.design`), 74
 ResetPolarity (class in `topwrap.model.connections`), 81
 resets (Module property), 72
 resets (ModuleInstance attribute), 73
 resolve() (ObjectId method), 87
 Resource (class in `topwrap.repo.resource`), 143
 resource_type (ResourceHandler attribute), 143
 ResourceHandler (class in `topwrap.repo.resource`), 143
 reverse() (InterfaceSignalConfiguration method), 76
 reverse() (PortDirection method), 80
- ## S
- save() (BackendOutputInfo method), 71
 save() (Repo method), 145
 save() (ResourceHandler method), 143
 Schema (Config attribute), 100
 Schema (InterconnectManagerParams attribute), 85
 Schema (InterconnectParams attribute), 84
 Schema (InterconnectSubordinateParams attribute), 85
 select (ReferencedPort attribute), 80
 serialize() (Backend method), 72
 set_parent() (in module `topwrap.model.misc`), 86

signals (*Interface attribute*), 77
 signals (*InterfaceDefinition property*), 76
 single() (*Dimensions class method*), 82
 size (*Bit property*), 82
 size (*BitStruct property*), 83
 size (*InterconnectSubordinateParams attribute*), 85
 size (*Interface attribute*), 77
 size (*Logic property*), 82
 size (*LogicArray property*), 83
 size (*StructField property*), 83
 slice (*LogicBitSelect attribute*), 84
 SLICE (*PortSelectorOp attribute*), 78
 sliced_signals (*Interface property*), 77
 StructField (class in *topwrap.model.hdl_types*), 83
 SUBORDINATE (*InterfaceMode attribute*), 75
 subordinates (*Interconnect attribute*), 85
 synchronous_to (*Reset attribute*), 81
 synchronous_to (*ResetDomain attribute*), 74
 SystemVerilogGenerator (class in *topwrap.backend.sv.generators*), 140

T

top_module (*BuildContext attribute*), 150
 topwrap.backend.backend
 module, 71
 topwrap.frontend.frontend
 module, 70
 topwrap.interconnects.types.InterconnectTypeInfo
 module, 142
 topwrap.model.connections
 module, 80
 topwrap.model.design
 module, 73
 topwrap.model.hdl_types
 module, 82
 topwrap.model.inference.inference
 module, 79
 topwrap.model.inference.port
 module, 78
 topwrap.model.interconnect
 module, 84
 topwrap.model.interface
 module, 75
 topwrap.model.misc
 module, 86
 topwrap.model.module
 module, 72
 topwrap.plugin.base
 module, 149, 150

TranslationError, 86
 type (*InterfaceSignal attribute*), 76
 type (*Port attribute*), 80
 type (*StructField attribute*), 83

U

UNSPECIFIED (*InterfaceMode attribute*), 75
 update_interconnects_from_memory_maps()
 (*Design method*), 75
 upper (*Dimensions attribute*), 82

V

validate_kpm_design() (*DataflowValidator method*), 102
 value (*ElaboratableValue attribute*), 87
 VariableName (in module *topwrap.model.misc*), 86
 variants (*Enum attribute*), 83
 vendor (*Identifier attribute*), 87
 verilog_generators_map (in module *topwrap.backend.sv.generators*), 141
 version (*Identifier attribute*), 87

W

WishboneRRSystemVerilogGenerator (class in *topwrap.backend.sv.generators*), 140